

Frankenstein

Mary Shelley · 1818

TEACHER EDITION · CURRICULUM UNIT

30 lessons of 90 minutes, 5 a week (block schedule), 6 weeks

Syllabus · 90-minute lesson plans · lecture scripts · vocabulary · quizzes with keys · writing prompts at eleven rigor levels · SAT-style items · whole-book test · essays

Liber et Libri · Lux et Libri LLC

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Contents and unit overview

1. Unit overview and the 90-minute lesson
2. Syllabus (weekly pacing)
3. Lesson plans and lecture scripts (chapters 1–30), each with vocabulary, discussion questions, annotation focus, quiz and key, writing prompts and SAT-style items
4. Whole-book test and answer key
5. Essay assignments at eleven rigor levels

Grades: Grades 9–12 (also 7–8; scales to graduate via rigor levels). **Weeks:** 6. **Lessons:** 30 × 90 minutes.

Essential questions

- What does Frankenstein suggest about the costs of unchecked ambition?
- What does Frankenstein suggest about creation and responsibility?
- What does Frankenstein suggest about isolation and the need for companionship?
- What does Frankenstein suggest about nature versus nurture?
- What does Frankenstein suggest about the sublime power of nature?

Objectives

- Cite textual evidence to support analysis of what the text says explicitly and implicitly.
- Determine themes and analyze their development over the course of the novel.
- Analyze how characters, setting and point of view interact.
- Determine the meaning of words and phrases as they are used in the text.
- Write arguments to support claims with clear reasons and relevant evidence.

Standards: RL.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2, RL.9-10.3, RL.9-10.4, RL.11-12.2, W.9-10.1, W.11-12.1, RL.7.2, AP.RL.2, CF.RL.2, C2.RL.2, C3.RL.2, C4.RL.2, GR.RL.2
Assessments: Daily chapter quizzes (auto-graded); Weekly writing prompt (rubric); Whole-book test; Final essay
Differentiation: Every prompt and quiz has eleven rigor levels (Middle School through Graduate / PhD); the app applies student override, then class standard, then the automatic level.
Materials: Liber et Libri reader; Annotation journal; Chapter lecture slides or script

The 90-minute lesson

#	Segment	Mode	Minutes	Clock
1	Bell-ringer	You do	8	0–8
2	Vocabulary with etymology notes	I do	10	8–18

3	Background and context	I do	10	18–28
4	I do: modeled close reading	I do	12	28–40
5	We do: guided annotation	We do	15	40–55
6	You do: independent annotation	You do	15	55–70
7	Discussion	We do	10	70–80
8	Exit ticket / chapter quiz	You do	7	80–87
9	Closure	I do	3	87–90
	Total		**90**	

Syllabus

Week	Chapters	Lessons	Focus and activities	Assessment
1	Introduction Preface Letter I Letter II Letter III	5 × 90 min (450 min)	*the costs of unchecked ambition* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and etymology, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Chapter quizzes in the app • Socratic seminar on the costs of unchecked ambition • Weekly writing prompt at assigned rigor	Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt
2	Letter IV Chapter I Chapter II Chapter III Chapter IV	5 × 90 min (450 min)	*creation and responsibility* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and etymology, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Chapter quizzes in the app • Annotation check and vocabulary game • Weekly writing prompt at assigned rigor	Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt
3	Chapter V Chapter VI Chapter VII Chapter VIII Chapter IX	5 × 90 min (450 min)	*isolation and the need for companionship* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and etymology, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Chapter quizzes in the app • Socratic seminar on isolation and the need for companionship • Weekly writing prompt at assigned rigor	Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt
4	Chapter X Chapter XI Chapter XII Chapter XIII Chapter XIV	5 × 90 min (450 min)	*nature versus nurture* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and etymology, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Chapter quizzes in the app • Annotation check and vocabulary game • Weekly writing prompt at assigned rigor	Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt
5	Chapter XV Chapter XVI Chapter XVII Chapter XVIII Chapter XIX	5 × 90 min (450 min)	*the sublime power of nature* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and etymology, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Chapter quizzes in the app • Socratic seminar on the sublime power of nature • Weekly writing prompt at assigned rigor	Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt
6	Chapter XX Chapter XXI	5 × 90 min	*the costs of unchecked ambition* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and	Whole-book test and final essay

	Chapter XXII Chapter XXIII Chapter XXIV	(450 min)	etymology, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Chapter quizzes in the app • Annotation check and vocabulary game • Weekly writing prompt at assigned rigor	

Lesson plans and lecture scripts

Each chapter is one 90-minute class. Scripts are a starting point; adapt them to your students. Teacher summaries contain spoilers.

Lesson 1: Introduction

Focus: the origin of the novel and the idea of creation

Teacher only · spoilers

Writing in 1831, Shelley explains how the novel began: a rainy summer near Geneva in 1816, a ghost-story contest with Byron and Percy Shelley, conversations about galvanism, and a waking vision of a 'pale student of unhallowed arts' kneeling beside the thing he had put together. She calls the book her 'hideous progeny.'

Background: The 1816 'year without a summer' followed the eruption of Mount Tambora. Galvani's experiments making frog legs twitch with electricity fed public speculation about reanimation.

Significance: The Introduction is one of the most famous origin stories in literature and frames the novel as both a dream and a deliberate artistic creation, mirroring Victor's own act of making.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Settle in and write for five minutes: Shelley calls her book her 'hideous progeny.' How does that phrase connect the author to Victor? No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
Today's words are platitude, invocations, retrospection, galvanism, beatings. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check Webster's. Here is the first: “The illustrious poets also, annoyed by the platitude of prose, speedily relinquished their uncongenial task.” Webster's says: The quality or state of being flat, thin, or insipid. Now the word history: “platitude”: -ude (Latin -udo, "state of"). Root not in our table: have students find it. “invocation”: in- (Latin in-, "not" or "in") + voc (Latin vocare, "to call") + -ation (Latin -atio, "the act or result of"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary. “retrospection”: re- (Latin re-, "back, again") + -tion (Latin -tio, "the act of"). Root not in our table: have students find it. Add each root to your etymology log.

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Present the historical and literary background.
Here is what the first readers of Frankenstein would have known. The 1816 'year without a summer' followed the eruption of Mount Tambora. Galvani's experiments making frog legs twitch with electricity fed public speculation about reanimation. Why does this chapter matter? The Introduction is one of the most famous origin stories in literature and frames the novel as both a dream and a deliberate artistic creation, mirroring Victor's own act of making. Write down one question you want answered.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for point of view.
Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. I read a sentence, stop, and ask what the author is doing. When I see point of view, I underline it and write in the margin what effect it has. Here I notice the diction and the sentence rhythm, and I connect them to the origin of the novel and the idea of creation.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for Point of view, Allusion, Imagery.
Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of point of view. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.

> *I busied myself to think of a story—a story to rival those which had excited us to this task. One which would speak to the mysterious fears of our nature, and awaken thrilling horror—one to make the reader dread to look round, to curdle the blood, and quicken the beatings of the heart. If I did not accomplish these things, my ghost story would be unworthy of its name. I thought and pondered—vainly. I felt that blank incapability of invention which is the greatest misery of authorship, when dull Nothing replies to our anxious invocations. Have you thought of a story? I was asked each morning, and each morning I was forced to reply with a mortifying negative.*

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their rigor.
Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Point of view, Allusion, Imagery: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; your level is already set. Middle-school version: In "Introduction," how does Shelley show the origin of the novel and the idea of creation? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the chapter, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the point of view you noticed as one piece of evidence. I will circulate and conference.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion (think-pair-share or a short Socratic circle).
Let's talk. Our question: How does this chapter connect to the costs of unchecked ambition? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
Take the chapter quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this chapter suggests about the origin of the novel and the idea of creation, backed by one short quotation.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how point of view shapes the origin of the novel and the idea of creation. Tonight, read the next chapter and add two words to your etymology log.

Total: 90 minutes.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (Webster's 1913)	In context	Etymology note
platitude	The quality or state of being flat, thin, or insipid	*The illustrious poets also, annoyed by the platitude of prose, speedily relinquished their uncongenial task.*	"platitude": -ude (Latin -udo, "state of"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
invocations	The act or form of calling for the assistance or presence of some superior being	*I felt that blank incapability of invention which is the greatest misery of authorship, when dull Nothing replies to our anxious invocations.*	"invocation": in- (Latin in-, "not" or "in") + voc (Latin vocare, "to call") + -ation (Latin -atio, "the act or result of"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary.
retrospection	The act, or the faculty, of looking back on things past	*Blank and dreary on retrospection I call them; they were not so to me then.*	"retrospection": re- (Latin re-, "back, again") + -tion (Latin -tio, "the act of"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
galvanism	(a) Electricity excited by the mutual action of certain liquids and metals	*Perhaps a corpse would be reanimated; galvanism had given token of such things: perhaps the component parts of a creature might be manufactured, brought together, and endued with vital warmth.*	"galvanism": -ism (Greek -ismos, "practice, belief"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
beatings	The act of striking or giving blows	*One which would speak to the mysterious fears of our nature, and awaken thrilling horror—one to make the reader dread to look round, to curdle the blood, and quicken the beatings of the heart.*	"beating": be- (Old English be-, "thoroughly, about"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
reanimated	To animate anew	*Perhaps a corpse would be reanimated; galvanism had given token of such things: perhaps the component parts of a creature might be manufactured, brought together, and endued with vital warmth.*	"reanimate": re- (Latin re-, "back, again") + anim (Latin anima, "breath, soul") + -ate (Latin -atus, "to make, having"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary.
appertain	To belong or pertain, whether by right, nature, appointment, or custom	*In all matters of discovery and invention, even of those that appertain to the imagination, we are continually reminded of the story of Columbus and his egg.*	"appertain": ap- (Latin ad, "to") + tain (Latin tenere, "to hold"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary.
cradled	A bed or cot for a baby, oscillating on rockers or swinginng on pivots	*The shape was lost beneath the shadow of the castle walls; but soon a gate swung back, a step was heard, the door of the chamber opened, and he*	"cradle": no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin.

		advanced to the couch of the blooming youths, cradled in healthy sleep.	
inciting	To move to action	*He was forever inciting me to obtain literary reputation, which even on my own part I cared for then, though since I have become infinitely indifferent to it.*	“incite”: in- (Latin in-, "not" or "in"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
parquet	A body of seats on the floor of a music hall or theater nearest the orchestra	*I see them still; the very room, the dark parquet, the closed shutters, with the moonlight struggling through, and the sense I had that the glassy lake and white high Alps were beyond.*	“parquet”: no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin.

Discussion questions

1. Shelley calls her book her 'hideous progeny.' How does that phrase connect the author to Victor?
2. Where does point of view appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with the costs of unchecked ambition?

Annotation focus

- **Point of view:** look for who is telling the story and what that narrator can and cannot know
- **Allusion:** look for references to other books, myths, history or religion
- **Imagery:** look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create

Chapter quiz

1. Where was Shelley staying when the ghost-story contest began?
   A. In London
   B. In Venice
   C. On a ship to the Arctic
   D. Near Geneva, Switzerland
2. Who proposed that each guest write a ghost story?
   A. Lord Byron
   B. Victor Frankenstein
   C. Shelley's father
   D. Robert Walton
3. What scientific topic did the group discuss that influenced the idea?
   A. Galvanism and the principle of life
   B. Astronomy
   C. Steam engines
   D. Botany

4. How did the central image of the novel come to Shelley?
   A. While reading a play
   B. In a vivid waking vision as she lay in bed
   C. In a letter from a friend
   D. From a newspaper story
5. What does Shelley call her book?
   A. Her little ghost
   B. Her Prometheus
   C. Her summer diary
   D. Her hideous progeny
6. In the line "The illustrious poets also, annoyed by the platitude of prose, speedily relinquished their uncongenial task.", what does "platitude" most nearly mean?
   A. The act, or the faculty, of looking back on things past
   B. The act or form of calling for the assistance or presence of some superior being
   C. (a) Electricity excited by the mutual action of certain liquids and metals
   D. The quality or state of being flat, thin, or insipid
7. In the line "I felt that blank incapability of invention which is the greatest misery of authorship, when dull Nothing replies to our anxious invocations.", what does "invocations" most nearly mean?
   A. (a) Electricity excited by the mutual action of certain liquids and metals
   B. The act or form of calling for the assistance or presence of some superior being
   C. The act, or the faculty, of looking back on things past
   D. The quality or state of being flat, thin, or insipid

Answer key: 1. D (Near Geneva, Switzerland); 2. A (Lord Byron); 3. A (Galvanism and the principle of life); 4. B (In a vivid waking vision as she lay in bed); 5. D (Her hideous progeny); 6. D (The quality or state of being flat, thin, or insipid); 7. B (The act or form of calling for the assistance or presence of some superior being)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; RL.7.6, W.7.1): In "Introduction," how does Shelley show the origin of the novel and the idea of creation? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the chapter, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the point of view you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): In Introduction, how does Shelley develop the idea of the origin of the novel and the idea of creation? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the point of view in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Introduction develops the idea of the origin of the novel and the idea of creation. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of point of view and allusion shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Introduction (where it begins, turns and ends) and its point of view shape the reader's understanding of the origin of the novel and the idea of creation. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Introduction suggests about the origin of the novel and the idea of creation. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's point of view and allusion), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; AP.RL.3, AP.W.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses point of view in Introduction to complicate the reader's understanding of the origin of the novel and the idea of creation. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; CF.RL.3, CF.W.1): Situate Introduction within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of the origin of the novel and the idea of creation responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; C2.RL.3, C2.W.1): Read Introduction alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of the origin of the novel and the idea of creation follows or bends those conventions, using the point of view as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; C3.RL.3, C3.W.1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Introduction and its treatment of the origin of the novel and the idea of creation. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's point of view and allusion, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; C4.RL.3, C4.W.1): Develop a research argument that reads Introduction as evidence for a larger claim about the origin of the novel and the idea of creation in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; GR.RL.3, GR.W.1): Develop an original argument that reads Introduction as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of the origin of the novel and the idea of creation. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *Blank and dreary on retrospection I call them; they were not so to me then.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “retrospection” most nearly mean?

   A. To move to action

B. A body of seats on the floor of a music hall or theater nearest the orchestra

C. The act, or the faculty, of looking back on things past

D. A bed or cot for a baby, oscillating on rockers or swinginng on pivots

2. *I busied myself to think of a story—a story to rival those which had excited us to this task. One which would speak to the mysterious fears of our nature, and awaken thrilling horror—one to make the reader dread to look round, to curdle the blood, and quicken the beatings of the heart. If I did not accomplish these things, my ghost story would be unworthy of its name. I thought and pondered—vainly. I felt that blank incapability of invention which is the greatest misery of authorship, when dull Nothing replies to our anxious invocations. Have you thought of a story? I was asked each morning, and each morning I was forced to reply with a mortifying negative.*

Which choice best states a central concern of "Introduction"?

A. Darcy at Rosings

B. The origin of the novel and the idea of creation

C. The cycle of desire

D. Keeping secrets

SAT key: 1. C (The act, or the faculty, of looking back on things past); 2. B (The origin of the novel and the idea of creation)

Lesson 2: Preface

Focus: the author's stated purpose

Teacher only · spoilers

The 1818 Preface (written by Percy Shelley in Mary's voice) claims the central event is not impossible according to some physiologists, insists the story aims to show 'the amiableness of domestic affection,' and recalls the ghost-story origin.

Background: Prefaces in the period often defended novels against charges of immorality or absurdity. Erasmus Darwin, mentioned here, was a well-known physician and poet who speculated about life.

Significance: The Preface sets up the tension between scientific plausibility and moral fable that runs through the whole work.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Settle in and write for five minutes: Why might an author defend the 'possibility' of a fantastic event before the story begins? No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
Today's words are innovate, scrupled, spectres, environs, disadvantages. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check Webster's. Here is the first: "I have thus endeavoured to preserve the truth of the elementary principles of human nature, while I have not scrupled to innovate upon their combinations." Webster's says: To bring in as new. Now the word history: "innovate": in- (Latin in-, "not" or "in") + nov (Latin novus, "new") + -ate (Latin -atus, "to make, having"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary. "scruple": no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin. "spectre": spect (Latin specere, "to look"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary. Add each root to your etymology log.

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Present the historical and literary background.
Here is what the first readers of Frankenstein would have known. Prefaces in the period often defended novels against charges of immorality or absurdity. Erasmus Darwin, mentioned here, was a well-known physician and poet who speculated about life. Why does this chapter matter? The Preface sets up the tension between scientific plausibility and moral fable that runs through the whole work. Write down one question you want answered.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for tone / mood.
Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. I read a sentence, stop, and ask what the author is doing. When I see tone / mood, I underline it and write in the margin what effect it has. Here I notice the diction and the sentence rhythm, and I connect them to the author's stated purpose.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for Tone / mood, Theme, Allusion.
Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of tone / mood. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.

> *The event on which this fiction is founded, has been supposed, by Dr. Darwin, and some of the physiological writers of Germany, as not of impossible occurrence. I shall not be supposed as according the remotest degree of serious faith to such an imagination; yet, in assuming it as the basis of a work of fancy, I have not considered myself as merely weaving a series of supernatural terrors. The event on which the interest of the story depends is exempt from the disadvantages of a mere tale of spectres or enchantment. It was recommended by the novelty of the situations which it develops; and, however impossible as a physical fact, affords a point of view to the imagination for the delineating of human passions more comprehensive and commanding than any which the ordinary relations of existing events can yield.*

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their rigor.
Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Tone / mood, Theme, Allusion: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; your level is already set. Middle-school version: In "Preface," how does Shelley show the author's stated purpose? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the chapter, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the tone / mood you noticed as one piece of evidence. I will circulate and conference.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion (think-pair-share or a short Socratic circle).
Let's talk. Our question: How does this chapter connect to the costs of unchecked ambition? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
Take the chapter quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this chapter suggests about the author's stated purpose, backed by one short quotation.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how tone / mood shapes the author's stated purpose. Tonight, read the next chapter and add two words to your etymology log.

Total: 90 minutes.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (Webster's 1913)	In context	Etymology note
innovate	To bring in as new	*I have thus endeavoured to preserve the truth of the elementary principles of human nature, while I have not scrupled to innovate upon their combinations.*	"innovate": in- (Latin in-, "not" or "in") + nov (Latin novus, "new") + -ate (Latin -atus, "to make, having"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary.
scrupled	A weight of twenty grains	*I have thus endeavoured to preserve the truth of the elementary principles of human nature, while I have not scrupled to innovate upon their combinations.*	"scruple": no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin.
spectres	Something preternaturally visible	*The event on which the interest of the story depends is exempt from the disadvantages of a mere tale of spectres or enchantment.*	"spectre": spect (Latin specere, "to look"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary.
environs	The parts or places which surround another place, or lie in its neighborhood	*I passed the summer of 1816 in the environs of Geneva.*	"environs": en- (French en-/Latin in-, "into"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
disadvantages	Deprivation of advantage	*The event on which the interest of the story depends is exempt from the disadvantages of a mere tale of spectres or enchantment.*	"disadvantage": dis- (Latin dis-, "apart, not"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
elementary	Having only one principle or constituent part	*I have thus endeavoured to preserve the truth of the elementary principles of human nature, while I have not scrupled to innovate upon their combinations.*	"elementary": ment (Latin mens, "mind") + -ary (Latin -arius, "connected with"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary.
ghostly	Relating to the soul	*The weather, however, suddenly became serene; and my two friends left me on a journey among the Alps, and lost, in the magnificent scenes which they present, all memory of their ghostly visions.*	"ghostly": -ly (Old English -lice, "in the manner of"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
weaving	The act of one who, or that which, weaves	*I shall not be supposed as according the remotest degree of serious faith to such an imagination; yet, in assuming it as the basis of a work of fancy, I have not*	"weaving": -ing (Old English -ing, action). Root not in our table: have students find it.

		considered myself as merely weaving a series of supernatural terrors.	
occurrence	A coming or happening	*Darwin, and some of the physiological writers of Germany, as not of impossible occurrence.*	“occurrence”: cur (Latin cura, "care") + -ence (Latin -entia, "state of"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary.
expedient	Hastening or forward	*It was commenced partly as a source of amusement, and partly as an expedient for exercising any untried resources of mind.*	“expedient”: ex- (Latin ex, "out of") + ped (Latin pes/pedis, "foot") + -ent (Latin -ens, "one who, doing"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary.

Discussion questions

1. Why might an author defend the 'possibility' of a fantastic event before the story begins?
2. Where does tone / mood appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with creation and responsibility?

Annotation focus

- **Tone / mood:** look for word choices that reveal the narrator's attitude or the scene's feeling
- **Theme:** look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas
- **Allusion:** look for references to other books, myths, history or religion

Chapter quiz

1. Which scientist does the Preface mention as having supposed the event possible?
   A. Isaac Newton
   B. Galileo
   C. Humphry Davy
   D. Dr. Darwin
2. According to the Preface, what value does the story hope to display?
   A. The wealth of nations
   B. The glory of war
   C. The beauty of cities
   D. The amiableness of domestic affection
3. What kind of writing does the Preface compare the work to?
   A. Great works such as the Iliad and Shakespeare's plays
   B. Cookbooks
   C. Newspaper reports
   D. Sermons

4. What is the tone of the Preface?
   A. Angry and accusatory
   B. Measured and defensive of the book's seriousness
   C. Comic and mocking
   D. Romantic and lovesick
5. What season and weather does the Preface recall?
   A. A cold, rainy summer
   B. An autumn harvest
   C. A snowy winter in London
   D. A hot spring in Italy
6. In the line “I have thus endeavoured to preserve the truth of the elementary principles of human nature, while I have not scrupled to innovate upon their combinations.”, what does “innovate” most nearly mean?
   A. To bring in as new
   B. A weight of twenty grains
   C. The parts or places which surround another place, or lie in its neighborhood
   D. Something preternaturally visible
7. In the line “I have thus endeavoured to preserve the truth of the elementary principles of human nature, while I have not scrupled to innovate upon their combinations.”, what does “scrupled” most nearly mean?
   A. To bring in as new
   B. Something preternaturally visible
   C. The parts or places which surround another place, or lie in its neighborhood
   D. A weight of twenty grains

Answer key: 1. D (Dr. Darwin); 2. D (The amiableness of domestic affection); 3. A (Great works such as the Iliad and Shakespeare's plays); 4. B (Measured and defensive of the book's seriousness); 5. A (A cold, rainy summer); 6. A (To bring in as new); 7. D (A weight of twenty grains)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; RL.7.4, W.7.1): In “Preface,” how does Shelley show the author's stated purpose? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the chapter, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the tone / mood you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): In Preface, how does Shelley develop the idea of the author's stated purpose? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the tone / mood in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Preface develops the idea of the author's stated purpose. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of tone / mood and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Preface (where it begins, turns and ends) and its tone / mood shape the reader's understanding of the author's stated purpose. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Preface suggests about the author's stated purpose. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's tone / mood and theme), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; AP.RL.1, AP.W.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses tone / mood in Preface to complicate the reader's understanding of the author's stated purpose. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; CF.RL.1, CF.W.1): Situate Preface within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of the author's stated purpose responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; C2.RL.1, C2.W.1): Read Preface alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of the author's stated purpose follows or bends those conventions, using the tone / mood as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; C3.RL.1, C3.W.1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Preface and its treatment of the author's stated purpose. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's tone / mood and theme, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; C4.RL.1, C4.W.1): Develop a research argument that reads Preface as evidence for a larger claim about the author's stated purpose in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; GR.RL.1, GR.W.1): Develop an original argument that reads Preface as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of the author's stated purpose. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *The event on which the interest of the story depends is exempt from the disadvantages of a mere tale of spectres or enchantment.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “spectres” most nearly mean?

   A. The act of one who, or that which, weaves

   B. Something preternaturally visible

C. Hastening or forward

D. A coming or happening

2. *The event on which this fiction is founded, has been supposed, by Dr. Darwin, and some of the physiological writers of Germany, as not of impossible occurrence. I shall not be supposed as according the remotest degree of serious faith to such an imagination; yet, in assuming it as the basis of a work of fancy, I have not considered myself as merely weaving a series of supernatural terrors. The event on which the interest of the story depends is exempt from the disadvantages of a mere tale of spectres or enchantment. It was recommended by the novelty of the situations which it develops; and, however impossible as a physical fact, affords a point of view to the imagination for the delineating of human passions more comprehensive and commanding than any which the ordinary relations of existing events can yield.*

Which choice best states a central concern of "Preface"?

A. Loss and leaving home

B. Wisdom cannot be taught

C. Learning compassion by watching

D. The author's stated purpose

SAT key: 1. B (Something preternaturally visible); 2. D (The author's stated purpose)

Lesson 3: Letter I

Focus: ambition and the hunger for discovery

Teacher only · spoilers

Robert Walton writes to his sister Margaret Saville from St. Petersburg. He is about to sail toward the North Pole, eager to discover a passage and the secret of the magnet, and he describes his self-education and longing for glory.

Background: Arctic exploration and the search for a Northwest Passage were major public dreams in the early 1800s. Letters were a popular novel form (the epistolary novel).

Significance: Walton is Victor's double: an ambitious man willing to risk others for discovery. The frame narrative invites readers to judge whether he will learn from Victor.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Settle in and write for five minutes: What do Walton's dreams of the North Pole reveal about his character? No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
Today's words are enticement, fluctuate, effusions, satiate, foretaste. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check Webster's. Here is the first: "My life might have been passed in ease and luxury; but I preferred glory to every enticement that wealth placed in my path." Webster's says: The act or practice of alluring or tempting. Now the word history: "enticement": en- (French en-/Latin in-, "into") + -ment (Latin -mentum, "result or means of"). Root not in our table: have students find it. "fluctuate": luc (Latin lux, "light") + -ate (Latin -atus, "to make, having"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary. "effusion": -sion (Latin -sio, "the act of"). Root not in our table: have students find it. Add each root to your etymology log.

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Present the historical and literary background.
Here is what the first readers of Frankenstein would have known. Arctic exploration and the search for a Northwest Passage were major public dreams in the early 1800s. Letters were a popular novel form (the epistolary novel). Why does this chapter matter? Walton is Victor's double: an ambitious man willing to risk others for discovery. The frame narrative invites readers to judge whether he will learn from Victor. Write down one question you want answered.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for point of view.
Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. I read a sentence, stop, and ask what the author is doing. When I see point of view, I underline it and write in the margin what effect it has. Here I notice the diction and the sentence rhythm, and I connect them to ambition and the hunger for discovery.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for Point of view, Foreshadowing, Characterization.
Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of point of view. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.

> *You will rejoice to hear that no disaster has accompanied the commencement of an enterprise which you have regarded with such evil forebodings. I arrived here yesterday; and my first task is to assure my dear sister of my welfare, and increasing confidence in the success of my undertaking.*

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their rigor.
Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Point of view, Foreshadowing, Characterization: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; your level is already set. Middle-school version: In "Letter I," how does Shelley show ambition and the hunger for discovery? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the chapter, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the point of view you noticed as one piece of evidence. I will circulate and conference.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion (think-pair-share or a short Socratic circle).
Let's talk. Our question: How does this chapter connect to the costs of unchecked ambition? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
Take the chapter quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this chapter suggests about ambition and the hunger for discovery, backed by one short quotation.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how point of view shapes ambition and the hunger for discovery. Tonight, read the next chapter and add two words to your etymology log.

Total: 90 minutes.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (Webster's 1913)	In context	Etymology note
enticement			

	The act or practice of alluring or tempting	*My life might have been passed in ease and luxury; but I preferred glory to every enticement that wealth placed in my path.*	“enticement”: en- (French en-/ Latin in-, "into") + -ment (Latin -mentum, "result or means of"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
fluctuate	To move as a wave	*My courage and my resolution is firm; but my hopes fluctuate, and my spirits are often depressed.*	“fluctuate”: luc (Latin lux, "light") + -ate (Latin -atus, "to make, having"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary.
effusions	The act of pouring out	*These visions faded when I perused, for the first time, those poets whose effusions entranced my soul, and lifted it to heaven.*	“effusion”: -sion (Latin -sio, "the act of"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
satiate	Filled to satiety	*I shall satiate my ardent curiosity with the sight of a part of the world never before visited, and may tread a land never before imprinted by the foot of man.*	“satiate”: -ate (Latin -atus, "to make, having"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
foretaste	A taste beforehand	*This breeze, which has travelled from the regions towards which I am advancing, gives me a foretaste of those icy climes.*	“foretaste”: fore- (Old English fore, "before"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
entranced	The act of entering or going into	*These visions faded when I perused, for the first time, those poets whose effusions entranced my soul, and lifted it to heaven.*	“entrance”: en- (French en-/ Latin in-, "into"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
diffusing	To pour out and cause to spread, as a fluid	*There, Margaret, the sun is forever visible; its broad disk just skirting the horizon, and diffusing a perpetual splendour.*	“diffuse”: no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin.
sledges	A strong vehicle with low runners or low wheels	*They fly quickly over the snow in their sledges; the motion is pleasant, and, in my opinion, far more agreeable than that of an English stagecoach.*	“sledge”: no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin.
seafaring	Following the business of a mariner	*These volumes were my study day and night, and my familiarity with them increased that regret which I had felt, as a child, on learning that my father’s dying injunction had forbidden my uncle to allow me to embark in a seafaring life.*	“seafaring”: se- (Latin se-, "apart") + -ing (Old English -ing, action). Root not in our table: have students find it.
forebodings	Presage of coming ill	*You will rejoice to hear that no disaster has accompanied the commencement of an enterprise which you have regarded with such evil forebodings.*	“foreboding”: fore- (Old English fore, "before") + -ing (Old English -ing, action). Root not in our table: have students find it.

Discussion questions

1. What do Walton's dreams of the North Pole reveal about his character?
2. Where does point of view appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with isolation and the need for companionship?

Annotation focus

- **Point of view:** look for who is telling the story and what that narrator can and cannot know
- **Foreshadowing:** look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events
- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them

Chapter quiz

1. To whom is Walton writing?
   A. His sister, Margaret Saville
   B. Victor Frankenstein
   C. A ship's captain
   D. His father
2. Where is Walton when he writes the first letter?
   A. Archangel
   B. London
   C. Geneva
   D. St. Petersburg
3. What does Walton hope to discover?
   A. A cure for disease
   B. Gold in Siberia
   C. A lost city
   D. A passage near the pole and the secret of the magnet
4. How did Walton educate himself as a boy?
   A. Attending university in Paris
   B. Working in a laboratory
   C. Reading his uncle's library of voyages
   D. Studying law
5. What does Walton's ambition foreshadow?
   A. A war with Russia
   B. Victor's own dangerous pursuit of knowledge
   C. A happy marriage
   D. His return home rich

6. In the line “My life might have been passed in ease and luxury; but I preferred glory to every enticement that wealth placed in my path.”, what does “enticement” most nearly mean?
   A. The act or practice of alluring or tempting
   B. The act of pouring out
   C. To move as a wave
   D. Filled to satiety
7. In the line “My courage and my resolution is firm; but my hopes fluctuate, and my spirits are often depressed.”, what does “fluctuate” most nearly mean?
   A. The act of pouring out
   B. Filled to satiety
   C. To move as a wave
   D. The act or practice of alluring or tempting

Answer key: 1. A (His sister, Margaret Saville); 2. D (St. Petersburg); 3. D (A passage near the pole and the secret of the magnet); 4. C (Reading his uncle's library of voyages); 5. B (Victor's own dangerous pursuit of knowledge); 6. A (The act or practice of alluring or tempting); 7. C (To move as a wave)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; RL.7.6, W.7.1): In “Letter I,” how does Shelley show ambition and the hunger for discovery? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the chapter, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the point of view you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): In Letter I, how does Shelley develop the idea of ambition and the hunger for discovery? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the point of view in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Letter I develops the idea of ambition and the hunger for discovery. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of point of view and foreshadowing shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Letter I (where it begins, turns and ends) and its point of view shape the reader's understanding of ambition and the hunger for discovery. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Letter I suggests about ambition and the hunger for discovery. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's point of view and foreshadowing), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; AP.RL.3, AP.W.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses point of view in Letter I to complicate the reader's understanding of ambition and the hunger for discovery. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; CF.RL.3, CF.W.1): Situate Letter I within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of ambition and the hunger for discovery responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; C2.RL.3, C2.W.1): Read Letter I alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of ambition and the hunger for discovery follows or bends those conventions, using the point of view as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; C3.RL.3, C3.W.1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Letter I and its treatment of ambition and the hunger for discovery. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's point of view and foreshadowing, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; C4.RL.3, C4.W.1): Develop a research argument that reads Letter I as evidence for a larger claim about ambition and the hunger for discovery in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; GR.RL.3, GR.W.1): Develop an original argument that reads Letter I as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of ambition and the hunger for discovery. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *These visions faded when I perused, for the first time, those poets whose effusions entranced my soul, and lifted it to heaven.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “effusions” most nearly mean?

   A. A strong vehicle with low runners or low wheels

   B. Following the business of a mariner

   C. Presage of coming ill

   D. The act of pouring out

2. *You will rejoice to hear that no disaster has accompanied the commencement of an enterprise which you have regarded with such evil forebodings. I arrived here yesterday; and my first task is to assure my dear sister of my welfare, and increasing confidence in the success of my undertaking.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Letter I”?

   A. The pain of a father's love

   B. The first death and growing guilt

   C. Grief, prison and return

   D. Ambition and the hunger for discovery

SAT key: 1. D (The act of pouring out); 2. D (Ambition and the hunger for discovery)

Lesson 4: Letter II

Focus: loneliness and the desire for a friend

Teacher only · spoilers

From Archangel, Walton hires a ship and crew but confesses that he has no friend who shares his enthusiasm. He describes his master and lieutenant and promises Margaret he will not 'kill the albatross.'

Background: Coleridge's 'The Rime of the Ancient Mariner' (1798), alluded to here, was hugely popular; Mary Shelley heard Coleridge recite it as a child.

Significance: Walton's loneliness introduces the novel's central need: companionship. The albatross allusion warns of punishment for violating nature.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Settle in and write for five minutes: Why does Walton feel he needs a friend, and what kind of friend does he want? No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
Today's words are albatross, embarkation, amassed, unemployed, endowments. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check Webster's. Here is the first: "I am going to unexplored regions, to "the land of mist and snow"; but I shall kill no albatross, therefore do not be alarmed for my safety, or if I should come back to you as worn and woeful as the "Ancient Mariner."" Webster's says: A web-footed bird, of the genus Diomedea, of which there are several species. Now the word history: "albatross": no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin. "embarkation": em- (French en-/Latin in-, "into") + bark (Late Latin barca, "small boat") + -ation (Latin -atio, "the act or result of"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary. "amass": mass (Latin massa, "lump"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary. Add each root to your etymology log.

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Present the historical and literary background.
Here is what the first readers of Frankenstein would have known. Coleridge's 'The Rime of the Ancient Mariner' (1798), alluded to here, was hugely popular; Mary Shelley heard Coleridge recite it as a child. Why does this chapter matter? Walton's loneliness introduces the novel's central need: companionship. The albatross allusion warns of punishment for violating nature. Write down one question you want answered.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for characterization.
Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. I read a sentence, stop, and ask what the author is doing. When I see characterization, I underline it and write in the margin what effect it has. Here I notice the diction and the sentence rhythm, and I connect them to loneliness and the desire for a friend.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for Characterization, Theme, Tone / mood.
Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of characterization. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.

> *How slowly the time passes here, encompassed as I am by frost and snow; yet a second step is taken towards my enterprise. I have hired a vessel, and am occupied in collecting my sailors; those whom I have already engaged, appear to be men on whom I can depend, and are certainly possessed of dauntless courage.*

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their rigor.
Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Characterization, Theme, Tone / mood: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; your level is already set. Middle-school version: In "Letter II," how does Shelley show loneliness and the desire for a friend? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the chapter, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence. I will circulate and conference.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion (think-pair-share or a short Socratic circle).
Let's talk. Our question: How does this chapter connect to the costs of unchecked ambition? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
Take the chapter quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this chapter suggests about loneliness and the desire for a friend, backed by one short quotation.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how characterization shapes loneliness and the desire for a friend. Tonight, read the next chapter and add two words to your etymology log.

Total: 90 minutes.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (Webster's 1913)	In context	Etymology note

albatross	A web-footed bird, of the genus Diomedea, of which there are several species	*I am going to unexplored regions, to "the land of mist and snow"; but I shall kill no albatross, therefore do not be alarmed for my safety, or if I should come back to you as worn and woeful as the "Ancient Mariner."*	"albatross": no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin.
embarkation	The act of putting or going on board of a vessel	*Those are as fixed as fate; and my voyage is only now delayed until the weather shall permit my embarkation.*	"embarkation": em- (French en-/Latin in-, "into") + bark (Late Latin barca, "small boat") + -ation (Latin -atio, "the act or result of"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary.
amassed	To collect into a mass or heap	*Some years ago, he loved a young Russian lady, of moderate fortune; and having amassed a considerable sum in prize-money, the father of the girl consented to the match.*	"amass": mass (Latin massa, "lump"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary.
unemployed	Nor employed in manual or other labor	*I first became acquainted with him on board a whale vessel: finding that he was unemployed in this city, I easily engaged him to assist in my enterprise.*	"unemployed": un- (Old English un-, "not") + ploy (Latin plicare, "to fold" (via French employer)) + -ed (Old English -ed, past or "having"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary.
endowments	The act of bestowing a dower, fund, or permanent provision for support	*He is an Englishman, and in the midst of national and professional prejudices, unsoftened by cultivation, retains some of the noblest endowments of humanity.*	"endowment": en- (French en-/Latin in-, "into") + dow (Latin dotare, "to endow, give") + -ment (Latin -mentum, "result or means of"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary.
illiterate	Ignorant of letters or books	*Now I am twenty-eight, and am in reality more illiterate than many schoolboys of fifteen.*	"illiterate": il- (Latin in-, "not") + liter (Latin littera, "letter") + -ate (Latin -atus, "to make, having"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary.
encompassed	To circumscribe or go round so as to surround closely	*How slowly the time passes here, encompassed as I am by frost and snow; yet a second step is taken towards my enterprise.*	"encompass": en- (French en-/Latin in-, "into") + pass (Latin passus, "step"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary.
retains	To continue to hold	*He is an Englishman, and in the midst of national and professional prejudices, unsoftened by cultivation, retains some of the noblest endowments of humanity.*	"retain": re- (Latin re-, "back, again") + tain (Latin tenere, "to hold"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary.

mildness	The quality or state of being mild	*The master is a person of an excellent disposition, and is remarkable in the ship for his gentleness and the mildness of his discipline.*	“mildness”: mild (Old English milde, "gentle") + -ness (Old English -ness, "state of"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary.
voyages	Formerly, a passage either by sea or land	*But it is a still greater evil to me that I am self-educated: for the first fourteen years of my life I ran wild on a common, and read nothing but our uncle Thomas's books of voyages.*	“voyage”: voy (Latin via, "way" (via French voyage)). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary.

Discussion questions

1. Why does Walton feel he needs a friend, and what kind of friend does he want?
2. Where does characterization appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with nature versus nurture?

Annotation focus

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- **Theme:** look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas
- **Tone / mood:** look for word choices that reveal the narrator's attitude or the scene's feeling

Chapter quiz

1. What does Walton say he lacks most?
   A. A friend who shares his feelings
   B. A ship
   C. Money for the voyage
   D. Maps of the Arctic
2. Which poem does Walton allude to?
   A. The Iliad
   B. The Rime of the Ancient Mariner
   C. Hamlet
   D. Paradise Lost
3. From what port does Walton write this letter?
   A. Geneva
   B. Lisbon
   C. Archangel
   D. Ingolstadt
4. What theme is introduced by his longing?
   A. The love of money
   B. The evils of travel

C. The joy of solitude

D. The need for companionship

5. How does Walton describe his crew's master?

A. A former pirate

B. Kind and gentle, remarkable for mildness

C. Lazy and drunk

D. Cruel and violent

6. In the line “I am going to unexplored regions, to “the land of mist and snow”; but I shall kill no albatross, therefore do not be alarmed for my safety, or if I should come back to you as worn and woeful as the “Ancient Mariner.””, what does “albatross” most nearly mean?

A. To collect into a mass or heap

B. Nor employed in manual or other labor

C. The act of putting or going on board of a vessel

D. A web-footed bird, of the genus Diomedea, of which there are several species

7. In the line “Those are as fixed as fate; and my voyage is only now delayed until the weather shall permit my embarkation.”, what does “embarkation” most nearly mean?

A. To collect into a mass or heap

B. The act of putting or going on board of a vessel

C. A web-footed bird, of the genus Diomedea, of which there are several species

D. Nor employed in manual or other labor

Answer key: 1. A (A friend who shares his feelings); 2. B (The Rime of the Ancient Mariner); 3. C (Archangel); 4. D (The need for companionship); 5. B (Kind and gentle, remarkable for mildness); 6. D (A web-footed bird, of the genus Diomedea, of which there are several species); 7. B (The act of putting or going on board of a vessel)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; RL.7.3, W.7.1): In “Letter II,” how does Shelley show loneliness and the desire for a friend? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the chapter, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In Letter II, how does Shelley develop the idea of loneliness and the desire for a friend? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the characterization in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Letter II develops the idea of loneliness and the desire for a friend. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Letter II (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's understanding of loneliness and the desire for a friend.

Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Letter II suggests about loneliness and the desire for a friend. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's characterization and theme), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; AP.RL.2, AP.W.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses characterization in Letter II to complicate the reader's understanding of loneliness and the desire for a friend. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; CF.RL.2, CF.W.1): Situate Letter II within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of loneliness and the desire for a friend responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; C2.RL.2, C2.W.1): Read Letter II alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of loneliness and the desire for a friend follows or bends those conventions, using the characterization as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; C3.RL.2, C3.W.1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Letter II and its treatment of loneliness and the desire for a friend. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's characterization and theme, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; C4.RL.2, C4.W.1): Develop a research argument that reads Letter II as evidence for a larger claim about loneliness and the desire for a friend in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; GR.RL.2, GR.W.1): Develop an original argument that reads Letter II as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of loneliness and the desire for a friend. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *Some years ago, he loved a young Russian lady, of moderate fortune; and having amassed a considerable sum in prize-money, the father of the girl consented to the match.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “amassed” most nearly mean?

   A. The quality or state of being mild

   B. Formerly, a passage either by sea or land

C. To continue to hold

D. To collect into a mass or heap

2. *How slowly the time passes here, encompassed as I am by frost and snow; yet a second step is taken towards my enterprise. I have hired a vessel, and am occupied in collecting my sailors; those whom I have already engaged, appear to be men on whom I can depend, and are certainly possessed of dauntless courage.*

Which choice best states a central concern of "Letter II"?

A. Neighbors and gossip

B. Trusted relatives

C. Loneliness and the desire for a friend

D. The origin of the novel and the idea of creation

SAT key: 1. D (To collect into a mass or heap); 2. C (Loneliness and the desire for a friend)

Lesson 5: Letter III

Focus: confidence before danger

Teacher only · spoilers

A brief letter: Walton reports that he is safe and well advanced on his voyage. He is full of confidence and determination despite floating ice.

Background: Short letters between long ones create pacing and suspense, a technique common in epistolary fiction.

Significance: Walton's optimism makes the coming crisis feel more dramatic and ironic.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Settle in and write for five minutes: Why might Shelley include such a short, cheerful letter here? No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
Today's words are pathless, tracing, indicating, homeward, incidents. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check Webster's. Here is the first: "Thus far I have gone, tracing a secure way over the pathless seas: the very stars themselves being witnesses and testimonies of my triumph." Webster's says: Having no beaten path or way. Now the word history: "pathless": path (Greek pathos, "feeling, suffering") + -less (Old English -leas, "without"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary. "tracing": -ing (Old English -ing, action). Root not in our table: have students find it. "indicate": in- (Latin in-, "not" or "in") + -ate (Latin -atus, "to make, having"). Root not in our table: have students find it. Add each root to your etymology log.

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Present the historical and literary background.
Here is what the first readers of Frankenstein would have known. Short letters between long ones create pacing and suspense, a technique common in epistolary fiction. Why does this chapter matter? Walton's optimism makes the coming crisis feel more dramatic and ironic. Write down one question you want answered.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for tone / mood.
Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. I read a sentence, stop, and ask what the author is doing. When I see tone / mood, I underline it and write in the margin what effect it has. Here I notice the diction and the sentence rhythm, and I connect them to confidence before danger.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for Tone / mood, Foreshadowing, Setting.
Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of tone / mood. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.

> *No incidents have hitherto befallen us that would make a figure in a letter. One or two stiff gales, and the springing of a leak, are accidents which experienced navigators scarcely remember to record; and I shall be well content if nothing worse happen to us during our voyage.*

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their rigor.
Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Tone / mood, Foreshadowing, Setting: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; your level is already set. Middle-school version: In "Letter III," how does Shelley show confidence before danger? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the chapter, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the tone / mood you noticed as one piece of evidence. I will circulate and conference.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion (think-pair-share or a short Socratic circle).
Let's talk. Our question: How does this chapter connect to the costs of unchecked ambition? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
Take the chapter quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this chapter suggests about confidence before danger, backed by one short quotation.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how tone / mood shapes confidence before danger. Tonight, read the next chapter and add two words to your etymology log.

Total: 90 minutes.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (Webster's 1913)	In context	Etymology note
pathless	Having no beaten path or way	*Thus far I have gone, tracing a secure way over the pathless seas: the very stars themselves being witnesses and testimonies of my triumph.*	"pathless": path (Greek pathos, "feeling, suffering") + -less (Old English -leas, "without"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary.
tracing			

	The act of one who traces	*Thus far I have gone, tracing a secure way over the pathless seas: the very stars themselves being witnesses and testimonies of my triumph.*	“tracing”: -ing (Old English -ing, action). Root not in our table: have students find it.
indicating	To point out	*I am, however, in good spirits: my men are bold, and apparently firm of purpose; nor do the floating sheets of ice that continually pass us, indicating the dangers of the region towards which we are advancing, appear to dismay them.*	“indicate”: in- (Latin in-, "not" or "in") + -ate (Latin -atus, "to make, having"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
homeward	Being in the direction of home	*This letter will reach England by a merchantman now on its homeward voyage from Archangel; more fortunate than I, who may not see my native land, perhaps, for many years.*	“homeward”: ard (Latin ardere, "to burn"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary.
incidents	Falling or striking upon, as a ray of light upon a reflecting surface	*No incidents have hitherto befallen us that would make a figure in a letter.*	“incident”: in- (Latin in-, "not" or "in") + -ent (Latin -ens, "one who, doing"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
accidents	Literally, a befalling	*One or two stiff gales, and the springing of a leak, are accidents which experienced navigators scarcely remember to record; and I shall be well content if nothing worse happen to us during our voyage.*	“accident”: ac- (Latin ad, "to") + -ent (Latin -ens, "one who, doing"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
obedient	Subject in will or act to authority	*Why not still proceed over the untamed yet obedient element?*	“obedient”: ob- (Latin ob, "against, toward") + -ent (Latin -ens, "one who, doing"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
floating	Buoyed upon or in a fluid	*I am, however, in good spirits: my men are bold, and apparently firm of purpose; nor do the floating sheets of ice that continually pass us, indicating the dangers of the region towards which we are advancing, appear to dismay them.*	“floating”: -ing (Old English -ing, action). Root not in our table: have students find it.
prudent	Sagacious in adapting means to ends	*I will be cool, persevering, and prudent.*	“prudent”: -ent (Latin -ens, "one who, doing"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
advancing	To bring forward	*I am, however, in good spirits: my men are bold, and apparently firm of purpose; nor do the floating sheets of ice that continually pass us, indicating the dangers of the region towards which we are advancing, appear to dismay them.*	“advance”: ad- (Latin ad, "to, toward"). Root not in our table: have students find it.

Discussion questions

1. Why might Shelley include such a short, cheerful letter here?
2. Where does tone / mood appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with the sublime power of nature?

Annotation focus

- **Tone / mood:** look for word choices that reveal the narrator's attitude or the scene's feeling
- **Foreshadowing:** look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events
- **Setting:** look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling

Chapter quiz

1. How does Walton feel in Letter III?
   A. Ill and weak
   B. Confident and determined
   C. Ready to turn back
   D. Terrified
2. What danger does he mention seeing?
   A. Floating sheets of ice
   B. A pirate ship
   C. A whale attack
   D. A volcano
3. What is the main purpose of this letter?
   A. To announce his marriage
   B. To ask for money
   C. To reassure Margaret he is safe
   D. To describe Victor
4. What does Walton's confidence create for the reader?
   A. Dramatic irony and suspense
   B. Boredom
   C. Comedy
   D. Certainty of success
5. Which word best describes Walton's attitude?
   A. Defeated
   B. Resolute
   C. Regretful
   D. Indifferent
6. In the line “Thus far I have gone, tracing a secure way over the pathless seas: the very stars themselves being witnesses and testimonies of my triumph.”, what does “pathless” most nearly mean?
   A. To point out

B. Being in the direction of home

C. The act of one who traces

D. Having no beaten path or way

7. In the line “Thus far I have gone, tracing a secure way over the pathless seas: the very stars themselves being witnesses and testimonies of my triumph.”, what does “tracing” most nearly mean?

A. The act of one who traces

B. Having no beaten path or way

C. Being in the direction of home

D. To point out

Answer key: 1. B (Confident and determined); 2. A (Floating sheets of ice); 3. C (To reassure Margaret he is safe); 4. A (Dramatic irony and suspense); 5. B (Resolute); 6. D (Having no beaten path or way); 7. A (The act of one who traces)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; RL.7.4, W.7.1): In “Letter III,” how does Shelley show confidence before danger? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the chapter, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the tone / mood you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): In Letter III, how does Shelley develop the idea of confidence before danger? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the tone / mood in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Letter III develops the idea of confidence before danger. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of tone / mood and foreshadowing shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Letter III (where it begins, turns and ends) and its tone / mood shape the reader's understanding of confidence before danger. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Letter III suggests about confidence before danger. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's tone / mood and foreshadowing), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; AP.RL.1, AP.W.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses tone / mood in Letter III to complicate the reader's understanding of confidence before danger. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; CF.RL.1, CF.W.1): Situate Letter III within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of confidence before danger responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; C2.RL.1, C2.W.1): Read Letter III alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of confidence before danger follows or bends those conventions, using the tone / mood as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; C3.RL.1, C3.W.1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Letter III and its treatment of confidence before danger. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's tone / mood and foreshadowing, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; C4.RL.1, C4.W.1): Develop a research argument that reads Letter III as evidence for a larger claim about confidence before danger in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; GR.RL.1, GR.W.1): Develop an original argument that reads Letter III as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of confidence before danger. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *I am, however, in good spirits: my men are bold, and apparently firm of purpose; nor do the floating sheets of ice that continually pass us, indicating the dangers of the region towards which we are advancing, appear to dismay them.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “indicating” most nearly mean?

   A. To point out
   B. Buoyed upon or in a fluid
   C. Sagacious in adapting means to ends
   D. To bring forward

2. *No incidents have hitherto befallen us that would make a figure in a letter. One or two stiff gales, and the springing of a leak, are accidents which experienced navigators scarcely remember to record; and I shall be well content if nothing worse happen to us during our voyage.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Letter III”?

   A. The Brighton plan
   B. Parental conflict over the refusal
   C. Doubts and preparations
   D. Confidence before danger

SAT key: 1. A (To point out); 2. D (Confidence before danger)

Lesson 6: Letter IV

Focus: the meeting of two ambitious men

Teacher only · spoilers

Trapped in ice, Walton's crew sees a giant figure on a dog sled, and the next morning rescues a frozen, exhausted stranger: Victor Frankenstein. Victor recovers slowly, becomes Walton's friend, and, hearing of Walton's ambition, agrees to tell his own story as a warning.

Background: The frame (Walton) now opens into Victor's narrative, a 'story within a story' structure called a nested or frame narrative.

Significance: Victor's warning, 'Learn from me,' makes the whole novel a cautionary tale addressed to Walton and to the reader.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Settle in and write for five minutes: Victor says he will tell his story so Walton may learn from it. What lesson do you predict? No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
Today's words are capitulated, tutored, telescopes, rawness, eventual. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check Webster's. Here is the first: "Margaret, if you had seen the man who thus capitulated for his safety, your surprise would have been boundless." Webster's says: To settle or draw up the heads or terms of an agreement, as in chapters or articles. Now the word history: "capitulate": cap (Latin capere, "to take") + -ate (Latin -atus, "to make, having"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary. "tutor": -or (Latin -or, "one who"). Root not in our table: have students find it. "telescope": no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin. Add each root to your etymology log.

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Present the historical and literary background.
Here is what the first readers of Frankenstein would have known. The frame (Walton) now opens into Victor's narrative, a 'story within a story' structure called a nested or frame narrative. Why does this chapter matter? Victor's warning, 'Learn from me,' makes the whole novel a cautionary tale addressed to Walton and to the reader. Write down one question you want answered.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for foreshadowing.
Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. I read a sentence, stop, and ask what the author is doing. When I see foreshadowing, I underline it and write in the margin what effect it has. Here I notice the diction and the sentence rhythm, and I connect them to the meeting of two ambitious men.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for Foreshadowing, Characterization, Point of view.
Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of foreshadowing. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.

> *About two o'clock the mist cleared away, and we beheld, stretched out in every direction, vast and irregular plains of ice, which seemed to have no end. Some of my comrades groaned, and my own mind began to grow watchful with anxious thoughts, when a strange sight suddenly attracted our attention, and diverted our solicitude from our own situation. We perceived a low carriage, fixed on a sledge and drawn by dogs, pass on towards the north, at the distance of half a mile: a being which had the shape of a man, but apparently of gigantic stature, sat in the sledge, and guided the dogs. We watched the rapid progress of the traveller with our telescopes, until he was lost among the distant inequalities of the ice.*

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their rigor.
Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Foreshadowing, Characterization, Point of view: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; your level is already set. Middle-school version: In "Letter IV," how does Shelley show the meeting of two ambitious men? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the chapter, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the foreshadowing you noticed as one piece of evidence. I will circulate and conference.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion (think-pair-share or a short Socratic circle).
Let's talk. Our question: How does this chapter connect to the costs of unchecked ambition? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
Take the chapter quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this chapter suggests about the meeting of two ambitious men, backed by one short quotation.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how foreshadowing shapes the meeting of two ambitious men. Tonight, read the next chapter and add two words to your etymology log.

Total: 90 minutes.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (Webster's 1913)	In context	Etymology note
capitulated	To settle or draw up the heads or terms of an agreement, as in chapters or articles	*Margaret, if you had seen the man who thus capitulated for his safety, your surprise would have been boundless.*	"capitulate": cap (Latin capere, "to take") + -ate (Latin -atus, "to make, having"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary.
tutored	One who guards, protects, watches over, or has the care of, some person or thing	*You have been tutored and refined by books and retirement from the world, and you are, therefore, somewhat fastidious; but this only renders you the more fit to appreciate the extraordinary merits of this wonderful man.*	"tutor": -or (Latin -or, "one who"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
telescopes	An optical instrument used in viewing distant objects, as the heavenly bodies	*We watched the rapid progress of the traveller with our telescopes, until he was lost among the distant inequalities of the ice.*	"telescope": no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin.
rawness	The quality or state of being raw	*He manifested the greatest eagerness to be upon deck, to watch for the sledge which had before appeared; but I have persuaded him to remain in the cabin, for he is far too weak to sustain the rawness of the atmosphere.*	"rawness": -ness (Old English -ness, "state of"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
eventual	Coming or happening as a consequence or result	*He entered attentively into all my arguments in favour of my eventual success, and into every minute detail of the measures I had taken to secure it.*	"eventual": vent (Latin venire, "to come") + -al (Latin -alis, "relating to"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary.
irradiated	To throw rays of light upon	*Even now, as I commence my task, his full-toned voice swells in my ears; his lustrous eyes dwell on me with all their melancholy sweetness; I see his thin hand raised in animation, while the lineaments of his face are irradiated by the soul within.*	"irradiate": ir- (Latin in-, "not") + -ate (Latin -atus, "to make, having"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
benevolently	Having a disposition to do good	*"And yet you rescued me from a strange and perilous situation; you have benevolently restored me to life."*	"benevolent": bene- (Latin bene, "well") + -ent (Latin -ens, "one who, doing"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
conciliating	To win ower	*Yet his manners are so conciliating and gentle, that the sailors are all interested in*	"conciliate": con- (Latin com-, "with, together") + -ate (Latin -atus, "to make, having"). Root

		him, although they have had very little communication with him.	not in our table: have students find it.
oppresses	To impose excessive burdens upon	*But he is generally melancholy and despairing; and sometimes he gnashes his teeth, as if impatient of the weight of woes that oppresses him.*	"oppress": no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin.
trickle	To flow in a small, gentle stream	*At first I perceived that he tried to suppress his emotion; he placed his hands before his eyes; and my voice quivered and failed me, as I beheld tears trickle fast from between his fingers—a groan burst from his heaving breast.*	"trickle": no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin.

Discussion questions

1. Victor says he will tell his story so Walton may learn from it. What lesson do you predict?
2. Where does foreshadowing appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with the costs of unchecked ambition?

Annotation focus

- **Foreshadowing:** look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events
- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- **Point of view:** look for who is telling the story and what that narrator can and cannot know

Chapter quiz

1. What does the crew first see on the ice?
   A. A polar bear
   B. A lost ship
   C. A gigantic figure on a dog sled
   D. A fire
2. Who is rescued from the ice?
   A. A Russian sailor
   B. Victor Frankenstein
   C. The creature
   D. Henry Clerval
3. Why does Victor decide to tell his story?
   A. To earn passage home
   B. Because he is dying of fever
   C. To confess a theft
   D. To warn Walton about dangerous ambition

4. How does Walton feel toward the stranger?
   A. He admires and loves him like a brother
   B. He fears him
   C. He distrusts him
   D. He ignores him
5. What narrative structure begins here?
   A. A single third-person narrator
   B. A frame narrative with a story within a story
   C. A play
   D. A diary only
6. In the line "Margaret, if you had seen the man who thus capitulated for his safety, your surprise would have been boundless.", what does "capitulated" most nearly mean?
   A. One who guards, protects, watches over, or has the care of, some person or thing
   B. An optical instrument used in viewing distant objects, as the heavenly bodies
   C. To settle or draw up the heads or terms of an agreement, as in chapters or articles
   D. The quality or state of being raw
7. In the line "You have been tutored and refined by books and retirement from the world, and you are, therefore, somewhat fastidious; but this only renders you the more fit to appreciate the extraordinary merits of this wonderful man.", what does "tutored" most nearly mean?
   A. The quality or state of being raw
   B. One who guards, protects, watches over, or has the care of, some person or thing
   C. An optical instrument used in viewing distant objects, as the heavenly bodies
   D. To settle or draw up the heads or terms of an agreement, as in chapters or articles

Answer key: 1. C (A gigantic figure on a dog sled); 2. B (Victor Frankenstein); 3. D (To warn Walton about dangerous ambition); 4. A (He admires and loves him like a brother); 5. B (A frame narrative with a story within a story); 6. C (To settle or draw up the heads or terms of an agreement, as in chapters or articles); 7. B (One who guards, protects, watches over, or has the care of, some person or thing)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; RL.7.5, W.7.1): In "Letter IV," how does Shelley show the meeting of two ambitious men? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the chapter, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the foreshadowing you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1): In Letter IV, how does Shelley develop the idea of the meeting of two ambitious men? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the foreshadowing in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Letter IV develops the idea of the meeting of two ambitious men. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of foreshadowing and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Letter IV (where it begins, turns and ends) and its foreshadowing shape the reader's understanding of the meeting of two ambitious men. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Letter IV suggests about the meeting of two ambitious men. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's foreshadowing and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; AP.RL.3, AP.W.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses foreshadowing in Letter IV to complicate the reader's understanding of the meeting of two ambitious men. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; CF.RL.3, CF.W.1): Situate Letter IV within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of the meeting of two ambitious men responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; C2.RL.3, C2.W.1): Read Letter IV alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of the meeting of two ambitious men follows or bends those conventions, using the foreshadowing as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; C3.RL.3, C3.W.1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Letter IV and its treatment of the meeting of two ambitious men. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's foreshadowing and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; C4.RL.3, C4.W.1): Develop a research argument that reads Letter IV as evidence for a larger claim about the meeting of two ambitious men in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; GR.RL.3, GR.W.1): Develop an original argument that reads Letter IV as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of the meeting of two ambitious men. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *We watched the rapid progress of the traveller with our telescopes, until he was lost among the distant inequalities of the ice.*

As used in the text, what does the word "telescopes" most nearly mean?

A. To impose excessive burdens upon

B. An optical instrument used in viewing distant objects, as the heavenly bodies

C. To flow in a small, gentle stream

D. To win ower

2. *About two o'clock the mist cleared away, and we beheld, stretched out in every direction, vast and irregular plains of ice, which seemed to have no end. Some of my comrades groaned, and my own mind began to grow watchful with anxious thoughts, when a strange sight suddenly attracted our attention, and diverted our solicitude from our own situation. We perceived a low carriage, fixed on a sledge and drawn by dogs, pass on towards the north, at the distance of half a mile: a being which had the shape of a man, but apparently of gigantic stature, sat in the sledge, and guided the dogs. We watched the rapid progress of the traveller with our telescopes, until he was lost among the distant inequalities of the ice.*

Which choice best states a central concern of "Letter IV"?

A. The first spark of obsession

B. The accomplished woman

C. Marriage as a social goal

D. The meeting of two ambitious men

SAT key: 1. B (An optical instrument used in viewing distant objects, as the heavenly bodies); 2. D (The meeting of two ambitious men)

Lesson 7: Chapter I

Focus: a privileged childhood and family love

Teacher only · spoilers

Victor describes his Genevese family: his father Alphonse, his mother Caroline (rescued from poverty), and the adopted Elizabeth Lavenza, whom his mother gives him as a 'present.' His childhood is loving and protected.

Background: Geneva was an independent republic known for Calvinism and civic pride; Rousseau, a Genevan, influenced ideas of education and nature.

Significance: Victor's ideal upbringing contrasts sharply with the creature's abandonment, raising the nature-versus-nurture question.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Settle in and write for five minutes: How does Victor's childhood compare with what a newly created being might need? No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
Today's words are foldings, vagrants, decreasing, chamois, dungeons. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check Webster's. Here is the first: “During one of their walks a poor cot in the foldings of a vale attracted their notice, as being singularly disconsolate, while the number of half-clothed children gathered about it, spoke of penury in its worst shape.” Webster's says: The act of making a fold or folds. Now the word history: “folding”: -ing (Old English -ing, action). Root not in our table: have students find it. “vagrant”: vag (Latin vagari, "to wander") + -ant (Latin -ans, "one who, doing"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary. “decreasing”: de- (Latin de, "down from, away") + -ing (Old English -ing, action). Root not in our table: have students find it. Add each root to your etymology log.

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Present the historical and literary background.
Here is what the first readers of Frankenstein would have known. Geneva was an independent republic known for Calvinism and civic pride; Rousseau, a Genevan, influenced ideas of education and nature. Why does this chapter matter? Victor's ideal upbringing contrasts sharply with the creature's abandonment, raising the nature-versus-nurture question. Write down one question you want answered.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for characterization.
Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. I read a sentence, stop, and ask what the author is doing. When I see characterization, I underline it and write in the margin what effect it has. Here I notice the diction and the sentence rhythm, and I connect them to a privileged childhood and family love.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for Characterization, Setting, Foreshadowing.
Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of characterization. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.

> *His daughter attended him with the greatest tenderness; but she saw with despair that their little fund was rapidly decreasing, and that there was no other prospect of support. But Caroline Beaufort possessed a mind of an uncommon mould; and her courage rose to support her in her adversity. She procured plain work; she plaited straw; and by various means contrived to earn a pittance scarcely sufficient to support life.*

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their rigor.
Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Characterization, Setting, Foreshadowing: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; your level is already set. Middle-school version: In "Chapter I," how does Shelley show a privileged childhood and family love? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the chapter, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence. I will circulate and conference.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion (think-pair-share or a short Socratic circle).
Let's talk. Our question: How does this chapter connect to the costs of unchecked ambition? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
Take the chapter quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this chapter suggests about a privileged childhood and family love, backed by one short quotation.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how characterization shapes a privileged childhood and family love. Tonight, read the next chapter and add two words to your etymology log.

Total: 90 minutes.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word		In context	Etymology note

	Definition (Webster's 1913)		
foldings	The act of making a fold or folds	*During one of their walks a poor cot in the foldings of a vale attracted their notice, as being singularly disconsolate, while the number of half-clothed children gathered about it, spoke of penury in its worst shape.*	"folding": -ing (Old English -ing, action). Root not in our table: have students find it.
vagrants	Moving without certain direction	*The four others were dark-eyed, hardy little vagrants; this child was thin, and very fair.*	"vagrant": vag (Latin vagari, "to wander") + -ant (Latin -ans, "one who, doing"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary.
decreasing	Becoming less and less	*His daughter attended him with the greatest tenderness; but she saw with despair that their little fund was rapidly decreasing, and that there was no other prospect of support.*	"decreasing": de- (Latin de, "down from, away") + -ing (Old English -ing, action). Root not in our table: have students find it.
chamois	(Zoöl.) A small species of antelope (Rupicapra tragus), living on the loftiest mountain ridges of Europe, as the…	*When my father returned from Milan, he found playing with me in the hall of our villa, a child fairer than pictured cherub —a creature who seemed to shed radiance from her looks, and whose form and motions were lighter than the chamois of the hills.*	"chamois": no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin.
dungeons	A close, dark prison, commondonjon or keep of a castle, these being used as prisons	*Whether he had died, or still lingered in the dungeons of Austria, was not known.*	"dungeon": no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin.
rambles	To walk, ride, or sail, from place to place, without any determinate object in view	*I, their eldest child, was born at Naples, and as an infant accompanied them in their rambles.*	"ramble": no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin.
interment	The act or ceremony of depositing a dead body in the earth	*He came like a protecting spirit to the poor girl, who committed herself to his care; and after the interment of his friend, he conducted her to Geneva, and placed her under the protection of a relation.*	"interment": inter- (Latin inter, "between") + ment (Latin mens, "mind"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary.
pittance		*She procured plain work; she plaited straw; and by various means contrived to*	"pittance": -ance (Latin -antia, "state of"). Root not in

	An allowance of food bestowed in charity	*earn a pittance scarcely sufficient to support life.*	our table: have students find it.
confiscated	Seized and appropriated by the government to the public use	*His property was confiscated, his child became an orphan and a beggar.*	“confiscate”: con- (Latin com-, "with, together") + -ate (Latin -atus, "to make, having"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
deplored	To feel or to express deep and poignant grief for	*He bitterly deplored the false pride which led his friend to a conduct so little worthy of the affection that united them.*	“deplore”: de- (Latin de, "down from, away") + plor (Latin plorare, "to wail"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary.

Discussion questions

1. How does Victor's childhood compare with what a newly created being might need?
2. Where does characterization appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with creation and responsibility?

Annotation focus

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- **Setting:** look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling
- **Foreshadowing:** look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events

Chapter quiz

1. Where is Victor's family from?
   A. Paris
   B. Naples
   C. London
   D. Geneva
2. How does Elizabeth join the family?
   A. She is adopted from a poor Italian family
   B. She is a cousin from England
   C. She is a servant
   D. She is Victor's sister by birth
3. How does Victor's mother describe Elizabeth to him?
   A. As a pretty present for him
   B. As a burden
   C. As his teacher
   D. As a dangerous stranger

4. What kind of childhood does Victor have?
   A. Spent at sea
   B. Cruel and poor
   C. Lonely and neglected
   D. Loving and sheltered
5. Why is this childhood important to the novel?
   A. It contrasts with the creature's abandonment
   B. It shows Victor's poverty
   C. It explains Walton's voyage
   D. It introduces the North Pole
6. In the line “During one of their walks a poor cot in the foldings of a vale attracted their notice, as being singularly disconsolate, while the number of half-clothed children gathered about it, spoke of penury in its worst shape.”, what does “foldings” most nearly mean?
   A. Becoming less and less
   B. Moving without certain direction
   C. The act of making a fold or folds
   D. (Zoöl.) A small species of antelope (Rupicapra tragus), living on the loftiest mountain ridges of Europe, as the…
7. In the line “The four others were dark-eyed, hardy little vagrants; this child was thin, and very fair.”, what does “vagrants” most nearly mean?
   A. The act of making a fold or folds
   B. Moving without certain direction
   C. Becoming less and less
   D. (Zoöl.) A small species of antelope (Rupicapra tragus), living on the loftiest mountain ridges of Europe, as the…

Answer key: 1. D (Geneva); 2. A (She is adopted from a poor Italian family); 3. A (As a pretty present for him); 4. D (Loving and sheltered); 5. A (It contrasts with the creature's abandonment); 6. C (The act of making a fold or folds); 7. B (Moving without certain direction)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; RL.7.3, W.7.1): In “Chapter I,” how does Shelley show a privileged childhood and family love? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the chapter, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In Chapter I, how does Shelley develop the idea of a privileged childhood and family love? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the characterization in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Chapter I develops the idea of a privileged childhood and family love. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and

explain how the author's use of characterization and setting shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Chapter I (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's understanding of a privileged childhood and family love. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Chapter I suggests about a privileged childhood and family love. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's characterization and setting), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; AP.RL.2, AP.W.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses characterization in Chapter I to complicate the reader's understanding of a privileged childhood and family love. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; CF.RL.2, CF.W.1): Situate Chapter I within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of a privileged childhood and family love responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; C2.RL.2, C2.W.1): Read Chapter I alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of a privileged childhood and family love follows or bends those conventions, using the characterization as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; C3.RL.2, C3.W.1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter I and its treatment of a privileged childhood and family love. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's characterization and setting, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; C4.RL.2, C4.W.1): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter I as evidence for a larger claim about a privileged childhood and family love in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; GR.RL.2, GR.W.1): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter I as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of a privileged childhood and family love. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *His daughter attended him with the greatest tenderness; but she saw with despair that their little fund was rapidly decreasing, and that there was no other prospect of support.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "decreasing" most nearly mean?

   A. Becoming less and less
   B. Seized and appropriated by the government to the public use
   C. An allowance of food bestowed in charity
   D. To feel or to express deep and poignant grief for

2. *His daughter attended him with the greatest tenderness; but she saw with despair that their little fund was rapidly decreasing, and that there was no other prospect of support. But Caroline Beaufort possessed a mind of an uncommon mould; and her courage rose to support her in her adversity. She procured plain work; she plaited straw; and by various means contrived to earn a pittance scarcely sufficient to support life.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Chapter I"?

   A. The letter
   B. Bingley returns
   C. Self-recognition
   D. A privileged childhood and family love

SAT key: 1. A (Becoming less and less); 2. D (A privileged childhood and family love)

Lesson 8: Chapter II

Focus: the first spark of obsession

Teacher only · spoilers

Victor recalls his friend Henry Clerval and his own early fascination with the alchemists Cornelius Agrippa, Paracelsus and Albertus Magnus. A lightning strike that destroys an oak tree introduces him to electricity, and he briefly turns to mathematics before 'destiny' pulls him back.

Background: Agrippa and Paracelsus were Renaissance figures who mixed early science with magic. Lightning and electricity fascinated Enlightenment scientists like Benjamin Franklin.

Significance: Victor frames his life as fated, shifting responsibility away from his choices—a key point for discussion.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Settle in and write for five minutes: Victor blames 'destiny' for his fate. Do you agree, or did he choose? No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
Today's words are ligaments, disunion, loudness, preceptors, dissect. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check Webster's. Here is the first: “Thus strangely are our souls constructed, and by such slight ligaments are we bound to prosperity or ruin.” Webster's says: Anything that ties or unites one thing or part to another. Now the word history: “ligament”: -ment (Latin -mentum, "result or means of"). Root not in our table: have students find it. “disunion”: dis- (Latin dis-, "apart, not"). Root not in our table: have students find it. “loudness”: -ness (Old English -ness, "state of"). Root not in our table: have students find it. Add each root to your etymology log.

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Present the historical and literary background.
Here is what the first readers of Frankenstein would have known. Agrippa and Paracelsus were Renaissance figures who mixed early science with magic. Lightning and electricity fascinated Enlightenment scientists like Benjamin Franklin. Why does this chapter matter? Victor frames his life as fated, shifting responsibility away from his choices —a key point for discussion. Write down one question you want answered.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for foreshadowing.
Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. I read a sentence, stop, and ask what the author is doing. When I see foreshadowing, I underline it and write in the margin what effect it has. Here I notice the diction and the sentence rhythm, and I connect them to the first spark of obsession.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for Foreshadowing, Characterization, Symbolism.
Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of foreshadowing. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.

> *The untaught peasant beheld the elements around him, and was acquainted with their practical uses. The most learned philosopher knew little more. He had partially unveiled the face of Nature, but her immortal lineaments were still a wonder and a mystery. He might dissect, anatomise, and give names; but, not to speak of a final cause, causes in their secondary and tertiary grades were utterly unknown to him. I had gazed upon the fortifications and impediments that seemed to keep human beings from entering the citadel of nature, and rashly and ignorantly I had repined.*

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their rigor.
Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Foreshadowing, Characterization, Symbolism: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; your level is already set. Middle-school version: In "Chapter II," how does Shelley show the first spark of obsession? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the chapter, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the foreshadowing you noticed as one piece of evidence. I will circulate and conference.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion (think-pair-share or a short Socratic circle).
Let's talk. Our question: How does this chapter connect to the costs of unchecked ambition? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
Take the chapter quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this chapter suggests about the first spark of obsession, backed by one short quotation.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how foreshadowing shapes the first spark of obsession. Tonight, read the next chapter and add two words to your etymology log.

Total: 90 minutes.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (Webster's 1913)	In context	Etymology note
ligaments	Anything that ties or unites one	*Thus strangely are our souls constructed, and by such slight ligaments are we bound to prosperity or ruin.*	"ligament": -ment (Latin -mentum, "result or means of"). Root not in our table: have students find it.

	thing or part to another		
disunion	The termination of union	*I need not say that we were strangers to any species of disunion or dispute.*	“disunion”: dis- (Latin dis-, "apart, not"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
loudness	The quality or state of being loud	*It advanced from behind the mountains of Jura; and the thunder burst at once with frightful loudness from various quarters of the heavens.*	“loudness”: -ness (Old English -ness, "state of"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
preceptors	One who gives commands, or makes rules	*Under the guidance of my new preceptors, I entered with the greatest diligence into the search of the philosopher’s stone and the elixir of life; but the latter soon obtained my undivided attention.*	“preceptor”: pre- (Latin prae, "before") + cept (Latin capere, "to take") + -or (Latin -or, "one who"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary.
dissect	(Anat.) To divide into separate parts	*He might dissect, anatomise, and give names; but, not to speak of a final cause, causes in their secondary and tertiary grades were utterly unknown to him.*	“dissect”: dis- (Latin dis-, "apart, not"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
relinquishing	To withdraw from	*Her victory was announced by an unusual tranquillity and gladness of soul, which followed the relinquishing of my ancient and latterly tormenting studies.*	“relinquish”: re- (Latin re-, "back, again") + quis (Latin quaerere, "to seek"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary.
unveiled	To remove a veil from	*He had partially unveiled the face of Nature, but her immortal lineaments were still a wonder and a mystery.*	“unveil”: un- (Old English un-, "not"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
invulnerable	Incapable of being wounded, or of receiving injury	*Wealth was an inferior object; but what glory would attend the discovery, if I could banish disease from the human frame, and render man invulnerable to any but a violent death!*	“invulnerable”: in- (Latin in-, "not" or "in") + -able (Latin -abilis, "able to be"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
splintered	To split or rend into long, thin pieces	*It was not splintered by the shock, but entirely reduced to thin ribbons of wood.*	“splinter”: -er (Old English -ere, "one who"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
predilection	A previous liking	*Natural philosophy is the genius that has regulated my fate; I desire, therefore, in this narration, to state those facts which led to my predilection for that science.*	“predilection”: pre- (Latin prae, "before") + -tion (Latin -tio, "the act of"). Root not in our table: have students find it.

Discussion questions

1. Victor blames 'destiny' for his fate. Do you agree, or did he choose?

2. Where does foreshadowing appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with isolation and the need for companionship?

Annotation focus

- **Foreshadowing:** look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events
- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- **Symbolism:** look for objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas

Chapter quiz

1. Which author first fascinates Victor?
   A. Cornelius Agrippa
   B. Homer
   C. Isaac Newton
   D. Shakespeare
2. What does Victor's father call Agrippa's work?
   A. Brilliant science
   B. A great adventure
   C. Holy truth
   D. Sad trash
3. What event introduces Victor to electricity?
   A. A fire in the house
   B. A storm at sea
   C. A shock from a machine
   D. Lightning destroying an oak tree
4. Who is Victor's closest childhood friend?
   A. Henry Clerval
   B. Robert Walton
   C. Felix De Lacey
   D. M. Krempe
5. What does Victor say governed his life?
   A. Religion
   B. Destiny
   C. Money
   D. His mother
6. In the line “Thus strangely are our souls constructed, and by such slight ligaments are we bound to prosperity or ruin.”, what does “ligaments” most nearly mean?
   A. The termination of union
   B. One who gives commands, or makes rules

C. The quality or state of being loud

D. Anything that ties or unites one thing or part to another

7. In the line “I need not say that we were strangers to any species of disunion or dispute.”, what does “disunion” most nearly mean?

A. The quality or state of being loud

B. One who gives commands, or makes rules

C. The termination of union

D. Anything that ties or unites one thing or part to another

Answer key: 1. A (Cornelius Agrippa); 2. D (Sad trash); 3. D (Lightning destroying an oak tree); 4. A (Henry Clerval); 5. B (Destiny); 6. D (Anything that ties or unites one thing or part to another); 7. C (The termination of union)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; RL.7.5, W.7.1): In “Chapter II,” how does Shelley show the first spark of obsession? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the chapter, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the foreshadowing you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1): In Chapter II, how does Shelley develop the idea of the first spark of obsession? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the foreshadowing in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Chapter II develops the idea of the first spark of obsession. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of foreshadowing and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Chapter II (where it begins, turns and ends) and its foreshadowing shape the reader's understanding of the first spark of obsession. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Chapter II suggests about the first spark of obsession. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's foreshadowing and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; AP.RL.3, AP.W.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses foreshadowing in Chapter II to complicate the reader's understanding of the first spark of obsession. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; CF.RL.3, CF.W.1): Situate Chapter II within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of the first spark of obsession responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; C2.RL.3, C2.W.1): Read Chapter II alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of the first spark of obsession follows or bends those conventions, using the foreshadowing as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; C3.RL.3, C3.W.1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter II and its treatment of the first spark of obsession. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's foreshadowing and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; C4.RL.3, C4.W.1): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter II as evidence for a larger claim about the first spark of obsession in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; GR.RL.3, GR.W.1): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter II as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of the first spark of obsession. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *It advanced from behind the mountains of Jura; and the thunder burst at once with frightful loudness from various quarters of the heavens.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “loudness” most nearly mean?

   A. Incapable of being wounded, or of receiving injury

   B. The quality or state of being loud

   C. To split or rend into long, thin pieces

   D. A previous liking

2. *The untaught peasant beheld the elements around him, and was acquainted with their practical uses. The most learned philosopher knew little more. He had partially unveiled the face of Nature, but her immortal lineaments were still a wonder and a mystery. He might dissect, anatomise, and give names; but, not to speak of a final cause, causes in their secondary and tertiary grades were utterly unknown to him. I had gazed upon the fortifications and impediments that seemed to keep human beings from entering the citadel of nature, and rashly and ignorantly I had repined.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Chapter II”?

   A. Sisters and judgment

   B. Isolation in the north

   C. A journey and a mercenary suitor

   D. The first spark of obsession

SAT key: 1. B (The quality or state of being loud); 2. D (The first spark of obsession)

Lesson 9: Chapter III

Focus: loss and leaving home

Teacher only · spoilers

Victor's mother dies of scarlet fever caught while nursing Elizabeth, and on her deathbed asks Victor and Elizabeth to marry. Victor leaves for the University of Ingolstadt, where M. Krempe scorns his alchemists and M. Waldman inspires him with modern chemistry.

Background: Ingolstadt (Bavaria) had a real university and was associated with the Illuminati, a secret society. Chemistry was rapidly changing in this era.

Significance: Grief and ambition merge; Waldman's speech about scientists who 'penetrate into the recesses of nature' ignites Victor's resolve.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Settle in and write for five minutes: How might his mother's death affect Victor's desire to conquer death? No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
Today's words are prepossess, crucible, residents, fatiguing, chimeras. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check Webster's. Here is the first: "Krempe was a little squat man, with a gruff voice and a repulsive countenance; the teacher, therefore, did not prepossess me in favour of his pursuits." Webster's says: To preoccupy, as ground or land. Now the word history: "prepossess": pre- (Latin prae, "before") + pos (Latin ponere, "to place"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary. "crucible": -ible (Latin -ibilis, "able to be"). Root not in our table: have students find it. "resident": re- (Latin re-, "back, again") + -ent (Latin -ens, "one who, doing"). Root not in our table: have students find it. Add each root to your etymology log.

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Present the historical and literary background.
Here is what the first readers of Frankenstein would have known. Ingolstadt (Bavaria) had a real university and was associated with the Illuminati, a secret society. Chemistry was rapidly changing in this era. Why does this chapter matter? Grief and ambition merge; Waldman's speech about scientists who 'penetrate into the recesses of nature' ignites Victor's resolve. Write down one question you want answered.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for foreshadowing.
Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. I read a sentence, stop, and ask what the author is doing. When I see foreshadowing, I underline it and write in the margin what effect it has. Here I notice the diction and the sentence rhythm, and I connect them to loss and leaving home.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for Foreshadowing, Characterization, Tone / mood.
Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of foreshadowing. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.

> *I had sufficient leisure for these and many other reflections during my journey to Ingolstadt, which was long and fatiguing. At length the high white steeple of the town met my eyes. I alighted, and was conducted to my solitary apartment, to spend the evening as I pleased.*

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their rigor.
Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Foreshadowing, Characterization, Tone / mood: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; your level is already set. Middle-school version: In "Chapter III," how does Shelley show loss and leaving home? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the chapter, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the foreshadowing you noticed as one piece of evidence. I will circulate and conference.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion (think-pair-share or a short Socratic circle).
Let's talk. Our question: How does this chapter connect to the costs of unchecked ambition? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
Take the chapter quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this chapter suggests about loss and leaving home, backed by one short quotation.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how foreshadowing shapes loss and leaving home. Tonight, read the next chapter and add two words to your etymology log.

Total: 90 minutes.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (Webster's 1913)	In context	Etymology note

prepossess	To preoccupy, as ground or land	*Krempe was a little squat man, with a gruff voice and a repulsive countenance; the teacher, therefore, did not prepossess me in favour of his pursuits.*	"prepossess": pre- (Latin prae, "before") + pos (Latin ponere, "to place"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary.
crucible	A vessel or melting pot, composed of some very refractory substance, as clay, graphite, platinum, and used for…	*But these philosophers, whose hands seem only made to dabble in dirt, and their eyes to pore over the microscope or crucible, have indeed performed miracles.*	"crucible": -ible (Latin -ibilis, "able to be"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
residents	Dwelling, or having an abode, in a place for a continued length of time	*Such were my reflections during the first two or three days of my residence at Ingolstadt, which were chiefly spent in becoming acquainted with the localities, and the principal residents in my new abode.*	"resident": re- (Latin re-, "back, again") + -ent (Latin -ens, "one who, doing"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
fatiguing	Weariness from bodily labor or mental exertion	*I had sufficient leisure for these and many other reflections during my journey to Ingolstadt, which was long and fatiguing.*	"fatigue": no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin.
chimeras	(Myth.) A monster represented as vomiting flames, and as having the head of a lion, the body of a goat, and the tail…	*I was required to exchange chimeras of boundless grandeur for realities of little worth.*	"chimera": no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin.
transmuted	To change from one nature, form, or substance, into another	*The modern masters promise very little; they know that metals cannot be transmuted, and that the elixir of life is a chimera.*	"transmute": trans- (Latin trans, "across"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
panegyric	An oration or eulogy in praise of some person or achievement	*After having made a few preparatory experiments, he concluded with a panegyric upon modern chemistry, the terms of which I shall never forget:—*	"panegyric": -ic (Greek -ikos, "relating to"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
insurrection	A rising against civil or political authority, or the established government	*My internal being was in a state of insurrection and turmoil; I felt that order would thence arise, but I had no power to produce it.*	"insurrection": in- (Latin in-, "not" or "in") + -tion (Latin -tio, "the act of"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
commences	To have a beginning or origin	*These are the reflections of the first days; but when the lapse of time proves the reality of the evil, then the actual bitterness of grief commences.*	"commence": com- (Latin com-, "with, together"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
imbibed	To drink in		

		Good God! in what desert land have you lived, where no one was kind enough to inform you that these fancies, which you have so greedily imbibed, are a thousand years old, and as musty as they are ancient?	“imbibe”: im- (Latin in-, "not" or "in"). Root not in our table: have students find it.

Discussion questions

1. How might his mother's death affect Victor's desire to conquer death?
2. Where does foreshadowing appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with nature versus nurture?

Annotation focus

- **Foreshadowing:** look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events
- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- **Tone / mood:** look for word choices that reveal the narrator's attitude or the scene's feeling

Chapter quiz

1. How does Victor's mother die?
   A. A carriage accident
   B. Drowning
   C. Scarlet fever caught nursing Elizabeth
   D. Old age
2. What is her dying wish?
   A. That Victor become a priest
   B. That the family move
   C. That Victor stay home
   D. That Victor and Elizabeth marry
3. Where does Victor go to university?
   A. Ingolstadt
   B. Geneva
   C. Paris
   D. Oxford
4. Which professor inspires Victor?
   A. M. Krempe
   B. Dr. Darwin
   C. M. Waldman
   D. M. Clerval
5. How does M. Krempe react to Victor's reading?
   A. He scorns it as outdated nonsense

B. He gives Victor more alchemy books

C. He praises it

D. He expels Victor

6. In the line "Krempe was a little squat man, with a gruff voice and a repulsive countenance; the teacher, therefore, did not prepossess me in favour of his pursuits.", what does "prepossess" most nearly mean?

A. Weariness from bodily labor or mental exertion

B. To preoccupy, as ground or land

C. A vessel or melting pot, composed of some very refractory substance, as clay, graphite, platinum, and used for…

D. Dwelling, or having an abode, in a place for a continued length of time

7. In the line "But these philosophers, whose hands seem only made to dabble in dirt, and their eyes to pore over the microscope or crucible, have indeed performed miracles.", what does "crucible" most nearly mean?

A. Weariness from bodily labor or mental exertion

B. To preoccupy, as ground or land

C. A vessel or melting pot, composed of some very refractory substance, as clay, graphite, platinum, and used for…

D. Dwelling, or having an abode, in a place for a continued length of time

Answer key: 1. C (Scarlet fever caught nursing Elizabeth); 2. D (That Victor and Elizabeth marry); 3. A (Ingolstadt); 4. C (M. Waldman); 5. A (He scorns it as outdated nonsense); 6. B (To preoccupy, as ground or land); 7. C (A vessel or melting pot, composed of some very refractory substance, as clay, graphite, platinum, and used for…)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; RL.7.5, W.7.1): In "Chapter III," how does Shelley show loss and leaving home? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the chapter, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the foreshadowing you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1): In Chapter III, how does Shelley develop the idea of loss and leaving home? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the foreshadowing in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Chapter III develops the idea of loss and leaving home. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of foreshadowing and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Chapter III (where it begins, turns and ends) and its foreshadowing shape the reader's understanding of loss and leaving home. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Chapter III suggests about loss and leaving home. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's foreshadowing and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; AP.RL.3, AP.W.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses foreshadowing in Chapter III to complicate the reader's understanding of loss and leaving home. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; CF.RL.3, CF.W.1): Situate Chapter III within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of loss and leaving home responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; C2.RL.3, C2.W.1): Read Chapter III alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of loss and leaving home follows or bends those conventions, using the foreshadowing as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; C3.RL.3, C3.W.1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter III and its treatment of loss and leaving home. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's foreshadowing and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; C4.RL.3, C4.W.1): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter III as evidence for a larger claim about loss and leaving home in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; GR.RL.3, GR.W.1): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter III as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of loss and leaving home. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *Such were my reflections during the first two or three days of my residence at Ingolstadt, which were chiefly spent in becoming acquainted with the localities, and the principal residents in my new abode.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “residents” most nearly mean?

   A. A rising against civil or political authority, or the established government

   B. Dwelling, or having an abode, in a place for a continued length of time

   C. To drink in

   D. To have a beginning or origin

2. *I had sufficient leisure for these and many other reflections during my journey to Ingolstadt, which was long and fatiguing. At length the high white steeple of the town met my eyes. I alighted, and was conducted to my solitary apartment, to spend the evening as I pleased.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Chapter III”?

   A. The pain of a father's love

B. The Brighton plan

C. Loss and leaving home

D. Visit to Hunsford

SAT key: 1. B (Dwelling, or having an abode, in a place for a continued length of time); 2. C (Loss and leaving home)

Lesson 10: Chapter IV

Focus: obsession and the discovery of life

Teacher only · spoilers

Victor works tirelessly, masters chemistry, and discovers the cause of life. Gathering materials from charnel houses and dissecting rooms, he neglects family and health for nearly two years as he builds a being of gigantic stature.

Background: Body-snatching to supply anatomy schools was a real scandal of the era. 'Natural philosophy' was the period term for science.

Significance: Victor withholds the secret from Walton, warning 'how dangerous is the acquirement of knowledge'—the novel's core moral caution.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Settle in and write for five minutes: Victor refuses to tell Walton how he created life. Why is this choice important? No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
Today's words are procrastinate, slaughterhouse, dissecting, dabbled, charnel. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check Webster's. Here is the first: "I wished, as it were, to procrastinate all that related to my feelings of affection until the great object, which swallowed up every habit of my nature, should be completed." Webster's says: To put off till to-morrow, or from day to day. Now the word history: "procrastinate": pro- (Latin pro, "forward, for") + -ate (Latin -atus, "to make, having"). Root not in our table: have students find it. "slaughterhouse": no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin. "dissecting": dis- (Latin dis-, "apart, not") + -ing (Old English -ing, action). Root not in our table: have students find it. Add each root to your etymology log.

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Present the historical and literary background.
Here is what the first readers of Frankenstein would have known. Body-snatching to supply anatomy schools was a real scandal of the era. 'Natural philosophy' was the period term for science. Why does this chapter matter? Victor withholds the secret from Walton, warning 'how dangerous is the acquirement of knowledge'—the novel's core moral caution. Write down one question you want answered.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for foreshadowing.
Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. I read a sentence, stop, and ask what the author is doing. When I see foreshadowing, I underline it and write in the margin what effect it has. Here I notice the diction and the sentence rhythm, and I connect them to obsession and the discovery of life.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for Foreshadowing, Tone / mood, Imagery.
Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of foreshadowing. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.

> *I see by your eagerness, and the wonder and hope which your eyes express, my friend, that you expect to be informed of the secret with which I am acquainted; that cannot be: listen patiently until the end of my story, and you will easily perceive why I am reserved upon that subject. I will not lead you on, unguarded and ardent as I then was, to your destruction and infallible misery. Learn from me, if not by my precepts, at least by my example, how dangerous is the acquirement of knowledge, and how much happier that man is who believes his native town to be the world, than he who aspires to become greater than his nature will allow.*

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their rigor.
Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Foreshadowing, Tone / mood, Imagery: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; your level is already set. Middle-school version: In "Chapter IV," how does Shelley show obsession and the discovery of life? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the chapter, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the foreshadowing you noticed as one piece of evidence. I will circulate and conference.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion (think-pair-share or a short Socratic circle).
Let's talk. Our question: How does this chapter connect to the costs of unchecked ambition? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
Take the chapter quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this chapter suggests about obsession and the discovery of life, backed by one short quotation.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how foreshadowing shapes obsession and the discovery of life. Tonight, read the next chapter and add two words to your etymology log.

Total: 90 minutes.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (Webster's 1913)	In context	Etymology note
procrastinate	To put off till to-morrow, or from day to day	*I wished, as it were, to procrastinate all that related to my feelings of affection until the great object, which swallowed up every habit of my nature, should be completed.*	"procrastinate": pro- (Latin pro, "forward, for") + -ate (Latin -atus, "to make, having"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
slaughterhouse	A house where beasts are butchered for the market	*The dissecting room and the slaughterhouse furnished many of my materials; and often did my human nature turn with loathing from my occupation, whilst, still urged on by an eagerness which perpetually increased, I brought my work near to a conclusion.*	"slaughterhouse": no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin.
dissecting	Dividing or separating the parts of an animal or vegetable body	*The dissecting room and the slaughterhouse furnished many of my materials; and often did my human nature turn with loathing from my occupation, whilst, still urged on by an eagerness which perpetually increased, I brought my work near to a conclusion.*	"dissecting": dis- (Latin dis-, "apart, not") + -ing (Old English -ing, action). Root not in our table: have students find it.
dabbled	To wet by little dips or strokes	*Who shall conceive the horrors of my secret toil, as I dabbled among the unhallowed damps of the grave, or tortured the living animal to animate the lifeless clay?*	"dabble": no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin.
charnel	Containing the bodies of the dead	*Now I was led to examine the cause and progress of this decay, and forced to spend days and nights in vaults and charnel-houses.*	"charnel": no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin.
disquieted	Deprived of quiet	*I knew my silence disquieted them; and I well remembered the words of my father: "I know that while you are pleased with yourself, you will think of us with affection, and we shall hear regularly from you.*	"disquiet": dis- (Latin dis-, "apart, not"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
abstruse	Concealed or hidden out of the way	*In a thousand ways he smoothed for me the path of knowledge, and made the most abstruse enquiries clear and facile to my apprehension.*	"abstruse": ab- (Latin ab, "away from"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
unguarded	To deprive of a guard	*I will not lead you on, unguarded and ardent as I then was, to your destruction and infallible misery.*	"unguard": un- (Old English un-, "not") + ard (Latin ardere, "to burn"). Teacher note from a

			root table; verify in an etymological dictionary.
vintage	The produce of the vine for one season, in grapes or in wine	*It was a most beautiful season; never did the fields bestow a more plentiful harvest, or the vines yield a more luxuriant vintage: but my eyes were insensible to the charms of nature.*	"vintage": no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin.
physiology	The science which treats of the phenomena of living organisms	*I revolved these circumstances in my mind, and determined thenceforth to apply myself more particularly to those branches of natural philosophy which relate to physiology.*	"physiology": log (Greek logos, "word, reason"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary.

Discussion questions

1. Victor refuses to tell Walton how he created life. Why is this choice important?
2. Where does foreshadowing appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with the sublime power of nature?

Annotation focus

- **Foreshadowing:** look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events
- **Tone / mood:** look for word choices that reveal the narrator's attitude or the scene's feeling
- **Imagery:** look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create

Chapter quiz

1. What does Victor discover?
   A. A route to the pole
   B. A cure for fever
   C. A new planet
   D. The cause of generation and life
2. Where does Victor gather materials?
   A. A church garden
   B. The forest
   C. The market
   D. Charnel houses and dissecting rooms
3. Why does Victor make the being gigantic?
   A. By accident
   B. The small parts were hard to work with
   C. To frighten enemies
   D. To make it strong for labor

4. What happens to Victor's health and relationships?
   A. He becomes stronger
   B. He travels widely
   C. He neglects his family and grows ill and pale
   D. He marries
5. What does Victor refuse to share with Walton?
   A. His age
   B. His family's names
   C. The secret of how he created life
   D. The location of Geneva
6. In the line “I wished, as it were, to procrastinate all that related to my feelings of affection until the great object, which swallowed up every habit of my nature, should be completed.”, what does “procrastinate” most nearly mean?
   A. To wet by little dips or strokes
   B. Dividing or separating the parts of an animal or vegetable body
   C. A house where beasts are butchered for the market
   D. To put off till to-morrow, or from day to day
7. In the line “The dissecting room and the slaughterhouse furnished many of my materials; and often did my human nature turn with loathing from my occupation, whilst, still urged on by an eagerness which perpetually increased, I brought my work near to a conclusion.”, what does “slaughterhouse” most nearly mean?
   A. To wet by little dips or strokes
   B. A house where beasts are butchered for the market
   C. To put off till to-morrow, or from day to day
   D. Dividing or separating the parts of an animal or vegetable body

Answer key: 1. D (The cause of generation and life); 2. D (Charnel houses and dissecting rooms); 3. B (The small parts were hard to work with); 4. C (He neglects his family and grows ill and pale); 5. C (The secret of how he created life); 6. D (To put off till to-morrow, or from day to day); 7. B (A house where beasts are butchered for the market)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; RL.7.5, W.7.1): In “Chapter IV,” how does Shelley show obsession and the discovery of life? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the chapter, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the foreshadowing you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1): In Chapter IV, how does Shelley develop the idea of obsession and the discovery of life? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the foreshadowing in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Chapter IV develops the idea of obsession and the discovery of life. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of foreshadowing and tone / mood shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Chapter IV (where it begins, turns and ends) and its foreshadowing shape the reader's understanding of obsession and the discovery of life. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Chapter IV suggests about obsession and the discovery of life. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's foreshadowing and tone / mood), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; AP.RL.3, AP.W.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses foreshadowing in Chapter IV to complicate the reader's understanding of obsession and the discovery of life. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; CF.RL.3, CF.W.1): Situate Chapter IV within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of obsession and the discovery of life responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; C2.RL.3, C2.W.1): Read Chapter IV alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of obsession and the discovery of life follows or bends those conventions, using the foreshadowing as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; C3.RL.3, C3.W.1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter IV and its treatment of obsession and the discovery of life. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's foreshadowing and tone / mood, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; C4.RL.3, C4.W.1): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter IV as evidence for a larger claim about obsession and the discovery of life in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; GR.RL.3, GR.W.1): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter IV as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of obsession and the discovery of life. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *The dissecting room and the slaughterhouse furnished many of my materials; and often did my human nature turn with loathing from my occupation, whilst, still urged on by an eagerness which perpetually increased, I brought my work near to a conclusion.*

As used in the text, what does the word "dissecting" most nearly mean?

A. The produce of the vine for one season, in grapes or in wine

B. To deprive of a guard

C. The science which treats of the phenomena of living organisms

D. Dividing or separating the parts of an animal or vegetable body

2. *I see by your eagerness, and the wonder and hope which your eyes express, my friend, that you expect to be informed of the secret with which I am acquainted; that cannot be: listen patiently until the end of my story, and you will easily perceive why I am reserved upon that subject. I will not lead you on, unguarded and ardent as I then was, to your destruction and infallible misery. Learn from me, if not by my precepts, at least by my example, how dangerous is the acquirement of knowledge, and how much happier that man is who believes his native town to be the world, than he who aspires to become greater than his nature will allow.*

Which choice best states a central concern of "Chapter IV"?

A. A disastrous ball

B. Jealousy at Pemberley

C. Obsession and the discovery of life

D. The letter

SAT key: 1. D (Dividing or separating the parts of an animal or vegetable body); 2. C (Obsession and the discovery of life)

Lesson 11: Chapter V

Focus: horror at the moment of creation

Teacher only · spoilers

On a dreary November night, the creature opens its 'dull yellow eye.' Horrified by its appearance, Victor flees, dreams of Elizabeth turning into his mother's corpse, and wakes to see the creature reaching toward him. He runs into the street, meets Clerval, and collapses into a long fever, nursed by Henry.

Background: Gothic novels used darkness, storms and nightmares to produce dread. The quoted lines from Coleridge's 'Ancient Mariner' reinforce Victor's guilt.

Significance: The irony is sharp: the being Victor labored to make is abandoned within minutes. The creature's outstretched hand may be a gesture of affection that Victor reads as threat.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Settle in and write for five minutes: Was the creature's first gesture threatening or loving? Use evidence. No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
Today's words are agitates, palpitated, infusing, relapses, lassitude. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check Webster's. Here is the first: ""Compose yourself," said Clerval, who observed my change of colour, "I will not mention it, if it agitates you; but your father and cousin would be very happy if they received a letter from you in your own handwriting." Webster's says: To move with a violent, irregular action. Now the word history: "agitate": -ate (Latin -atus, "to make, having"). Root not in our table: have students find it. "palpitate": -ate (Latin -atus, "to make, having"). Root not in our table: have students find it. "infuse": in- (Latin in-, "not" or "in"). Root not in our table: have students find it. Add each root to your etymology log.

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Present the historical and literary background.
Here is what the first readers of Frankenstein would have known. Gothic novels used darkness, storms and nightmares to produce dread. The quoted lines from Coleridge's 'Ancient Mariner' reinforce Victor's guilt. Why does this chapter matter? The irony is sharp: the being Victor labored to make is abandoned within minutes. The creature's outstretched hand may be a gesture of affection that Victor reads as threat. Write down one question you want answered.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for imagery.
Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. I read a sentence, stop, and ask what the author is doing. When I see imagery, I underline it and write in the margin what effect it has. Here I notice the diction and the sentence rhythm, and I connect them to horror at the moment of creation.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for Imagery, Tone / mood, Irony.
Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of imagery. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.

> *I continued walking in this manner for some time, endeavouring, by bodily exercise, to ease the load that weighed upon my mind. I traversed the streets, without any clear conception of where I was, or what I was doing. My heart palpitated in the sickness of fear; and I hurried on with irregular steps, not daring to look about me:—*

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their rigor.
Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Imagery, Tone / mood, Irony: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; your level is already set. Middle-school version: In "Chapter V," how does Shelley show horror at the moment of creation? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the chapter, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the imagery you noticed as one piece of evidence. I will circulate and conference.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion (think-pair-share or a short Socratic circle).
Let's talk. Our question: How does this chapter connect to the costs of unchecked ambition? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
Take the chapter quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this chapter suggests about horror at the moment of creation, backed by one short quotation.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how imagery shapes horror at the moment of creation. Tonight, read the next chapter and add two words to your etymology log.

Total: 90 minutes.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (Webster's 1913)	In context	Etymology note

agitates	To move with a violent, irregular action	*“Compose yourself,” said Clerval, who observed my change of colour, “I will not mention it, if it agitates you; but your father and cousin would be very happy if they received a letter from you in your own handwriting.*	“agitate”: -ate (Latin -atus, "to make, having"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
palpitated	To beat rapidly and more strongly than usual	*My heart palpitated in the sickness of fear; and I hurried on with irregular steps, not daring to look about me:—*	“palpitate”: -ate (Latin -atus, "to make, having"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
infusing	To pour in, as a liquid	*I had worked hard for nearly two years, for the sole purpose of infusing life into an inanimate body.*	“infuse”: in- (Latin in-, "not" or "in"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
relapses	To slip or slide back, in a literal sense	*By very slow degrees, and with frequent relapses, that alarmed and grieved my friend, I recovered.*	“relapse”: re- (Latin re-, "back, again"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
lassitude	A condition of the body, or mind, when its voluntary functions are performed with difficulty, and only by a strong…	*At length lassitude succeeded to the tumult I had before endured; and I threw myself on the bed in my clothes, endeavouring to seek a few moments of forgetfulness.*	“lassitude”: -ude (Latin -udo, "state of"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
convalescence	The recovery of heath and strength after disease	*It was a divine spring; and the season contributed greatly to my convalescence.*	“convalescence”: con- (Latin com-, "with, together") + -ence (Latin -entia, "state of"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
alighting	To spring down, get down, or descend, as from on horseback or from a carriage	*“My dear Frankenstein,” exclaimed he, “how glad I am to see you! how fortunate that you should be here at the very moment of my alighting!”*	“alight”: no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin.
unbounded	Having no bound or limit	*But I was in reality very ill; and surely nothing but the unbounded and unremitting attentions of my friend could have restored me to life.*	“unbounded”: un- (Old English un-, "not") + -ed (Old English -ed, past or "having"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
wildness	The quality or state of being wild	*Clerval at first attributed my unusual spirits to joy on his arrival; but when he observed me more attentively, he saw a wildness in my eyes for which he could not account; and my loud, unrestrained,*	“wildness”: -ness (Old English -ness, "state of"). Root not in our table: have students find it.

		heartless laughter, frightened and astonished him.	
bedchamber	A chamber for a bed	*Unable to endure the aspect of the being I had created, I rushed out of the room, and continued a long time traversing my bedchamber, unable to compose my mind to sleep.*	“bedchamber”: be- (Old English be-, "thoroughly, about") + -er (Old English -ere, "one who"). Root not in our table: have students find it.

Discussion questions

1. Was the creature's first gesture threatening or loving? Use evidence.
2. Where does imagery appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with the costs of unchecked ambition?

Annotation focus

- **Imagery:** look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create
- **Tone / mood:** look for word choices that reveal the narrator's attitude or the scene's feeling
- **Irony:** look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true

Chapter quiz

1. What month does the creature come to life?
   A. December
   B. June
   C. March
   D. November
2. What first feature of the creature does Victor describe?
   A. Its dull yellow eye
   B. Its smile
   C. Its voice
   D. Its hands
3. What does Victor dream after fleeing?
   A. He sails north
   B. Elizabeth turns into his dead mother's corpse
   C. He is drowning
   D. He is crowned king
4. Who arrives in Ingolstadt and nurses Victor?
   A. Walton
   B. Elizabeth
   C. Henry Clerval
   D. Alphonse

5. What is ironic about this chapter?
   A. The creature is tiny
   B. Clerval is a scientist
   C. Victor is happy
   D. Victor abandons the being he worked years to create
6. In the line ""Compose yourself," said Clerval, who observed my change of colour, "I will not mention it, if it agitates you; but your father and cousin would be very happy if they received a letter from you in your own handwriting.", what does "agitates" most nearly mean?
   A. To beat rapidly and more strongly than usual
   B. To move with a violent, irregular action
   C. To slip or slide back, in a literal sense
   D. To pour in, as a liquid
7. In the line "My heart palpitated in the sickness of fear; and I hurried on with irregular steps, not daring to look about me:—", what does "palpitated" most nearly mean?
   A. To slip or slide back, in a literal sense
   B. To pour in, as a liquid
   C. To beat rapidly and more strongly than usual
   D. To move with a violent, irregular action

Answer key: 1. D (November); 2. A (Its dull yellow eye); 3. B (Elizabeth turns into his dead mother's corpse); 4. C (Henry Clerval); 5. D (Victor abandons the being he worked years to create); 6. B (To move with a violent, irregular action); 7. C (To beat rapidly and more strongly than usual)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; RL.7.4, W.7.1): In "Chapter V," how does Shelley show horror at the moment of creation? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the chapter, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the imagery you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): In Chapter V, how does Shelley develop the idea of horror at the moment of creation? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the imagery in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Chapter V develops the idea of horror at the moment of creation. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and tone / mood shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Chapter V (where it begins, turns and ends) and its imagery shape the reader's understanding of horror at the moment of creation. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Chapter V suggests about horror at the moment of creation. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each

(including the chapter's imagery and tone / mood), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; AP.RL.1, AP.W.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses imagery in Chapter V to complicate the reader's understanding of horror at the moment of creation. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; CF.RL.1, CF.W.1): Situate Chapter V within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of horror at the moment of creation responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; C2.RL.1, C2.W.1): Read Chapter V alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of horror at the moment of creation follows or bends those conventions, using the imagery as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; C3.RL.1, C3.W.1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter V and its treatment of horror at the moment of creation. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's imagery and tone / mood, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; C4.RL.1, C4.W.1): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter V as evidence for a larger claim about horror at the moment of creation in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; GR.RL.1, GR.W.1): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter V as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of horror at the moment of creation. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *I had worked hard for nearly two years, for the sole purpose of infusing life into an inanimate body.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “infusing” most nearly mean?

   A. The quality or state of being wild

   B. Having no bound or limit

   C. A chamber for a bed

   D. To pour in, as a liquid

2. *I continued walking in this manner for some time, endeavouring, by bodily exercise, to ease the load that weighed upon my mind. I traversed the streets, without any clear conception of where I was, or what I was*

doing. My heart palpitated in the sickness of fear; and I hurried on with irregular steps, not daring to look about me:—

Which choice best states a central concern of "Chapter V"?

A. Horror at the moment of creation

B. First impressions at the ball

C. Loss and vengeance

D. Neighbors and gossip

SAT key: 1. D (To pour in, as a liquid); 2. A (Horror at the moment of creation)

Lesson 12: Chapter VI

Focus: recovery and false peace

Teacher only · spoilers

Recovering, Victor reads a letter from Elizabeth telling of home and of Justine Moritz, a servant girl who became part of the family. Victor now hates natural philosophy. He and Clerval study languages and take a restorative walking tour.

Background: Romantic writers believed nature could heal the mind, a theme in Wordsworth's poetry.

Significance: The calm before tragedy: Justine's introduction sets up her later fate.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Settle in and write for five minutes: Why does Shelley introduce Justine through a cheerful letter? No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
Today's words are salubrious, congratulatory, encomiums, vacillating, devolved. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check Webster's. Here is the first: "We passed a fortnight in these perambulations: my health and spirits had long been restored, and they gained additional strength from the salubrious air I breathed, the natural incidents of our progress, and the conversation of my friend." Webster's says: Favorable to health. Now the word history: "salubrious": -ious (Latin -iosus, "full of"). Root not in our table: have students find it. "congratulatory": con- (Latin com-, "with, together") + -ory (Latin -orius, "relating to"). Root not in our table: have students find it. "encomium": en- (French en-/Latin in-, "into"). Root not in our table: have students find it. Add each root to your etymology log.

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Present the historical and literary background.
Here is what the first readers of Frankenstein would have known. Romantic writers believed nature could heal the mind, a theme in Wordsworth's poetry. Why does this chapter matter? The calm before tragedy: Justine's introduction sets up her later fate. Write down one question you want answered.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for setting.
Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. I read a sentence, stop, and ask what the author is doing. When I see setting, I underline it and write in the margin what effect it has. Here I notice the diction and the sentence rhythm, and I connect them to recovery and false peace.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for Setting, Tone / mood, Characterization.
Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of setting. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.

> *"I must say also a few words to you, my dear cousin, of little darling William. I wish you could see him; he is very tall of his age, with sweet laughing blue eyes, dark eyelashes, and curling hair. When he smiles, two little dimples appear on each cheek, which are rosy with health. He has already had one or two little wives, but Louisa Biron is his favourite, a pretty little girl of five years of age.*

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their rigor.
Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Setting, Tone / mood, Characterization: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; your level is already set. Middle-school version: In "Chapter VI," how does Shelley show recovery and false peace? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the chapter, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the setting you noticed as one piece of evidence. I will circulate and conference.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion (think-pair-share or a short Socratic circle).
Let's talk. Our question: How does this chapter connect to the costs of unchecked ambition? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
Take the chapter quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this chapter suggests about recovery and false peace, backed by one short quotation.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how setting shapes recovery and false peace. Tonight, read the next chapter and add two words to your etymology log.

Total: 90 minutes.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (Webster's 1913)	In context	Etymology note
salubrious	Favorable to health	*We passed a fortnight in these perambulations: my health and spirits had long been restored, and they gained additional strength from the salubrious air I breathed, the natural incidents of our progress, and the conversation of my friend.*	"salubrious": -ious (Latin -iosus, "full of"). Root not in our table: have students find it.

congratulatory	Expressive of sympathetic joy	*The pretty Miss Mansfield has already received the congratulatory visits on her approaching marriage with a young Englishman, John Melbourne, Esq.*	“congratulatory”: con- (Latin com-, "with, together") + -ory (Latin -orius, "relating to"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
encomiums	Warm or high praise	*Krempe was not equally docile; and in my condition at that time, of almost insupportable sensitiveness, his harsh blunt encomiums gave me even more pain than the benevolent approbation of M.*	“encomium”: en- (French en-/ Latin in-, "into"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
vacillating	Inclined to fluctuate	*The poor woman was very vacillating in her repentance.*	“vacillating”: -ing (Old English -ing, action). Root not in our table: have students find it.
devolved	To roll onward or downward	*I figure to myself that the task of attending on your sick bed has devolved on some mercenary old nurse, who could never guess your wishes, nor minister to them with the care and affection of your poor cousin.*	“devolve”: de- (Latin de, "down from, away"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
dialects	Means or mode of expressing thoughts	*I did not, like him, attempt a critical knowledge of their dialects, for I did not contemplate making any other use of them than temporary amusement.*	“dialect”: no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin.
alleging	To bring forward with positiveness	*Clerval, whose eyes and feelings were always quick in discerning the sensations of others, declined the subject, alleging, in excuse, his total ignorance; and the conversation took a more general turn.*	“allege”: leg (Latin lex/legere, "law" / "to read, choose"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary.
dimples	A slight natural depression or indentation on the surface of some part of the body, esp	*When he smiles, two little dimples appear on each cheek, which are rosy with health.*	“dimple”: no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin.
retarded	To keep delaying	*Summer passed away in these occupations, and my return to Geneva was fixed for the latter end of autumn; but being delayed by several accidents, winter and snow arrived, the roads were deemed impassable, and my journey was retarded until the ensuing spring.*	“retard”: re- (Latin re-, "back, again") + ard (Latin ardere, "to burn"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary.
diffident	Wanting confidence in others	*Young men should be diffident of themselves, you know, M.*	“diffident”: fid (Latin fides, "faith") + -ent (Latin -ens, "one who, doing"). Teacher

			note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary.

Discussion questions

1. Why does Shelley introduce Justine through a cheerful letter?
2. Where does setting appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with creation and responsibility?

Annotation focus

- **Setting:** look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling
- **Tone / mood:** look for word choices that reveal the narrator's attitude or the scene's feeling
- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them

Chapter quiz

1. Who writes to Victor during his recovery?
   A. Walton
   B. His mother
   C. Krempe
   D. Elizabeth
2. Who is Justine Moritz?
   A. An innkeeper
   B. A girl who became a servant and part of the family
   C. A professor
   D. Victor's sister
3. How does Victor now feel about natural philosophy?
   A. He loves it more
   B. He teaches it
   C. He is indifferent
   D. He cannot bear it
4. What does Clerval study?
   A. Medicine
   B. Chemistry
   C. Oriental languages
   D. Astronomy
5. What restores Victor's spirits?
   A. A sea voyage
   B. A party
   C. A walking tour in nature with Clerval
   D. A new experiment

6. In the line “We passed a fortnight in these perambulations: my health and spirits had long been restored, and they gained additional strength from the salubrious air I breathed, the natural incidents of our progress, and the conversation of my friend.”, what does “salubrious” most nearly mean?
   A. Warm or high praise
   B. Inclined to fluctuate
   C. Expressive of sympathetic joy
   D. Favorable to health
7. In the line “The pretty Miss Mansfield has already received the congratulatory visits on her approaching marriage with a young Englishman, John Melbourne, Esq.”, what does “congratulatory” most nearly mean?
   A. Favorable to health
   B. Inclined to fluctuate
   C. Warm or high praise
   D. Expressive of sympathetic joy

Answer key: 1. D (Elizabeth); 2. B (A girl who became a servant and part of the family); 3. D (He cannot bear it); 4. C (Oriental languages); 5. C (A walking tour in nature with Clerval); 6. D (Favorable to health); 7. D (Expressive of sympathetic joy)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; RL.7.3, W.7.1): In “Chapter VI,” how does Shelley show recovery and false peace? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the chapter, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the setting you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In Chapter VI, how does Shelley develop the idea of recovery and false peace? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the setting in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Chapter VI develops the idea of recovery and false peace. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and tone / mood shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Chapter VI (where it begins, turns and ends) and its setting shape the reader's understanding of recovery and false peace. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Chapter VI suggests about recovery and false peace. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's setting and tone / mood), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; AP.RL.3, AP.W.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses setting in Chapter VI to complicate the reader's understanding of recovery and false peace. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; CF.RL.3, CF.W.1): Situate Chapter VI within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of recovery and false peace responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; C2.RL.3, C2.W.1): Read Chapter VI alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of recovery and false peace follows or bends those conventions, using the setting as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; C3.RL.3, C3.W.1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter VI and its treatment of recovery and false peace. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's setting and tone / mood, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; C4.RL.3, C4.W.1): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter VI as evidence for a larger claim about recovery and false peace in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; GR.RL.3, GR.W.1): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter VI as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of recovery and false peace. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *Krempe was not equally docile; and in my condition at that time, of almost insupportable sensitiveness, his harsh blunt encomiums gave me even more pain than the benevolent approbation of M.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “encomiums” most nearly mean?

   A. Warm or high praise

   B. To keep delaying

   C. Wanting confidence in others

   D. A slight natural depression or indentation on the surface of some part of the body, esp

2. *“I must say also a few words to you, my dear cousin, of little darling William. I wish you could see him; he is very tall of his age, with sweet laughing blue eyes, dark eyelashes, and curling hair. When he smiles, two little dimples appear on each cheek, which are rosy with health. He has already had one or two little wives, but Louisa Biron is his favourite, a pretty little girl of five years of age.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Chapter VI”?

   A. Music, wit and manners

   B. Visit to Hunsford

   C. Reflections on love

   D. Recovery and false peace

SAT key: 1. A (Warm or high praise); 2. D (Recovery and false peace)

Lesson 13: Chapter VII

Focus: the first death and growing guilt

Teacher only · spoilers

A letter from his father reports that Victor's youngest brother, William, has been murdered. Returning to Geneva during a storm, Victor glimpses the creature near the spot and becomes certain it is the killer. He learns that Justine has been accused because William's locket was found on her.

Background: The Alps and storms are classic sublime settings—vast nature that inspires awe and fear.

Significance: Victor's silence begins here: he knows the truth but says nothing, making him complicit.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Settle in and write for five minutes: Should Victor tell the authorities what he knows? Why does he stay silent? No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
Today's words are cabriolet, prognosticate, scaling, desolating, festering. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check Webster's. Here is the first: “But now, as soon as the horses arrived, I hurried into a cabriolet, and bade farewell to my friend.” Webster's says: A one-horse carriage with two seats and a calash top. Now the word history: “cabriolet”: no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin. “prognosticate”: pro- (Latin pro, "forward, for") + gnos (Greek gnosis, "knowledge") + -ate (Latin -atus, "to make, having"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary. “scaling”: -ing (Old English -ing, action). Root not in our table: have students find it. Add each root to your etymology log.

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Present the historical and literary background.
Here is what the first readers of Frankenstein would have known. The Alps and storms are classic sublime settings—vast nature that inspires awe and fear. Why does this chapter matter? Victor's silence begins here: he knows the truth but says nothing, making him complicit. Write down one question you want answered.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for foreshadowing.
Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. I read a sentence, stop, and ask what the author is doing. When I see foreshadowing, I underline it and write in the margin what effect it has. Here I notice the diction and the sentence rhythm, and I connect them to the first death and growing guilt.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for Foreshadowing, Imagery, Irony.
Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of foreshadowing. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.

> *"Come, Victor; not brooding thoughts of vengeance against the assassin, but with feelings of peace and gentleness, that will heal, instead of festering, the wounds of our minds. Enter the house of mourning, my friend, but with kindness and affection for those who love you, and not with hatred for your enemies.*

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their rigor.
Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Foreshadowing, Imagery, Irony: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; your level is already set. Middle-school version: In "Chapter VII," how does Shelley show the first death and growing guilt? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the chapter, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the foreshadowing you noticed as one piece of evidence. I will circulate and conference.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion (think-pair-share or a short Socratic circle).
Let's talk. Our question: How does this chapter connect to the costs of unchecked ambition? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
Take the chapter quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this chapter suggests about the first death and growing guilt, backed by one short quotation.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how foreshadowing shapes the first death and growing guilt. Tonight, read the next chapter and add two words to your etymology log.

Total: 90 minutes.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (Webster's 1913)	In context	Etymology note
cabriolet	A one-horse carriage with two seats and a calash top	*But now, as soon as the horses arrived, I hurried into a cabriolet, and bade farewell to my friend.*	"cabriolet": no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin.
prognosticate			"prognosticate": pro- (Latin pro, "forward, for") + gnos (Greek gnosis,

	To indicate as future	*Is this to prognosticate peace, or to mock at my unhappiness?"*	"knowledge") + -ate (Latin -atus, "to make, having"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary.
scaling	Adapted for removing scales, as from a fish	*Who could arrest a creature capable of scaling the overhanging sides of Mont Salêve?*	"scaling": -ing (Old English -ing, action). Root not in our table: have students find it.
desolating	Destitute or deprived of inhabitants	*One sudden and desolating change had taken place; but a thousand little circumstances might have by degrees worked other alterations, which, although they were done more tranquilly, might not be the less decisive.*	"desolate": de- (Latin de, "down from, away") + sol (Latin solus, "alone" / sol, "sun") + -ate (Latin -atus, "to make, having"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary.
festering	To generate pus	*"Come, Victor; not brooding thoughts of vengeance against the assassin, but with feelings of peace and gentleness, that will heal, instead of festering, the wounds of our minds.*	"fester": -er (Old English -ere, "one who"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
indelible	That can not be removed, washed away, blotted out, or effaced	*Six years had elapsed, passed as a dream but for one indelible trace, and I stood in the same place where I had last embraced my father before my departure for Ingolstadt.*	"indelible": in- (Latin in-, "not" or "in") + -ible (Latin -ibilis, "able to be"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
carnage	Flesh of slain animals or men	*I had turned loose into the world a depraved wretch, whose delight was in carnage and misery; had he not murdered my brother?*	"carnage": no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin.
ravings	Talking irrationally and wildly	*I well knew that if any other had communicated such a relation to me, I should have looked upon it as the ravings of insanity.*	"raving": -ing (Old English -ing, action). Root not in our table: have students find it.
credited	Reliance on the truth of something said or done	*Besides, the strange nature of the animal would elude all pursuit, even if I were so far credited as to persuade my relatives to commence it.*	"credit": cred (Latin credere, "to believe"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary.
assassin	One who kills, or attempts to kill, by surprise or secret assault	*"Come, Victor; not brooding thoughts of vengeance against the assassin, but with feelings of peace and gentleness, that will heal, instead of festering, the wounds of our minds.*	"assassin": as- (Latin ad, "to"). Root not in our table: have students find it.

Discussion questions

1. Should Victor tell the authorities what he knows? Why does he stay silent?

2. Where does foreshadowing appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with isolation and the need for companionship?

Annotation focus

- **Foreshadowing:** look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events
- **Imagery:** look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create
- **Irony:** look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true

Chapter quiz

1. Who has been murdered?
   A. Alphonse
   B. Elizabeth
   C. Clerval
   D. William, Victor's youngest brother
2. What weather greets Victor near Geneva?
   A. A violent thunderstorm
   B. A heatwave
   C. Fog
   D. A blizzard
3. What does the lightning reveal?
   A. Justine
   B. The creature on the mountainside
   C. A burning house
   D. A ship
4. Who is accused of the murder?
   A. Ernest
   B. Elizabeth
   C. Justine Moritz
   D. Clerval
5. What evidence was found on the accused?
   A. The miniature portrait (locket) William wore
   B. Blood
   C. A knife
   D. A letter
6. In the line “But now, as soon as the horses arrived, I hurried into a cabriolet, and bade farewell to my friend.”, what does “cabriolet” most nearly mean?
   A. To indicate as future
   B. Adapted for removing scales, as from a fish

C. A one-horse carriage with two seats and a calash top

D. Destitute or deprived of inhabitants

7. In the line “Is this to prognosticate peace, or to mock at my unhappiness?””, what does “prognosticate” most nearly mean?

A. To indicate as future

B. Destitute or deprived of inhabitants

C. Adapted for removing scales, as from a fish

D. A one-horse carriage with two seats and a calash top

Answer key: 1. D (William, Victor's youngest brother); 2. A (A violent thunderstorm); 3. B (The creature on the mountainside); 4. C (Justine Moritz); 5. A (The miniature portrait (locket) William wore); 6. C (A one-horse carriage with two seats and a calash top); 7. A (To indicate as future)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; RL.7.5, W.7.1): In “Chapter VII,” how does Shelley show the first death and growing guilt? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the chapter, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the foreshadowing you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1): In Chapter VII, how does Shelley develop the idea of the first death and growing guilt? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the foreshadowing in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Chapter VII develops the idea of the first death and growing guilt. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of foreshadowing and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Chapter VII (where it begins, turns and ends) and its foreshadowing shape the reader's understanding of the first death and growing guilt. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Chapter VII suggests about the first death and growing guilt. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's foreshadowing and imagery), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; AP.RL.3, AP.W.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses foreshadowing in Chapter VII to complicate the reader's understanding of the first death and growing guilt. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; CF.RL.3, CF.W.1): Situate Chapter VII within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of the first death and growing guilt responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; C2.RL.3, C2.W.1): Read Chapter VII alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of the first death and growing guilt follows or bends those conventions, using the foreshadowing as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; C3.RL.3, C3.W.1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter VII and its treatment of the first death and growing guilt. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's foreshadowing and imagery, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; C4.RL.3, C4.W.1): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter VII as evidence for a larger claim about the first death and growing guilt in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; GR.RL.3, GR.W.1): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter VII as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of the first death and growing guilt. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *Who could arrest a creature capable of scaling the overhanging sides of Mont Salêve?*

   As used in the text, what does the word “scaling” most nearly mean?

   A. One who kills, or attempts to kill, by surprise or secret assault

   B. Adapted for removing scales, as from a fish

   C. Talking irrationally and wildly

   D. Reliance on the truth of something said or done

2. *“Come, Victor; not brooding thoughts of vengeance against the assassin, but with feelings of peace and gentleness, that will heal, instead of festering, the wounds of our minds. Enter the house of mourning, my friend, but with kindness and affection for those who love you, and not with hatred for your enemies.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Chapter VII”?

   A. Neighbors and gossip

   B. The cycle of desire

   C. Family in crisis

   D. The first death and growing guilt

SAT key: 1. B (Adapted for removing scales, as from a fish); 2. D (The first death and growing guilt)

Lesson 14: Chapter VIII

Focus: injustice and the burden of silence

Teacher only · spoilers

Justine is tried. Though innocent, she confesses under pressure from her confessor, who threatened her with damnation, and is executed. Elizabeth defends her eloquently; Victor suffers privately but does not speak.

Background: Courts of the time could convict on circumstantial evidence; religious confession carried enormous social pressure.

Significance: Justice fails, showing how society punishes the vulnerable while the guilty (Victor, indirectly) remain free.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Settle in and write for five minutes: Who is responsible for Justine's death? Rank the characters and defend your order. No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
Today's words are tarnish, consoles, unmingled, playfellow, gnashed. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check Webster's. Here is the first: “Elizabeth also wept, and was unhappy; but hers also was the misery of innocence, which, like a cloud that passes over the fair moon, for a while hides but cannot tarnish its brightness.” Webster's says: To soil, or change the appearance of, especially by an alternation induced by the air, or by dust, or the like. Now the word history: “tarnish”: no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin. “console”: con- (Latin com-, "with, together") + sol (Latin solus, "alone" / sol, "sun"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary. “unmingle”: un- (Old English un-, "not") + min (Latin minor, "smaller"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary. Add each root to your etymology log.

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Present the historical and literary background.
Here is what the first readers of Frankenstein would have known. Courts of the time could convict on circumstantial evidence; religious confession carried enormous social pressure. Why does this chapter matter? Justice fails, showing how society punishes the vulnerable while the guilty (Victor, indirectly) remain free. Write down one question you want answered.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for irony.
Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. I read a sentence, stop, and ask what the author is doing. When I see irony, I underline it and write in the margin what effect it has. Here I notice the diction and the sentence rhythm, and I connect them to injustice and the burden of silence.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for Irony, Characterization, Theme.
Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of irony. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.

> *I passed a night of unmingled wretchedness. In the morning I went to the court; my lips and throat were parched. I dared not ask the fatal question; but I was known, and the officer guessed the cause of my visit. The ballots had been thrown; they were all black, and Justine was condemned.*

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their rigor.
Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Irony, Characterization, Theme: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; your level is already set. Middle-school version: In "Chapter VIII," how does Shelley show injustice and the burden of silence? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the chapter, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the irony you noticed as one piece of evidence. I will circulate and conference.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion (think-pair-share or a short Socratic circle).
Let's talk. Our question: How does this chapter connect to the costs of unchecked ambition? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
Take the chapter quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this chapter suggests about injustice and the burden of silence, backed by one short quotation.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how irony shapes injustice and the burden of silence. Tonight, read the next chapter and add two words to your etymology log.

Total: 90 minutes.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (Webster's 1913)	In context	Etymology note
tarnish			

	To soil, or change the appearance of, especially by an alternation induced by the air, or by dust, or the like	*Elizabeth also wept, and was unhappy; but hers also was the misery of innocence, which, like a cloud that passes over the fair moon, for a while hides but cannot tarnish its brightness.*	"tarnish": no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin.
consoles	To cheer in distress or depression	*I soon shall see you again in heaven, where we shall all be happy; and that consoles me, going as I am to suffer ignominy and death."*	"console": con- (Latin com-, "with, together") + sol (Latin solus, "alone" / sol, "sun"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary.
unmingled	To separate, as things mixed	*I passed a night of unmingled wretchedness.*	"unmingle": un- (Old English un-, "not") + min (Latin minor, "smaller"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary.
playfellow	A companion in amusements or sports	*You shall not die!—You, my playfellow, my companion, my sister, perish on the scaffold!*	"playfellow": no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin.
gnashed	To strike together, as in anger or pain	*I gnashed my teeth, and ground them together, uttering a groan that came from my inmost soul.*	"gnash": no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin.
heartrending	Causing intense grief	*Elizabeth's heartrending eloquence failed to move the judges from their settled conviction in the criminality of the saintly sufferer.*	"heartrending": -ing (Old English -ing, action). Root not in our table: have students find it.
removes	To move away from the position occupied	*It removes more than half my misfortune; and I feel as if I could die in peace, now that my innocence is acknowledged by you, dear lady, and your cousin."*	"remove": re- (Latin re-, "back, again") + mov (Latin movere, "to move"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary.
distrusted	To feel absence of trust in	*"Oh, Justine! forgive me for having for one moment distrusted you.*	"distrust": dis- (Latin dis-, "apart, not"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
excommunication	The act of communicating or ejecting	*He threatened excommunication and hell fire in my last moments, if I continued obdurate.*	"excommunication": ex- (Latin ex, "out of") + -ation (Latin -atio, "the act or result of"). Root not

			in our table: have students find it.
subscribed	To write underneath, as one's name	*In an evil hour I subscribed to a lie; and now only am I truly miserable."*	"subscribe": sub- (Latin sub, "under") + scrib (Latin scribere, "to write"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary.

Discussion questions

1. Who is responsible for Justine's death? Rank the characters and defend your order.
2. Where does irony appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with nature versus nurture?

Annotation focus

- **Irony:** look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true
- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- **Theme:** look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas

Chapter quiz

1. What happens at Justine's trial?
   A. She is freed
   B. She escapes
   C. She is convicted and condemned
   D. The trial is cancelled
2. Why does Justine confess falsely?
   A. She wanted to protect Victor
   B. She was bribed
   C. She forgot
   D. Her confessor threatened her with damnation
3. Who speaks publicly for Justine?
   A. Victor
   B. Alphonse
   C. Clerval
   D. Elizabeth
4. How does Victor respond?
   A. He accuses Ernest
   B. He leaves Geneva
   C. He confesses
   D. He suffers in silence

5. What theme does the trial highlight?
   A. The love of travel
   B. The power of science
   C. The joy of law
   D. The failure of justice
6. In the line “Elizabeth also wept, and was unhappy; but hers also was the misery of innocence, which, like a cloud that passes over the fair moon, for a while hides but cannot tarnish its brightness.”, what does “tarnish” most nearly mean?
   A. To separate, as things mixed
   B. To cheer in distress or depression
   C. A companion in amusements or sports
   D. To soil, or change the appearance of, especially by an alternation induced by the air, or by dust, or the like
7. In the line “I soon shall see you again in heaven, where we shall all be happy; and that consoles me, going as I am to suffer ignominy and death.””, what does “consoles” most nearly mean?
   A. To soil, or change the appearance of, especially by an alternation induced by the air, or by dust, or the like
   B. To separate, as things mixed
   C. To cheer in distress or depression
   D. A companion in amusements or sports

Answer key: 1. C (She is convicted and condemned); 2. D (Her confessor threatened her with damnation); 3. D (Elizabeth); 4. D (He suffers in silence); 5. D (The failure of justice); 6. D (To soil, or change the appearance of, especially by an alternation induced by the air, or by dust, or the like); 7. C (To cheer in distress or depression)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; RL.7.6, W.7.1): In “Chapter VIII,” how does Shelley show injustice and the burden of silence? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the chapter, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the irony you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): In Chapter VIII, how does Shelley develop the idea of injustice and the burden of silence? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the irony in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Chapter VIII develops the idea of injustice and the burden of silence. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Chapter VIII (where it begins, turns and ends) and its irony shape the reader's understanding of injustice and the burden of silence. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Chapter VIII suggests about injustice and the burden of silence. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's irony and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; AP.RL.1, AP.W.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses irony in Chapter VIII to complicate the reader's understanding of injustice and the burden of silence. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; CF.RL.1, CF.W.1): Situate Chapter VIII within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of injustice and the burden of silence responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; C2.RL.1, C2.W.1): Read Chapter VIII alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of injustice and the burden of silence follows or bends those conventions, using the irony as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; C3.RL.1, C3.W.1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter VIII and its treatment of injustice and the burden of silence. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's irony and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; C4.RL.1, C4.W.1): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter VIII as evidence for a larger claim about injustice and the burden of silence in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; GR.RL.1, GR.W.1): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter VIII as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of injustice and the burden of silence. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *I passed a night of unmingled wretchedness.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “unmingled” most nearly mean?

   A. To write underneath, as one's name

   B. The act of communicating or ejecting

   C. To separate, as things mixed

   D. To feel absence of trust in

2. *I passed a night of unmingled wretchedness. In the morning I went to the court; my lips and throat were parched. I dared not ask the fatal question; but I was known, and the officer guessed the cause of my visit. The ballots had been thrown; they were all black, and Justine was condemned.*

Which choice best states a central concern of "Chapter VIII"?

A. Departure and relief

B. A changed Darcy

C. Family uproar

D. Injustice and the burden of silence

SAT key: 1. C (To separate, as things mixed); 2. D (Injustice and the burden of silence)

Lesson 15: Chapter IX

Focus: despair and the sublime

Teacher only · spoilers

Tormented by guilt, Victor considers suicide. His family withdraws to Belrive. Victor journeys into the Alps toward Chamounix, where the majesty of mountains, glaciers and Mont Blanc offers temporary relief.

Background: The Vale of Chamounix and Mont Blanc were Romantic pilgrimage sites; Percy Shelley wrote 'Mont Blanc' (1816).

Significance: The sublime landscape mirrors Victor's mind: grand, cold and overwhelming.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Settle in and write for five minutes: How does the mountain landscape reflect Victor's feelings? No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
Today's words are overhangs, lulling, glaciers, perpetrate, avalanche. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check Webster's. Here is the first: “I passed the bridge of Pélissier, where the ravine, which the river forms, opened before me, and I began to ascend the mountain that overhangs it.” Webster's says: To impend or hang over. Now the word history: “overhang”: over- (Old English ofer, "over"). Root not in our table: have students find it. “lull”: no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin. “glacier”: -er (Old English -ere, "one who"). Root not in our table: have students find it. Add each root to your etymology log.

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Present the historical and literary background.
Here is what the first readers of Frankenstein would have known. The Vale of Chamounix and Mont Blanc were Romantic pilgrimage sites; Percy Shelley wrote 'Mont Blanc' (1816). Why does this chapter matter? The sublime landscape mirrors Victor's mind: grand, cold and overwhelming. Write down one question you want answered.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for setting.
Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. I read a sentence, stop, and ask what the author is doing. When I see setting, I underline it and write in the margin what effect it has. Here I notice the diction and the sentence rhythm, and I connect them to despair and the sublime.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for Setting, Imagery, Tone / mood.
Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of setting. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.

> *Our house was the house of mourning. My father's health was deeply shaken by the horror of the recent events. Elizabeth was sad and desponding; she no longer took delight in her ordinary occupations; all pleasure seemed to her sacrilege toward the dead; eternal woe and tears she then thought was the just tribute she should pay to innocence so blasted and destroyed. She was no longer that happy creature, who in earlier youth wandered with me on the banks of the lake, and talked with ecstasy of our future prospects. The first of those sorrows which are sent to wean us from the earth, had visited her, and its dimming influence quenched her dearest smiles.*

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their rigor.
Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Setting, Imagery, Tone / mood: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; your level is already set. Middle-school version: In "Chapter IX," how does Shelley show despair and the sublime? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the chapter, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the setting you noticed as one piece of evidence. I will circulate and conference.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion (think-pair-share or a short Socratic circle).
Let's talk. Our question: How does this chapter connect to the costs of unchecked ambition? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
Take the chapter quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this chapter suggests about despair and the sublime, backed by one short quotation.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how setting shapes despair and the sublime. Tonight, read the next chapter and add two words to your etymology log.

Total: 90 minutes.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (Webster's 1913)	In context	Etymology note
overhangs	To impend or hang over	*I passed the bridge of Pélissier, where the ravine, which the river forms, opened before*	"overhang": over- (Old English ofer, "over"). Root

		me, and I began to ascend the mountain that overhangs it.	not in our table: have students find it.
lulling	To cause to rest by soothing influences	*The same lulling sounds acted as a lullaby to my too keen sensations: when I placed my head upon my pillow, sleep crept over me; I felt it as it came, and blessed the giver of oblivion.*	“lull”: no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin.
glaciers	An immense field or stream of ice, formed in the region of perpetual snow, and moving slowly down a mountain slope…	*Immense glaciers approached the road; I heard the rumbling thunder of the falling avalanche, and marked the smoke of its passage.*	“glacier”: -er (Old English -ere, "one who"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
perpetrate	To do or perform	*I had been the author of unalterable evils; and I lived in daily fear, lest the monster whom I had created should perpetrate some new wickedness.*	“perpetrate”: per- (Latin per, "through, thoroughly") + -ate (Latin -atus, "to make, having"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
avalanche	A large mass or body of snow and ice sliding swiftly down a mountain side, or falling down a precipice	*Immense glaciers approached the road; I heard the rumbling thunder of the falling avalanche, and marked the smoke of its passage.*	“avalanche”: no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin.
ephemeral	Beginning and ending in a day	*It was during an access of this kind that I suddenly left my home, and bending my steps towards the near Alpine valleys, sought in the magnificence, the eternity of such scenes, to forget myself and my ephemeral, because human, sorrows.*	“ephemeral”: -al (Latin -alis, "relating to"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
revisit	To visit again	*At these moments I wept bitterly, and wished that peace would revisit my mind only that I might afford them consolation and happiness.*	“revisit”: re- (Latin re-, "back, again") + vis (Latin videre, "to see"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary.
thirsted	A sensation of dryness in the throat associated with a craving for liquids, produced by deprivation of drink, or by…	*I had begun life with benevolent intentions, and thirsted for the moment when I should put them in practice, and make myself useful to my fellow-beings.*	“thirst”: no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin.
assassinated	To kill by surprise or secret assault	*William and Justine were assassinated, and the murderer escapes; he walks about the world free, and perhaps respected.*	“assassinate”: as- (Latin ad, "to") + -ate (Latin -atus, "to make, having"). Root not in

			our table: have students find it.
desponding	To give up, the will, courage, or spirit	*Elizabeth was sad and desponding; she no longer took delight in her ordinary occupations; all pleasure seemed to her sacrilege toward the dead; eternal woe and tears she then thought was the just tribute she should pay to innocence so blasted and destroyed.*	“despond”: de- (Latin de, "down from, away") + pon (Latin ponere, "to place"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary.

Discussion questions

1. How does the mountain landscape reflect Victor's feelings?
2. Where does setting appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with the sublime power of nature?

Annotation focus

- **Setting:** look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling
- **Imagery:** look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create
- **Tone / mood:** look for word choices that reveal the narrator's attitude or the scene's feeling

Chapter quiz

1. What does Victor consider in his despair?
   A. Suicide
   B. Becoming a monk
   C. Marrying at once
   D. Moving to England
2. Where does Victor travel for relief?
   A. The Alps near Chamounix
   B. The coast of Italy
   C. Ingolstadt
   D. London
3. Which mountain dominates the scenery?
   A. Ben Nevis
   B. Vesuvius
   C. Mont Blanc
   D. Everest
4. What literary idea describes the overwhelming landscape?
   A. Allegory
   B. The sublime
   C. Pastoral comedy

D. Satire

5. What effect does nature have on Victor?
   A. It makes him ill
   B. It bores him
   C. It soothes him for a time
   D. It angers him
6. In the line “I passed the bridge of Pélissier, where the ravine, which the river forms, opened before me, and I began to ascend the mountain that overhangs it.”, what does “overhangs” most nearly mean?
   A. An immense field or stream of ice, formed in the region of perpetual snow, and moving slowly down a mountain slope…
   B. To do or perform
   C. To impend or hang over
   D. To cause to rest by soothing influences
7. In the line “The same lulling sounds acted as a lullaby to my too keen sensations: when I placed my head upon my pillow, sleep crept over me; I felt it as it came, and blessed the giver of oblivion.”, what does “lulling” most nearly mean?
   A. To impend or hang over
   B. An immense field or stream of ice, formed in the region of perpetual snow, and moving slowly down a mountain slope…
   C. To do or perform
   D. To cause to rest by soothing influences

Answer key: 1. A (Suicide); 2. A (The Alps near Chamounix); 3. C (Mont Blanc); 4. B (The sublime); 5. C (It soothes him for a time); 6. C (To impend or hang over); 7. D (To cause to rest by soothing influences)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; RL.7.3, W.7.1): In “Chapter IX,” how does Shelley show despair and the sublime? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the chapter, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the setting you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In Chapter IX, how does Shelley develop the idea of despair and the sublime? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the setting in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Chapter IX develops the idea of despair and the sublime. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Chapter IX (where it begins, turns and ends) and its setting shape the reader's understanding of despair and the sublime. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Chapter IX suggests about despair and the sublime. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's setting and imagery), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; AP.RL.3, AP.W.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses setting in Chapter IX to complicate the reader's understanding of despair and the sublime. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; CF.RL.3, CF.W.1): Situate Chapter IX within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of despair and the sublime responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; C2.RL.3, C2.W.1): Read Chapter IX alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of despair and the sublime follows or bends those conventions, using the setting as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; C3.RL.3, C3.W.1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter IX and its treatment of despair and the sublime. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's setting and imagery, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; C4.RL.3, C4.W.1): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter IX as evidence for a larger claim about despair and the sublime in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; GR.RL.3, GR.W.1): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter IX as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of despair and the sublime. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *Immense glaciers approached the road; I heard the rumbling thunder of the falling avalanche, and marked the smoke of its passage.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “glaciers” most nearly mean?

   A. To give up, the will, courage, or spirit

   B. An immense field or stream of ice, formed in the region of perpetual snow, and moving slowly down a mountain slope…

   C. A sensation of dryness in the throat associated with a craving for liquids, produced by deprivation of drink, or by…

   D. To kill by surprise or secret assault

2. *Our house was the house of mourning. My father's health was deeply shaken by the horror of the recent events. Elizabeth was sad and desponding; she no longer took delight in her ordinary occupations; all pleasure seemed to her sacrilege toward the dead; eternal woe and tears she then thought was the just tribute she should pay to innocence so blasted and destroyed. She was no longer that happy creature, who in earlier youth wandered with me on the banks of the lake, and talked with ecstasy of our future prospects. The first of those sorrows which are sent to wean us from the earth, had visited her, and its dimming influence quenched her dearest smiles.*

Which choice best states a central concern of "Chapter IX"?

A. The first spark of obsession

B. Self-denial as a path

C. The hidden benefactor

D. Despair and the sublime

SAT key: 1. B (An immense field or stream of ice, formed in the region of perpetual snow, and moving slowly down a mountain slope…); 2. D (Despair and the sublime)

Lesson 16: Chapter X

Focus: confrontation between creator and creation

Teacher only · spoilers

On the glacier Montanvert, the creature approaches. Victor curses it; the creature answers eloquently, reminding Victor of his duties: 'I ought to be thy Adam, but I am rather the fallen angel.' He asks Victor to hear his story, and Victor follows him to a hut.

Background: Milton's Paradise Lost shapes the creature's self-understanding—God and Adam, Satan the outcast.

Significance: The creature's eloquence overturns expectations of a mindless monster and shifts our sympathies.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Settle in and write for five minutes: The creature says, 'I was benevolent and good; misery made me a fiend.' Do you believe him? No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
Today's words are pollutes, commiserate, inspiriting, diabolically, overlooks. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check Webster's. Here is the first: "We rise; one wand'ring thought pollutes the day." Webster's says: To make foul, impure, or unclean. Now the word history: "pollute": no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin. "commiserate": com- (Latin com-, "with, together") + -ate (Latin -atus, "to make, having"). Root not in our table: have students find it. "inspirit": in- (Latin in-, "not" or "in"). Root not in our table: have students find it. Add each root to your etymology log.

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Present the historical and literary background.
Here is what the first readers of Frankenstein would have known. Milton's Paradise Lost shapes the creature's self-understanding—God and Adam, Satan the outcast. Why does this chapter matter? The creature's eloquence overturns expectations of a mindless monster and shifts our sympathies. Write down one question you want answered.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for allusion.
Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. I read a sentence, stop, and ask what the author is doing. When I see allusion, I underline it and write in the margin what effect it has. Here I notice the diction and the sentence rhythm, and I connect them to confrontation between creator and creation.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for Allusion, Characterization, Irony.
Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of allusion. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.

> *We rest; a dream has power to poison sleep. We rise; one wand'ring thought pollutes the day. We feel, conceive, or reason; laugh or weep, Embrace fond woe, or cast our cares away; It is the same: for, be it joy or sorrow, The path of its departure still is free. Man's yesterday may ne'er be like his morrow; Nought may endure but mutability!*

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their rigor.
Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Allusion, Characterization, Irony: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; your level is already set. Middle-school version: In "Chapter X," how does Shelley show confrontation between creator and creation? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the chapter, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the allusion you noticed as one piece of evidence. I will circulate and conference.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion (think-pair-share or a short Socratic circle).
Let's talk. Our question: How does this chapter connect to the costs of unchecked ambition? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
Take the chapter quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this chapter suggests about confrontation between creator and creation, backed by one short quotation.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how allusion shapes confrontation between creator and creation. Tonight, read the next chapter and add two words to your etymology log.

Total: 90 minutes.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (Webster's 1913)	In context	Etymology note
pollutes	To make foul, impure, or unclean	*We rise; one wand'ring thought pollutes the day.*	"pollute": no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin.
commiserate			"commiserate": com- (Latin com-, "with, together") + -ate (Latin

	To feel sorrow, pain, or regret for	*Listen to my tale: when you have heard that, abandon or commiserate me, as you shall judge that I deserve.*	-atus, "to make, having"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
inspiriting	To infuse new life or spirit into	*All of soul-inspiriting fled with sleep, and dark melancholy clouded every thought.*	"inspirit": in- (Latin in-, "not" or "in"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
diabolically	Pertaining to the devil	*Begone, vile insect! or rather, stay, that I may trample you to dust! and, oh! that I could, with the extinction of your miserable existence, restore those victims whom you have so diabolically murdered!"*	"diabolical": -al (Latin -alis, "relating to"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
overlooks	To look down upon from a place that is over or above	*For some time I sat upon the rock that overlooks the sea of ice.*	"overlook": over- (Old English ofer, "over"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
misdeed	An evil deed	*Remember, that I am thy creature; I ought to be thy Adam; but I am rather the fallen angel, whom thou drivest from joy for no misdeed.*	"misdeed": mis- (Old English mis-, "wrongly"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
implores	To call upon, or for, in supplication	*Will no entreaties cause thee to turn a favourable eye upon thy creature, who implores thy goodness and compassion?*	"implore": im- (Latin in-, "not" or "in") + plor (Latin plorare, "to wail"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary.
illuminate	To make light	*The sun is yet high in the heavens; before it descends to hide itself behind yon snowy precipices, and illuminate another world, you will have heard my story, and can decide.*	"illuminate": il- (Latin in-, "not") + lum (Latin lumen, "light") + -ate (Latin -atus, "to make, having"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary.
barricade	(Mil.) A fortification, made in haste, of trees, earth, palisades, wagons, or anything that will obstruct the…	*I stood beside the sources of the Arveiron, which take their rise in a glacier, that with slow pace is advancing down from the summit of the hills, to barricade the valley.*	"barricade": no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin.
interspersed	To scatter or set here and there among other things	*The surface is very uneven, rising like the waves of a troubled sea, descending low, and interspersed by rifts that sink deep.*	"intersperse": inter- (Latin inter, "between"). Root not in our table: have students find it.

Discussion questions

1. The creature says, 'I was benevolent and good; misery made me a fiend.' Do you believe him?
2. Where does allusion appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.

3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with the costs of unchecked ambition?

Annotation focus

- **Allusion:** look for references to other books, myths, history or religion
- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- **Irony:** look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true

Chapter quiz

1. Where does Victor meet the creature?
   A. In Geneva
   B. In a church
   C. On the glacier at Montanvert
   D. On Walton's ship
2. How does the creature speak?
   A. Not at all
   B. In grunts
   C. Only in German
   D. Eloquently and persuasively
3. Which work does the creature allude to?
   A. Robinson Crusoe
   B. The Odyssey
   C. Paradise Lost
   D. Hamlet
4. What does the creature ask of Victor?
   A. To listen to his story
   B. To give him money
   C. To leave Europe
   D. To fight him
5. What is ironic about the creature's speech?
   A. He is silent
   B. He agrees with Victor
   C. He is afraid of ice
   D. The 'monster' is more reasonable than his creator
6. In the line “We rise; one wand’ring thought pollutes the day.”, what does “pollutes” most nearly mean?
   A. To feel sorrow, pain, or regret for
   B. To infuse new life or spirit into
   C. Pertaining to the devil
   D. To make foul, impure, or unclean

7. In the line “Listen to my tale: when you have heard that, abandon or commiserate me, as you shall judge that I deserve.”, what does “commiserate” most nearly mean?

   A. To infuse new life or spirit into

   B. Pertaining to the devil

   C. To make foul, impure, or unclean

   D. To feel sorrow, pain, or regret for

Answer key: 1. C (On the glacier at Montanvert); 2. D (Eloquently and persuasively); 3. C (Paradise Lost); 4. A (To listen to his story); 5. D (The 'monster' is more reasonable than his creator); 6. D (To make foul, impure, or unclean); 7. D (To feel sorrow, pain, or regret for)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; RL.7.9, W.7.1): In “Chapter X,” how does Shelley show confrontation between creator and creation? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the chapter, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the allusion you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; RL.9-10.9, W.9-10.1): In Chapter X, how does Shelley develop the idea of confrontation between creator and creation? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the allusion in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; RL.9-10.9, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Chapter X develops the idea of confrontation between creator and creation. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of allusion and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; RL.11-12.9, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Chapter X (where it begins, turns and ends) and its allusion shape the reader's understanding of confrontation between creator and creation. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; RL.11-12.9, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Chapter X suggests about confrontation between creator and creation. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's allusion and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; AP.RL.5, AP.W.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses allusion in Chapter X to complicate the reader's understanding of confrontation between creator and creation. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; CF.RL.5, CF.W.1): Situate Chapter X within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of confrontation between creator and creation responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; C2.RL.5, C2.W.1): Read Chapter X alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of confrontation between creator and creation follows or bends those conventions, using the allusion as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; C3.RL.5, C3.W.1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter X and its treatment of confrontation between creator and creation. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's allusion and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; C4.RL.5, C4.W.1): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter X as evidence for a larger claim about confrontation between creator and creation in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; GR.RL.5, GR.W.1): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter X as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of confrontation between creator and creation. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *All of soul-inspiriting fled with sleep, and dark melancholy clouded every thought.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “inspiriting” most nearly mean?

   A. To infuse new life or spirit into

   B. To make light

   C. To scatter or set here and there among other things

   D. (Mil.) A fortification, made in haste, of trees, earth, palisades, wagons, or anything that will obstruct the…

2. *We rest; a dream has power to poison sleep. We rise; one wand’ring thought pollutes the day. We feel, conceive, or reason; laugh or weep, Embrace fond woe, or cast our cares away; It is the same: for, be it joy or sorrow, The path of its departure still is free. Man’s yesterday may ne’er be like his morrow; Nought may endure but mutability!*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Chapter X”?

   A. A revelation from the colonel

   B. The accomplished woman

   C. Confrontation between creator and creation

   D. Keeping secrets

SAT key: 1. A (To infuse new life or spirit into); 2. C (Confrontation between creator and creation)

Lesson 17: Chapter XI

Focus: first experiences of the senses

Teacher only · spoilers

The creature narrates his first days: confusion of senses, cold, hunger, the discovery of fire, and the joy of moonlight and birdsong. Villagers attack him, and he shelters in a hovel beside a cottage.

Background: Philosophers like Locke argued that the mind begins as a 'blank slate' shaped by experience.

Significance: The creature's innocence makes society's violence toward him shocking and central to the nature-nurture debate.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Settle in and write for five minutes: What does the creature learn from fire—both good and painful? No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
Today's words are debilitated, canopied, incommoded, purloined, blackbird. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check Webster's. Here is the first: “He turned on hearing a noise; and, perceiving me, shrieked loudly, and, quitting the hut, ran across the fields with a speed of which his debilitated form hardly appeared capable.” Webster's says: To impair the strength of. Now the word history: “debilitate”: de- (Latin de, "down from, away") + -ate (Latin -atus, "to make, having"). Root not in our table: have students find it. “canopy”: no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin. “incommode”: in- (Latin in-, "not" or "in"). Root not in our table: have students find it. Add each root to your etymology log.

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Present the historical and literary background.
Here is what the first readers of Frankenstein would have known. Philosophers like Locke argued that the mind begins as a 'blank slate' shaped by experience. Why does this chapter matter? The creature's innocence makes society's violence toward him shocking and central to the nature-nurture debate. Write down one question you want answered.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for point of view.
Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. I read a sentence, stop, and ask what the author is doing. When I see point of view, I underline it and write in the margin what effect it has. Here I notice the diction and the sentence rhythm, and I connect them to first experiences of the senses.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for Point of view, Imagery, Characterization.
Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of point of view. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.

> *"The moon had disappeared from the night, and again, with a lessened form, showed itself, while I still remained in the forest. My sensations had, by this time, become distinct, and my mind received every day additional ideas. My eyes became accustomed to the light, and to perceive objects in their right forms; I distinguished the insect from the herb, and, by degrees, one herb from another. I found that the sparrow uttered none but harsh notes, whilst those of the blackbird and thrush were sweet and enticing.*

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their rigor.
Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Point of view, Imagery, Characterization: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; your level is already set. Middle-school version: In "Chapter XI," how does Shelley show first experiences of the senses? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the chapter, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the point of view you noticed as one piece of evidence. I will circulate and conference.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion (think-pair-share or a short Socratic circle).
Let's talk. Our question: How does this chapter connect to the costs of unchecked ambition? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
Take the chapter quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this chapter suggests about first experiences of the senses, backed by one short quotation.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how point of view shapes first experiences of the senses. Tonight, read the next chapter and add two words to your etymology log.

Total: 90 minutes.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (Webster's 1913)	In context	Etymology note
debilitated	To impair the strength of	*He turned on hearing a noise; and, perceiving me, shrieked loudly, and, quitting the hut, ran across the fields with a speed of which his debilitated form hardly appeared capable.*	"debilitate": de- (Latin de, "down from, away") + -ate (Latin -atus, "to make, having"). Root not in our table: have students find it.

canopied	A covering fixed over a bed, dais, or the like, or carried on poles over an exalted personage or a sacred object, etc	*I began also to observe, with greater accuracy, the forms that surrounded me, and to perceive the boundaries of the radiant roof of light which canopied me.*	"canopy": no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin.
incommoded	To give inconvenience or trouble to	*As she walked along, seemingly incommoded by the burden, a young man met her, whose countenance expressed a deeper despondence.*	"incommode": in- (Latin in-, "not" or "in"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
purloined	To take or carry away for one's self	*I had first, however, provided for my sustenance for that day, by a loaf of coarse bread, which I purloined, and a cup with which I could drink, more conveniently than from my hand, of the pure water which flowed by my retreat.*	"purloin": no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin.
blackbird	In England, a species of thrush (Turdus merula), a singing bird with a fin note	*I found that the sparrow uttered none but harsh notes, whilst those of the blackbird and thrush were sweet and enticing.*	"blackbird": no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin.
wearying	Having the strength exhausted by toil or exertion	*The light became more and more oppressive to me; and, the heat wearying me as I walked, I sought a place where I could receive shade.*	"weary": no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin.
enticed	To draw on, by exciting hope or desire	*The silver hair and benevolent countenance of the aged cottager won my reverence, while the gentle manners of the girl enticed my love.*	"entice": en- (French en-/ Latin in-, "into"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
carpeted	A heavy woven or felted fabric, usually of wool, but also of cotton, hemp, straw, etc.; esp	*"Having thus arranged my dwelling, and carpeted it with clean straw, I retired; for I saw the figure of a man at a distance, and I remembered too well my treatment the night before, to trust myself in his power.*	"carpet": no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin.
intercepted	To take or seize by the way, or before arrival at the destined place	*I was delighted when I first discovered that a pleasant sound, which often saluted my ears, proceeded from the throats of the little winged animals who had often intercepted the light from my eyes.*	"intercept": inter- (Latin inter, "between") + cept (Latin capere, "to take"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary.
surmount	To rise above	*Before, dark and opaque bodies had surrounded me, impervious to my touch*	"surmount": no root in our classroom table; have students

		or sight; but I now found that I could wander on at liberty, with no obstacles which I could not either surmount or avoid.	look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin.

Discussion questions

1. What does the creature learn from fire—both good and painful?
2. Where does point of view appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with creation and responsibility?

Annotation focus

- **Point of view:** look for who is telling the story and what that narrator can and cannot know
- **Imagery:** look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create
- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them

Chapter quiz

1. Who narrates this chapter?
   A. Elizabeth
   B. Walton
   C. The creature
   D. Victor
2. What does the creature discover that both warms and burns?
   A. Fire
   B. Iron
   C. Water
   D. Snow
3. How do villagers react to him?
   A. They ignore him
   B. They welcome him
   C. They worship him
   D. They attack him
4. Where does he take shelter?
   A. A cave in the Alps
   B. A hovel attached to a cottage
   C. A castle
   D. A church
5. What pleases him in nature?
   A. Moonlight and birdsong
   B. Machines
   C. Thunder

D. Crowded towns

6. In the line “He turned on hearing a noise; and, perceiving me, shrieked loudly, and, quitting the hut, ran across the fields with a speed of which his debilitated form hardly appeared capable.”, what does “debilitated” most nearly mean?
   A. To give inconvenience or trouble to
   B. To take or carry away for one's self
   C. To impair the strength of
   D. A covering fixed over a bed, dais, or the like, or carried on poles over an exalted personage or a sacred object, etc
7. In the line “I began also to observe, with greater accuracy, the forms that surrounded me, and to perceive the boundaries of the radiant roof of light which canopied me.”, what does “canopied” most nearly mean?
   A. To give inconvenience or trouble to
   B. To impair the strength of
   C. A covering fixed over a bed, dais, or the like, or carried on poles over an exalted personage or a sacred object, etc
   D. To take or carry away for one's self

Answer key: 1. C (The creature); 2. A (Fire); 3. D (They attack him); 4. B (A hovel attached to a cottage); 5. A (Moonlight and birdsong); 6. C (To impair the strength of); 7. C (A covering fixed over a bed, dais, or the like, or carried on poles over an exalted personage or a sacred object, etc)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; RL.7.6, W.7.1): In “Chapter XI,” how does Shelley show first experiences of the senses? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the chapter, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the point of view you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): In Chapter XI, how does Shelley develop the idea of first experiences of the senses? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the point of view in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Chapter XI develops the idea of first experiences of the senses. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of point of view and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Chapter XI (where it begins, turns and ends) and its point of view shape the reader's understanding of first experiences of the senses. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Chapter XI suggests about first experiences of the senses. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's point of view and imagery), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; AP.RL.3, AP.W.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses point of view in Chapter XI to complicate the reader's understanding of first experiences of the senses. Develop

a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; CF.RL.3, CF.W.1): Situate Chapter XI within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of first experiences of the senses responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; C2.RL.3, C2.W.1): Read Chapter XI alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of first experiences of the senses follows or bends those conventions, using the point of view as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; C3.RL.3, C3.W.1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter XI and its treatment of first experiences of the senses. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's point of view and imagery, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; C4.RL.3, C4.W.1): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter XI as evidence for a larger claim about first experiences of the senses in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; GR.RL.3, GR.W.1): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter XI as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of first experiences of the senses. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *As she walked along, seemingly incommoded by the burden, a young man met her, whose countenance expressed a deeper despondence.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “incommoded” most nearly mean?

   A. A heavy woven or felted fabric, usually of wool, but also of cotton, hemp, straw, etc.; esp

   B. To take or seize by the way, or before arrival at the destined place

   C. To give inconvenience or trouble to

   D. To rise above

2. *“The moon had disappeared from the night, and again, with a lessened form, showed itself, while I still remained in the forest. My sensations had, by this time, become distinct, and my mind received every day additional ideas. My eyes became accustomed to the light, and to perceive objects in their right forms; I distinguished the insect from the herb, and, by degrees, one herb from another. I found that the sparrow uttered none but harsh notes, whilst those of the blackbird and thrush were sweet and enticing.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Chapter XI”?

   A. Rejection and the turn to revenge

B. A changed Darcy

C. Puzzling visits

D. First experiences of the senses

SAT key: 1. C (To give inconvenience or trouble to); 2. D (First experiences of the senses)

Lesson 18: Chapter XII

Focus: learning compassion by watching

Teacher only · spoilers

Hidden, the creature observes the De Lacey family: the blind old father, Felix and Agatha. Seeing their poverty, he stops stealing their food and secretly gathers firewood for them. He begins to understand speech. Catching sight of his reflection in a pool, he is horrified at his own appearance.

Background: The cottage represents the domestic ideal praised in the Preface.

Significance: The creature's kindness shows his capacity for virtue before rejection hardens him.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Settle in and write for five minutes: What does the creature's secret help reveal about his nature? No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
Today's words are exhilarated, arbiters, execration, endeared, enhanced. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check Webster's. Here is the first: ""These thoughts exhilarated me, and led me to apply with fresh ardour to the acquiring the art of language." Webster's says: To make merry or jolly. Now the word history: "exhilarate": ex- (Latin ex, "out of") + -ate (Latin -atus, "to make, having"). Root not in our table: have students find it. "arbiter": -er (Old English -ere, "one who"). Root not in our table: have students find it. "execration": ex- (Latin ex, "out of") + -ation (Latin -atio, "the act or result of"). Root not in our table: have students find it. Add each root to your etymology log.

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Present the historical and literary background.
Here is what the first readers of Frankenstein would have known. The cottage represents the domestic ideal praised in the Preface. Why does this chapter matter? The creature's kindness shows his capacity for virtue before rejection hardens him. Write down one question you want answered.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for characterization.
Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. I read a sentence, stop, and ask what the author is doing. When I see characterization, I underline it and write in the margin what effect it has. Here I notice the diction and the sentence rhythm, and I connect them to learning compassion by watching.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for Characterization, Setting, Theme.
Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of characterization. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.

> *"I remember, the first time that I did this, the young woman, when she opened the door in the morning, appeared greatly astonished on seeing a great pile of wood on the outside. She uttered some words in a loud voice, and the youth joined her, who also expressed surprise. I observed, with pleasure, that he did not go to the forest that day, but spent it in repairing the cottage, and cultivating the garden.*

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their rigor.
Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Characterization, Setting, Theme: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; your level is already set. Middle-school version: In "Chapter XII," how does Shelley show learning compassion by watching? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the chapter, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence. I will circulate and conference.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion (think-pair-share or a short Socratic circle).
Let's talk. Our question: How does this chapter connect to the costs of unchecked ambition? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
Take the chapter quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this chapter suggests about learning compassion by watching, backed by one short quotation.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how characterization shapes learning compassion by watching. Tonight, read the next chapter and add two words to your etymology log.

Total: 90 minutes.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (Webster's 1913)	In context	Etymology note
exhilarated	To make merry or jolly	*"These thoughts exhilarated me, and led me to apply with fresh ardour to the acquiring the art of language.*	"exhilarate": ex- (Latin ex, "out of") + -ate (Latin -atus, "to make, having"). Root not in our table: have students find it.

arbiters	A person appointed, or chosen, by parties to determine a controversy between them	*I looked upon them as superior beings, who would be the arbiters of my future destiny.*	“arbiter”: -er (Old English -ere, "one who"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
execration	The act of cursing	*It was as the ass and the lapdog; yet surely the gentle ass whose intentions were affectionate, although his manners were rude, deserved better treatment than blows and execration.*	“execration”: ex- (Latin ex, "out of") + -ation (Latin -atio, "the act or result of"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
endeared	To make dear or beloved	*The gentle manners and beauty of the cottagers greatly endeared them to me: when they were unhappy, I felt depressed; when they rejoiced, I sympathised in their joys.*	“endear”: en- (French en-/Latin in-, "into"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
enhanced	To raise or lift up	*I saw few human beings beside them; and if any other happened to enter the cottage, their harsh manners and rude gait only enhanced to me the superior accomplishments of my friends.*	“enhance”: en- (French en-/Latin in-, "into"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
pronunciation	The act of uttering with articulation	*Their pronunciation was quick; and the words they uttered, not having any apparent connection with visible objects, I was unable to discover any clue by which I could unravel the mystery of their reference.*	“pronunciation”: pro- (Latin pro, "forward, for") + -ation (Latin -atio, "the act or result of"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
cultivating	To bestow attention, care, and labor upon, with a view to valuable returns	*I observed, with pleasure, that he did not go to the forest that day, but spent it in repairing the cottage, and cultivating the garden.*	“cultivate”: -ate (Latin -atus, "to make, having"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
starlight	The light given by the stars	*When they had retired to rest, if there was any moon, or the night was starlight, I went into the woods, and collected my own food and fuel for the cottage.*	“starlight”: no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin.
conjectured	An opinion, or judgment, formed on defective or presumptive evidence	*I conjectured, therefore, that he found on the paper signs for speech which he understood, and I ardently longed to comprehend these also; but how was that possible, when I did not even understand the sounds for which they stood as signs?*	“conjecture”: con- (Latin com-, "with, together") + ject (Latin iacere, "to throw") + -ure (Latin -ura, "act, result"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary.

communicating	To share in common	*I found that these people possessed a method of communicating their experience and feelings to one another by articulate sounds.*	“communicate”: com- (Latin com-, "with, together") + -ate (Latin -atus, "to make, having"). Root not in our table: have students find it.

Discussion questions

1. What does the creature's secret help reveal about his nature?
2. Where does characterization appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with isolation and the need for companionship?

Annotation focus

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- **Setting:** look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling
- **Theme:** look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas

Chapter quiz

1. Whom does the creature observe?
   A. Villagers in Geneva
   B. The Frankensteins
   C. The De Lacey family
   D. Walton's crew
2. Which family member is blind?
   A. Safie
   B. Agatha
   C. Felix
   D. The old father
3. Why does the creature stop taking their food?
   A. He gets caught
   B. He realizes they are poor
   C. He finds better food
   D. They lock it up
4. What does the creature see in a clear pool?
   A. A fish
   B. The moon only
   C. His own frightening reflection
   D. Victor
5. What does he begin to learn?
   A. Language

B. Swimming

C. Chemistry

D. Music

6. In the line ““These thoughts exhilarated me, and led me to apply with fresh ardour to the acquiring the art of language.”, what does “exhilarated” most nearly mean?

A. The act of cursing

B. To make dear or beloved

C. A person appointed, or chosen, by parties to determine a controversy between them

D. To make merry or jolly

7. In the line “I looked upon them as superior beings, who would be the arbiters of my future destiny.”, what does “arbiters” most nearly mean?

A. To make merry or jolly

B. To make dear or beloved

C. A person appointed, or chosen, by parties to determine a controversy between them

D. The act of cursing

Answer key: 1. C (The De Lacey family); 2. D (The old father); 3. B (He realizes they are poor); 4. C (His own frightening reflection); 5. A (Language); 6. D (To make merry or jolly); 7. C (A person appointed, or chosen, by parties to determine a controversy between them)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; RL.7.3, W.7.1): In “Chapter XII,” how does Shelley show learning compassion by watching? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the chapter, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In Chapter XII, how does Shelley develop the idea of learning compassion by watching? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the characterization in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Chapter XII develops the idea of learning compassion by watching. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and setting shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Chapter XII (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's understanding of learning compassion by watching. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Chapter XII suggests about learning compassion by watching. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's characterization and setting), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; AP.RL.2, AP.W.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses characterization in Chapter XII to complicate the reader's understanding of learning compassion by watching. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; CF.RL.2, CF.W.1): Situate Chapter XII within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of learning compassion by watching responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; C2.RL.2, C2.W.1): Read Chapter XII alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of learning compassion by watching follows or bends those conventions, using the characterization as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; C3.RL.2, C3.W.1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter XII and its treatment of learning compassion by watching. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's characterization and setting, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; C4.RL.2, C4.W.1): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter XII as evidence for a larger claim about learning compassion by watching in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; GR.RL.2, GR.W.1): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter XII as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of learning compassion by watching. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *It was as the ass and the lapdog; yet surely the gentle ass whose intentions were affectionate, although his manners were rude, deserved better treatment than blows and execration.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “execration” most nearly mean?

   A. To share in common

   B. The light given by the stars

   C. The act of cursing

   D. An opinion, or judgment, formed on defective or presumptive evidence

2. *“I remember, the first time that I did this, the young woman, when she opened the door in the morning, appeared greatly astonished on seeing a great pile of wood on the outside. She uttered some words in a loud voice, and the youth joined her, who also expressed surprise. I observed, with pleasure, that he did not go to the forest that day, but spent it in repairing the cottage, and cultivating the garden.*

Which choice best states a central concern of "Chapter XII"?

A. A changed Darcy

B. Embarrassing relations

C. Learning compassion by watching

D. Destroying the companion

SAT key: 1. C (The act of cursing); 2. C (Learning compassion by watching)

Lesson 19: Chapter XIII

Focus: language, knowledge and sorrow

Teacher only · spoilers

Spring comes, and Safie, an Arabian woman beloved by Felix, arrives. As Felix teaches her using Volney's 'Ruins of Empires,' the creature learns language and history alongside her. He learns of wealth, rank and injustice, realizes he has no family, money or name, and asks, 'What was I?' Knowledge deepens his misery.

Background: Volney's 'Ruins of Empires' (1791) was a radical history critiquing tyranny and religion; debates about property and rank reflect revolutionary thought after 1789.

Significance: Language opens knowledge and pain together, echoing Victor's own discovery that knowledge can isolate.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Settle in and write for five minutes: The creature wishes he could forget what he learned. Is knowledge always good? No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
Today's words are narrations, recommencing, dissipates, degenerating, disowned. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check Webster's. Here is the first: ""These wonderful narrations inspired me with strange feelings." Webster's says: The act of telling or relating the particulars of an event. Now the word history: "narration": -ation (Latin -atio, "the act or result of"). Root not in our table: have students find it. "recommence": re- (Latin re-, "back, again") + -ence (Latin -entia, "state of"). Root not in our table: have students find it. "dissipate": dis- (Latin dis-, "apart, not") + -ate (Latin -atus, "to make, having"). Root not in our table: have students find it. Add each root to your etymology log.

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Present the historical and literary background.
Here is what the first readers of Frankenstein would have known. Volney's 'Ruins of Empires' (1791) was a radical history critiquing tyranny and religion; debates about property and rank reflect revolutionary thought after 1789. Why does this chapter matter? Language opens knowledge and pain together, echoing Victor's own discovery that knowledge can isolate. Write down one question you want answered.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for allusion.
Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. I read a sentence, stop, and ask what the author is doing. When I see allusion, I underline it and write in the margin what effect it has. Here I notice the diction and the sentence rhythm, and I connect them to language, knowledge and sorrow.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for Allusion, Theme, Irony.
Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of allusion. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.

> *"It was on one of these days, when my cottagers periodically rested from labour—the old man played on his guitar, and the children listened to him—that I observed the countenance of Felix was melancholy beyond expression; he sighed frequently; and once his father paused in his music, and I conjectured by his manner that he enquired the cause of his son's sorrow. Felix replied in a cheerful accent, and the old man was recommencing his music, when someone tapped at the door.*

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their rigor.
Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Allusion, Theme, Irony: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; your level is already set. Middle-school version: In "Chapter XIII," how does Shelley show language, knowledge and sorrow? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the chapter, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the allusion you noticed as one piece of evidence. I will circulate and conference.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion (think-pair-share or a short Socratic circle).
Let's talk. Our question: How does this chapter connect to the costs of unchecked ambition? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
Take the chapter quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this chapter suggests about language, knowledge and sorrow, backed by one short quotation.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how allusion shapes language, knowledge and sorrow. Tonight, read the next chapter and add two words to your etymology log.

Total: 90 minutes.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word		In context	Etymology note

	Definition (Webster's 1913)		
narrations	The act of telling or relating the particulars of an event	*"These wonderful narrations inspired me with strange feelings.*	"narration": -ation (Latin -atio, "the act or result of"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
recommencing	To commence or begin again	*Felix replied in a cheerful accent, and the old man was recommencing his music, when someone tapped at the door.*	"recommence": re- (Latin re-, "back, again") + -ence (Latin -entia, "state of"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
dissipates	To scatter completely	*They made many signs which I did not comprehend; but I saw that her presence diffused gladness through the cottage, dispelling their sorrow as the sun dissipates the morning mists.*	"dissipate": dis- (Latin dis-, "apart, not") + -ate (Latin -atus, "to make, having"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
degenerating	Having become worse than one's kind, or one's former state	*I heard of the slothful Asiatics; of the stupendous genius and mental activity of the Grecians; of the wars and wonderful virtue of the early Romans—of their subsequent degenerating—of the decline of that mighty empire; of chivalry, Christianity, and kings.*	"degenerate": de- (Latin de, "down from, away") + gen (Latin/Greek genus, "birth, kind") + -ate (Latin -atus, "to make, having"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary.
disowned	To refuse to own or acknowledge as belonging to one's self	*Was I then a monster, a blot upon the earth, from which all men fled, and whom all men disowned?*	"disown": no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin.
wondrously	In a wonderful or surprising manner or degree	*Her hair of a shining raven black, and curiously braided; her eyes were dark, but gentle, although animated; her features of a regular proportion, and her complexion wondrously fair, each cheek tinged with a lovely pink.*	"wondrous": -ous (Latin -osus, "full of"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
hideously	Frightful, shocking, or offensive to the eyes	*I was, besides, endued with a figure hideously deformed and loathsome; I was not even of the same nature as man.*	"hideous": -ous (Latin -osus, "full of"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
enraptured	To transport with pleasure	*The old man appeared enraptured, and said some words, which Agatha endeavoured to explain to Safie, and by which he appeared to wish to express that she bestowed on him the greatest delight by her music.*	"enrapture": en- (French en-/Latin in-, "into") + -ure (Latin -ura, "act, result"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
braided	To weave, interlace, or entwine	*Her hair of a shining raven black, and curiously braided; her eyes were dark, but*	"braid": no root in our classroom table; have students look it up

	together, as three or more strands or threads	*gentle, although animated; her features of a regular proportion, and her complexion wondrously fair, each cheek tinged with a lovely pink.*	(Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin.
dismount	To come down	*He assisted her to dismount, and dismissing her guide, conducted her into the cottage.*	“dismount”: dis- (Latin dis-, "apart, not"). Root not in our table: have students find it.

Discussion questions

1. The creature wishes he could forget what he learned. Is knowledge always good?
2. Where does allusion appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with nature versus nurture?

Annotation focus

- **Allusion:** look for references to other books, myths, history or religion
- **Theme:** look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas
- **Irony:** look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true

Chapter quiz

1. Who arrives at the cottage?
   A. Safie
   B. Elizabeth
   C. Clerval
   D. Justine
2. How does Safie's arrival help the creature?
   A. She befriends him
   B. He learns language as she is taught
   C. She brings him chemistry books
   D. She feeds him
3. Which book does Felix read to Safie?
   A. Ruins of Empires
   B. The Bible
   C. Paradise Lost
   D. Plutarch's Lives
4. What question does the creature ask himself?
   A. Why is it cold?
   B. What was I?
   C. Who is Walton?
   D. Where is Geneva?

5. How does knowledge affect him?
   A. It cures his loneliness
   B. It increases his sorrow
   C. It makes him rich
   D. It makes him content
6. In the line ““These wonderful narrations inspired me with strange feelings.”, what does “narrations” most nearly mean?
   A. To scatter completely
   B. The act of telling or relating the particulars of an event
   C. Having become worse than one's kind, or one's former state
   D. To commence or begin again
7. In the line “Felix replied in a cheerful accent, and the old man was recommencing his music, when someone tapped at the door.”, what does “recommencing” most nearly mean?
   A. To commence or begin again
   B. To scatter completely
   C. The act of telling or relating the particulars of an event
   D. Having become worse than one's kind, or one's former state

Answer key: 1. A (Safie); 2. B (He learns language as she is taught); 3. A (Ruins of Empires); 4. B (What was I?); 5. B (It increases his sorrow); 6. B (The act of telling or relating the particulars of an event); 7. A (To commence or begin again)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; RL.7.9, W.7.1): In “Chapter XIII,” how does Shelley show language, knowledge and sorrow? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the chapter, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the allusion you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; RL.9-10.9, W.9-10.1): In Chapter XIII, how does Shelley develop the idea of language, knowledge and sorrow? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the allusion in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; RL.9-10.9, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Chapter XIII develops the idea of language, knowledge and sorrow. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of allusion and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; RL.11-12.9, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Chapter XIII (where it begins, turns and ends) and its allusion shape the reader's understanding of language, knowledge and sorrow. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; RL.11-12.9, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Chapter XIII suggests about language, knowledge and sorrow. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's allusion and theme), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; AP.RL.5, AP.W.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses allusion in Chapter XIII to complicate the reader's understanding of language, knowledge and sorrow. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; CF.RL.5, CF.W.1): Situate Chapter XIII within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of language, knowledge and sorrow responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; C2.RL.5, C2.W.1): Read Chapter XIII alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of language, knowledge and sorrow follows or bends those conventions, using the allusion as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; C3.RL.5, C3.W.1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter XIII and its treatment of language, knowledge and sorrow. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's allusion and theme, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; C4.RL.5, C4.W.1): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter XIII as evidence for a larger claim about language, knowledge and sorrow in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; GR.RL.5, GR.W.1): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter XIII as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of language, knowledge and sorrow. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *They made many signs which I did not comprehend; but I saw that her presence diffused gladness through the cottage, dispelling their sorrow as the sun dissipates the morning mists.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “dissipates” most nearly mean?

   A. To come down

   B. To scatter completely

   C. To weave, interlace, or entwine together, as three or more strands or threads

   D. To transport with pleasure

2. *“It was on one of these days, when my cottagers periodically rested from labour—the old man played on his guitar, and the children listened to him—that I observed the countenance of Felix was melancholy beyond expression; he sighed frequently; and once his father paused in his music, and I conjectured by his manner that he enquired the cause of his son’s sorrow. Felix replied in a cheerful accent, and the old man was recommencing his music, when someone tapped at the door.*

Which choice best states a central concern of "Chapter XIII"?

A. Hearing the many voices

B. Language, knowledge and sorrow

C. Cold reception

D. Wisdom cannot be taught

SAT key: 1. B (To scatter completely); 2. B (Language, knowledge and sorrow)

Lesson 20: Chapter XIV

Focus: injustice and exile

Teacher only · spoilers

The creature learns the De Laceys' history: Felix helped Safie's father, a Turkish merchant, escape unjust execution in Paris; the merchant betrayed them, and the family lost wealth and was exiled. Safie fled to find Felix.

Background: The story reflects prejudices and politics of 18th-century France and attitudes toward the Ottoman world.

Significance: Injustice repeats across the book; the virtuous suffer, and betrayal is common.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Settle in and write for five minutes: How does the De Laceys' story parallel the creature's own situation? No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
Today's words are facilitated, reiterating, expostulate, passports, noisome. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check Webster's. Here is the first: "His plans were facilitated by the news which arrived from Paris." Webster's says: To make easy or less difficult. Now the word history: "facilitate": fac (Latin facere, "to make, do") + -ate (Latin -atus, "to make, having"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary. "reiterate": re- (Latin re-, "back, again") + -ate (Latin -atus, "to make, having"). Root not in our table: have students find it. "expostulate": ex- (Latin ex, "out of") + pos (Latin ponere, "to place") + -ate (Latin -atus, "to make, having"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary. Add each root to your etymology log.

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Present the historical and literary background.
Here is what the first readers of Frankenstein would have known. The story reflects prejudices and politics of 18th-century France and attitudes toward the Ottoman world. Why does this chapter matter? Injustice repeats across the book; the virtuous suffer, and betrayal is common. Write down one question you want answered.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for plot.
Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. I read a sentence, stop, and ask what the author is doing. When I see plot, I underline it and write in the margin what effect it has. Here I notice the diction and the sentence rhythm, and I connect them to injustice and exile.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for Plot, Characterization, Irony.
Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of plot. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.

> *"The name of the old man was De Lacey. He was descended from a good family in France, where he had lived for many years in affluence, respected by his superiors, and beloved by his equals. His son was bred in the service of his country; and Agatha had ranked with ladies of the highest distinction. A few months before my arrival, they had lived in a large and luxurious city, called Paris, surrounded by friends, and possessed of every enjoyment which virtue, refinement of intellect, or taste, accompanied by a moderate fortune, could afford.*

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their rigor.
Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Plot, Characterization, Irony: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; your level is already set. Middle-school version: In "Chapter XIV," how does Shelley show injustice and exile? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the chapter, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the plot you noticed as one piece of evidence. I will circulate and conference.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion (think-pair-share or a short Socratic circle).
Let's talk. Our question: How does this chapter connect to the costs of unchecked ambition? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
Take the chapter quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this chapter suggests about injustice and exile, backed by one short quotation.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how plot shapes injustice and exile. Tonight, read the next chapter and add two words to your etymology log.

Total: 90 minutes.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (Webster's 1913)	In context	Etymology note
facilitated	To make easy or less difficult	*His plans were facilitated by the news which arrived from Paris.*	"facilitate": fac (Latin facere, "to make, do") + -ate (Latin -atus, "to make, having"). Teacher note from

			a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary.
reiterating	To repeat again and again	*The generous nature of Safie was outraged by this command; she attempted to expostulate with her father, but he left her angrily, reiterating his tyrannical mandate.*	“reiterate”: re- (Latin re-, "back, again") + -ate (Latin -atus, "to make, having"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
expostulate	To reason earnestly with a person on some impropriety of his conduct, representing the wrong he has done or intends,…	*The generous nature of Safie was outraged by this command; she attempted to expostulate with her father, but he left her angrily, reiterating his tyrannical mandate.*	“expostulate”: ex- (Latin ex, "out of") + pos (Latin ponere, "to place") + -ate (Latin -atus, "to make, having"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary.
passports	Permission to pass	*Felix had procured passports in the name of his father, sister, and himself.*	“passport”: port (Latin portare, "to carry"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary.
noisome	Noxious to health	*His blind and aged father, and his gentle sister, lay in a noisome dungeon, while he enjoyed the free air, and the society of her whom he loved.*	“noisome”: no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin.
affluence	A flowing to or towards	*He was descended from a good family in France, where he had lived for many years in affluence, respected by his superiors, and beloved by his equals.*	“affluence”: af- (Latin ad, "to") + flu (Latin fluere, "to flow") + -ence (Latin -entia, "state of"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary.
mandate	An official or authoritative command	*The generous nature of Safie was outraged by this command; she attempted to expostulate with her father, but he left her angrily, reiterating his tyrannical mandate.*	“mandate”: man (Latin manus, "hand") + -ate (Latin -atus, "to make, having"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary.
spurned	To drive back or away, as with the foot	*The young girl spoke in high and enthusiastic terms of her mother, who, born in freedom, spurned the bondage to which she was now reduced.*	“spurn”: no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin.
uncontrollable	Incapable of being controlled	*“Felix had accidentally been present at the trial; his horror and indignation were uncontrollable,*	“uncontrollable”: un- (Old English un-, "not") + -able (Latin -abilis, "able to be"). Root not in our table: have students find it.

		when he heard the decision of the court.	
revolved	To turn or roll round on, or as on, an axis, like a wheel	*He revolved a thousand plans by which he should be enabled to prolong the deceit until it might be no longer necessary, and secretly to take his daughter with him when he departed.*	“revolve”: re- (Latin re-, "back, again"). Root not in our table: have students find it.

Discussion questions

1. How does the De Laceys' story parallel the creature's own situation?
2. Where does plot appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with the sublime power of nature?

Annotation focus

- **Plot:** look for key events and the causes linking them
- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- **Irony:** look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true

Chapter quiz

1. Why were the De Laceys exiled?
   A. Felix helped a Turkish merchant escape
   B. They were scientists
   C. They stole money
   D. They insulted the king
2. Who betrayed them?
   A. Agatha
   B. Safie
   C. Victor
   D. Safie's father
3. Where did these events take place?
   A. Paris
   B. London
   C. Constantinople
   D. Ingolstadt
4. How does Safie show courage?
   A. She runs a business
   B. She travels alone to find Felix
   C. She becomes a judge
   D. She fights soldiers

5. What larger pattern does this story show?
   A. Wealth guarantees happiness
   B. The virtuous often suffer injustice
   C. Crime is always punished
   D. Travel is safe
6. In the line “His plans were facilitated by the news which arrived from Paris.”, what does “facilitated” most nearly mean?
   A. To reason earnestly with a person on some impropriety of his conduct, representing the wrong he has done or intends,…
   B. To repeat again and again
   C. Permission to pass
   D. To make easy or less difficult
7. In the line “The generous nature of Safie was outraged by this command; she attempted to expostulate with her father, but he left her angrily, reiterating his tyrannical mandate.”, what does “reiterating” most nearly mean?
   A. To make easy or less difficult
   B. To repeat again and again
   C. Permission to pass
   D. To reason earnestly with a person on some impropriety of his conduct, representing the wrong he has done or intends,…

Answer key: 1. A (Felix helped a Turkish merchant escape); 2. D (Safie's father); 3. A (Paris); 4. B (She travels alone to find Felix); 5. B (The virtuous often suffer injustice); 6. D (To make easy or less difficult); 7. B (To repeat again and again)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; RL.7.3, W.7.1): In “Chapter XIV,” how does Shelley show injustice and exile? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the chapter, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the plot you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In Chapter XIV, how does Shelley develop the idea of injustice and exile? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the plot in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Chapter XIV develops the idea of injustice and exile. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of plot and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Chapter XIV (where it begins, turns and ends) and its plot shape the reader's understanding of injustice and exile. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Chapter XIV suggests about injustice and exile. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's plot and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; AP.RL.2, AP.W.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses plot in Chapter XIV to complicate the reader's understanding of injustice and exile. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; CF.RL.2, CF.W.1): Situate Chapter XIV within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of injustice and exile responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; C2.RL.2, C2.W.1): Read Chapter XIV alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of injustice and exile follows or bends those conventions, using the plot as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; C3.RL.2, C3.W.1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter XIV and its treatment of injustice and exile. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's plot and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; C4.RL.2, C4.W.1): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter XIV as evidence for a larger claim about injustice and exile in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; GR.RL.2, GR.W.1): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter XIV as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of injustice and exile. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *The generous nature of Safie was outraged by this command; she attempted to expostulate with her father, but he left her angrily, reiterating his tyrannical mandate.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “expostulate” most nearly mean?

   A. To drive back or away, as with the foot

   B. Incapable of being controlled

   C. To turn or roll round on, or as on, an axis, like a wheel

   D. To reason earnestly with a person on some impropriety of his conduct, representing the wrong he has done or intends,…

2. *"The name of the old man was De Lacey. He was descended from a good family in France, where he had lived for many years in affluence, respected by his superiors, and beloved by his equals. His son was bred in the service of his country; and Agatha had ranked with ladies of the highest distinction. A few months before my arrival, they had lived in a large and luxurious city, called Paris, surrounded by friends, and possessed of every enjoyment which virtue, refinement of intellect, or taste, accompanied by a moderate fortune, could afford.*

Which choice best states a central concern of "Chapter XIV"?

A. Farewells at Hunsford

B. Despair and the sublime

C. Injustice and exile

D. Ambition and the hunger for discovery

SAT key: 1. D (To reason earnestly with a person on some impropriety of his conduct, representing the wrong he has done or intends,…); 2. C (Injustice and exile)

Lesson 21: Chapter XV

Focus: reading and identity

Teacher only · spoilers

The creature finds Paradise Lost, Plutarch's Lives and The Sorrows of Young Werther, and reads Victor's laboratory journal, which describes his creation with disgust. He reveals himself to the blind old De Lacey, who is kind, but Felix, Agatha and Safie return, and Felix strikes him and drives him away.

Background: Each book shapes him: Werther teaches feeling, Plutarch virtue and heroism, Milton his place in creation.

Significance: He identifies with both Adam and Satan; the De Laceys' rejection is the turning point from benevolence to rage.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Settle in and write for five minutes: Why does the creature compare himself to both Adam and Satan? No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
Today's words are massacring, undeceiving, instigate, unformed, disquisitions. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check Webster's. Here is the first: "I read of men concerned in public affairs, governing or massacring their species." Webster's says: The killing of a considerable number of human beings under circumstances of atrocity or cruelty, or contrary to the.... Now the word history: "massacre": sacr (Latin sacer, "holy"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary. "undeceive": un- (Old English un-, "not") + -ive (Latin -ivus, "tending to"). Root not in our table: have students find it. "instigate": in- (Latin in-, "not" or "in") + -ate (Latin -atus, "to make, having"). Root not in our table: have students find it. Add each root to your etymology log.

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Present the historical and literary background.
Here is what the first readers of Frankenstein would have known. Each book shapes him: Werther teaches feeling, Plutarch virtue and heroism, Milton his place in creation. Why does this chapter matter? He identifies with both Adam and Satan; the De Laceys' rejection is the turning point from benevolence to rage. Write down one question you want answered.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for allusion.
Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. I read a sentence, stop, and ask what the author is doing. When I see allusion, I underline it and write in the margin what effect it has. Here I notice the diction and the sentence rhythm, and I connect them to reading and identity.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for Allusion, Characterization, Theme.
Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of allusion. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.

> *"As I read, however, I applied much personally to my own feelings and condition. I found myself similar, yet at the same time strangely unlike to the beings concerning whom I read, and to whose conversation I was a listener. I sympathised with, and partly understood them, but I was unformed in mind; I was dependent on none, and related to none. 'The path of my departure was free'; and there was none to lament my annihilation. My person was hideous, and my stature gigantic? What did this mean? Who was I? What was I? Whence did I come? What was my destination? These questions continually recurred, but I was unable to solve them.*

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their rigor.
Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Allusion, Characterization, Theme: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; your level is already set. Middle-school version: In "Chapter XV," how does Shelley show reading and identity? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the chapter, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the allusion you noticed as one piece of evidence. I will circulate and conference.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion (think-pair-share or a short Socratic circle).
Let's talk. Our question: How does this chapter connect to the costs of unchecked ambition? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
Take the chapter quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this chapter suggests about reading and identity, backed by one short quotation.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how allusion shapes reading and identity. Tonight, read the next chapter and add two words to your etymology log.

Total: 90 minutes.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (Webster's 1913)	In context	Etymology note
massacring	The killing of a considerable number of human beings under circumstances of atrocity or cruelty, or contrary to the…	*I read of men concerned in public affairs, governing or massacring their species.*	"massacre": sacr (Latin sacer, "holy"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary.
undeceiving	To cause to be no longer deceived	*"The old man paused, and then continued, 'If you will unreservedly confide to me the particulars of your tale, I perhaps may be of use in undeceiving them.*	"undeceive": un- (Old English un-, "not") + -ive (Latin -ivus, "tending to"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
instigate	To goad or urge forward	*" 'Heaven forbid! even if you were really criminal; for that can only drive you to desperation, and not instigate you to virtue.*	"instigate": in- (Latin in-, "not" or "in") + -ate (Latin -atus, "to make, having"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
unformed	Decomposed, or resolved into parts	*I sympathised with, and partly understood them, but I was unformed in mind; I was dependent on none, and related to none. 'The path of my departure was free'; and there was none to lament my annihilation.*	"unformed": un- (Old English un-, "not") + form (Latin forma, "shape") + -ed (Old English -ed, past or "having"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary.
disquisitions	A formal or systematic inquiry into, or discussion of, any subject	*The disquisitions upon death and suicide were calculated to fill me with wonder.*	"disquisition": dis- (Latin dis-, "apart, not") + quis (Latin quaerere, "to seek") + -ition (Latin -itio, "the act of"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary.
decipher	To translate from secret characters or ciphers into intelligible terms	*At first I had neglected them; but now that I was able to decipher the characters in which they were written, I began to study them with diligence.*	"decipher": de- (Latin de, "down from, away") + -er (Old English -ere, "one who"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
persuades	To influence or gain over by argument, advice, entreaty, expostulation, etc.; to draw or incline to a determination…	*I am blind, and cannot judge of your countenance, but there is something in your words, which persuades me that you are sincere.*	"persuade": per- (Latin per, "through, thoroughly"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
deprecate	To pray against, as an evil	*I learned, from the views of social life which it developed, to admire*	"deprecate": de- (Latin de, "down from, away") + -ate (Latin -atus,

		their virtues, and to deprecate the vices of mankind.	"to make, having"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
antelope	One of a group of ruminant quadrupeds, intermediate between the deer and the goat	*I could have torn him limb from limb, as the lion rends the antelope.*	“antelope”: no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin.
decreased	To grow less, -- opposed to increase	*Their happiness was not decreased by the absence of summer.*	“decrease”: de- (Latin de, "down from, away"). Root not in our table: have students find it.

Discussion questions

1. Why does the creature compare himself to both Adam and Satan?
2. Where does allusion appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with the costs of unchecked ambition?

Annotation focus

- **Allusion:** look for references to other books, myths, history or religion
- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- **Theme:** look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas

Chapter quiz

1. Which book is NOT among those he finds?
   A. The Sorrows of Young Werther
   B. Plutarch's Lives
   C. Robinson Crusoe
   D. Paradise Lost
2. What document does he discover in his clothing?
   A. Victor's laboratory journal
   B. A map
   C. A will
   D. A letter from Elizabeth
3. Which character in Milton does he feel most like?
   A. Gabriel
   B. Satan, the outcast
   C. Michael
   D. Eve
4. Why does he choose the blind father first?
   A. He has money
   B. He cannot judge by appearance

C. He speaks German

D. He is the strongest

5. What does Felix do when he finds the creature with his father?

A. Calls for a doctor

B. Strikes him and drives him away

C. Shakes his hand

D. Invites him to dinner

6. In the line “I read of men concerned in public affairs, governing or massacring their species.”, what does “massacring” most nearly mean?

A. To goad or urge forward

B. The killing of a considerable number of human beings under circumstances of atrocity or cruelty, or contrary to the…

C. Decomposed, or resolved into parts

D. To cause to be no longer deceived

7. In the line ““The old man paused, and then continued, ‘If you will unreservedly confide to me the particulars of your tale, I perhaps may be of use in undeceiving them.”, what does “undeceiving” most nearly mean?

A. To goad or urge forward

B. The killing of a considerable number of human beings under circumstances of atrocity or cruelty, or contrary to the…

C. To cause to be no longer deceived

D. Decomposed, or resolved into parts

Answer key: 1. C (Robinson Crusoe); 2. A (Victor's laboratory journal); 3. B (Satan, the outcast); 4. B (He cannot judge by appearance); 5. B (Strikes him and drives him away); 6. B (The killing of a considerable number of human beings under circumstances of atrocity or cruelty, or contrary to the…); 7. C (To cause to be no longer deceived)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; RL.7.9, W.7.1): In “Chapter XV,” how does Shelley show reading and identity? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the chapter, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the allusion you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; RL.9-10.9, W.9-10.1): In Chapter XV, how does Shelley develop the idea of reading and identity? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the allusion in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; RL.9-10.9, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Chapter XV develops the idea of reading and identity. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of allusion and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; RL.11-12.9, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Chapter XV (where it begins, turns and ends) and its allusion shape the reader's understanding of reading and identity. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; RL.11-12.9, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Chapter XV suggests about reading and identity. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's allusion and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; AP.RL.5, AP.W.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses allusion in Chapter XV to complicate the reader's understanding of reading and identity. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; CF.RL.5, CF.W.1): Situate Chapter XV within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of reading and identity responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; C2.RL.5, C2.W.1): Read Chapter XV alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of reading and identity follows or bends those conventions, using the allusion as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; C3.RL.5, C3.W.1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter XV and its treatment of reading and identity. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's allusion and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; C4.RL.5, C4.W.1): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter XV as evidence for a larger claim about reading and identity in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; GR.RL.5, GR.W.1): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter XV as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of reading and identity. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *“ 'Heaven forbid! even if you were really criminal; for that can only drive you to desperation, and not instigate you to virtue.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “instigate” most nearly mean?

   A. To grow less, -- opposed to increase

   B. To goad or urge forward

   C. To pray against, as an evil

D. One of a group of ruminant quadrupeds, intermediate between the deer and the goat

2. *"As I read, however, I applied much personally to my own feelings and condition. I found myself similar, yet at the same time strangely unlike to the beings concerning whom I read, and to whose conversation I was a listener. I sympathised with, and partly understood them, but I was unformed in mind; I was dependent on none, and related to none. 'The path of my departure was free'; and there was none to lament my annihilation. My person was hideous, and my stature gigantic? What did this mean? Who was I? What was I? Whence did I come? What was my destination? These questions continually recurred, but I was unable to solve them.*

Which choice best states a central concern of "Chapter XV"?

A. Puzzling visits

B. The entail and the officers

C. Embarrassing relations

D. Reading and identity

SAT key: 1. B (To goad or urge forward); 2. D (Reading and identity)

Lesson 22: Chapter XVI

Focus: rejection and the turn to revenge

Teacher only · spoilers

The De Laceys abandon the cottage. Enraged, the creature burns it and heads for Geneva, guided by Victor's journal. He saves a drowning girl but is shot. Near Geneva he meets William, learns he is a Frankenstein, kills him, and plants the portrait on the sleeping Justine.

Background: This chapter retells Chapter VII's events from the other side—a key structural mirror.

Significance: His turn to violence complicates sympathy: rejection explains but does not excuse his crimes.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Settle in and write for five minutes: Does the creature's suffering excuse what he does to William and Justine? No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
Today's words are imprecate, bedewed, underwood, sanguinary, extracting. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check Webster's. Here is the first: "Oh, earth! how often did I imprecate curses on the cause of my being!" Webster's says: To call down by prayer, as something hurtful or calamitous. Now the word history: "imprecate": im- (Latin in-, "not" or "in") + -ate (Latin -atus, "to make, having"). Root not in our table: have students find it. "bedew": no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin. "underwood": un- (Old English un-, "not"). Root not in our table: have students find it. Add each root to your etymology log.

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Present the historical and literary background.
Here is what the first readers of Frankenstein would have known. This chapter retells Chapter VII's events from the other side—a key structural mirror. Why does this chapter matter? His turn to violence complicates sympathy: rejection explains but does not excuse his crimes. Write down one question you want answered.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for irony.
Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. I read a sentence, stop, and ask what the author is doing. When I see irony, I underline it and write in the margin what effect it has. Here I notice the diction and the sentence rhythm, and I connect them to rejection and the turn to revenge.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for Irony, Characterization, Foreshadowing.
Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of irony. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.

> *"When night came, I quitted my retreat, and wandered in the wood; and now, no longer restrained by the fear of discovery, I gave vent to my anguish in fearful howlings. I was like a wild beast that had broken the toils; destroying the objects that obstructed me, and ranging through the wood with a stag-like swiftness. O! what a miserable night I passed! the cold stars shone in mockery, and the bare trees waved their branches above me: now and then the sweet voice of a bird burst forth amidst the universal stillness. All, save I, were at rest or in enjoyment: I, like the archfiend, bore a hell within me; and, finding myself unsympathised with, wished to tear up the trees, spread havoc and destruction around me, and then to have sat down and enjoyed the ruin.*

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their rigor.
Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Irony, Characterization, Foreshadowing: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; your level is already set. Middle-school version: In "Chapter XVI," how does Shelley show rejection and the turn to revenge? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the chapter, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the irony you noticed as one piece of evidence. I will circulate and conference.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion (think-pair-share or a short Socratic circle).
Let's talk. Our question: How does this chapter connect to the costs of unchecked ambition? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
Take the chapter quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this chapter suggests about rejection and the turn to revenge, backed by one short quotation.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how irony shapes rejection and the turn to revenge. Tonight, read the next chapter and add two words to your etymology log.

Total: 90 minutes.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (Webster's 1913)	In context	Etymology note
imprecate		*Oh, earth! how often did I imprecate curses on the cause of my being!*	"imprecate": im- (Latin in-, "not" or "in") + -ate (Latin -atus, "to

	To call down by prayer, as something hurtful or calamitous		make, having"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
bedewed	To moisten with dew, or as with dew	*Soft tears again bedewed my cheeks, and I even raised my humid eyes with thankfulness towards the blessed sun which bestowed such joy upon me.*	"bedew": no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin.
underwood	Small trees and bushes that grow among large trees	*Accordingly I hid myself in some thick underwood, determining to devote the ensuing hours to reflection on my situation.*	"underwood": un- (Old English un-, "not"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
sanguinary	Attended with much bloodshed	*Thanks to the lessons of Felix and the sanguinary laws of man, I had learned now to work mischief.*	"sanguinary": -ary (Latin -arius, "connected with"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
extracting	To draw out or forth	*The ball had entered my shoulder, and I knew not whether it had remained there or passed through; at any rate I had no means of extracting it.*	"extract": ex- (Latin ex, "out of") + tract (Latin trahere, "to draw, pull"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary.
epithets	An adjective expressing some quality, attribute, or relation, that is properly or specially appropriate to a person…	*"The child still struggled, and loaded me with epithets which carried despair to my heart; I grasped his throat to silence him, and in a moment he lay dead at my feet.*	"epithet": the (Greek theos, "god"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary.
obstructed	To block up	*I was like a wild beast that had broken the toils; destroying the objects that obstructed me, and ranging through the wood with a stag-like swiftness.*	"obstruct": ob- (Latin ob, "against, toward") + struct (Latin struere, "to build"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary.
apprehending	To take or seize	*I trembled violently, apprehending some dreadful misfortune.*	"apprehend": ap- (Latin ad, "to"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
enkindled	To set on fire	*The nearer I approached to your habitation, the more deeply did I feel the spirit of revenge enkindled in my heart.*	"enkindle": en- (French en-/Latin in-, "into"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
imparting	To bestow a share or portion of	*Here, I thought, is one of those whose joy-imparting smiles are bestowed on all but me.*	"impart": im- (Latin in-, "not" or "in"). Root not in our table: have students find it.

Discussion questions

1. Does the creature's suffering excuse what he does to William and Justine?
2. Where does irony appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with creation and responsibility?

Annotation focus

- **Irony:** look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true
- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- **Foreshadowing:** look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events

Chapter quiz

1. Where does the creature travel after the De Laceys leave?
   A. To Ingolstadt
   B. To London
   C. To the North Pole
   D. Toward Geneva
2. What does the family do after the encounter?
   A. Hire guards
   B. Search for him to apologize
   C. Abandon the cottage
   D. Move into Geneva
3. What does the creature do to the cottage?
   A. Burns it
   B. Sells it
   C. Lives in it with them
   D. Repairs it
4. What happens after he saves a drowning girl?
   A. He is hired
   B. He is thanked
   C. He is shot
   D. He is adopted
5. Why does he kill William?
   A. William attacked him
   B. He learns the boy is a Frankenstein
   C. By accident
   D. For food
6. In the line “Oh, earth! how often did I imprecate curses on the cause of my being!”, what does “imprecate” most nearly mean?
   A. Small trees and bushes that grow among large trees

B. To call down by prayer, as something hurtful or calamitous

C. Attended with much bloodshed

D. To moisten with dew, or as with dew

7. In the line “Soft tears again bedewed my cheeks, and I even raised my humid eyes with thankfulness towards the blessed sun which bestowed such joy upon me.”, what does “bedewed” most nearly mean?

A. Attended with much bloodshed

B. Small trees and bushes that grow among large trees

C. To call down by prayer, as something hurtful or calamitous

D. To moisten with dew, or as with dew

Answer key: 1. D (Toward Geneva); 2. C (Abandon the cottage); 3. A (Burns it); 4. C (He is shot); 5. B (He learns the boy is a Frankenstein); 6. B (To call down by prayer, as something hurtful or calamitous); 7. D (To moisten with dew, or as with dew)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; RL.7.6, W.7.1): In “Chapter XVI,” how does Shelley show rejection and the turn to revenge? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the chapter, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the irony you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): In Chapter XVI, how does Shelley develop the idea of rejection and the turn to revenge? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the irony in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Chapter XVI develops the idea of rejection and the turn to revenge. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Chapter XVI (where it begins, turns and ends) and its irony shape the reader's understanding of rejection and the turn to revenge. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Chapter XVI suggests about rejection and the turn to revenge. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's irony and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; AP.RL.1, AP.W.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses irony in Chapter XVI to complicate the reader's understanding of rejection and the turn to revenge. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; CF.RL.1, CF.W.1): Situate Chapter XVI within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of rejection and the turn to revenge responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; C2.RL.1, C2.W.1): Read Chapter XVI alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of rejection and the turn to revenge follows or bends those conventions, using the irony as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; C3.RL.1, C3.W.1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter XVI and its treatment of rejection and the turn to revenge. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's irony and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; C4.RL.1, C4.W.1): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter XVI as evidence for a larger claim about rejection and the turn to revenge in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; GR.RL.1, GR.W.1): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter XVI as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of rejection and the turn to revenge. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *Accordingly I hid myself in some thick underwood, determining to devote the ensuing hours to reflection on my situation.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “underwood” most nearly mean?

   A. Small trees and bushes that grow among large trees

   B. To set on fire

   C. To take or seize

   D. To bestow a share or portion of

2. *“When night came, I quitted my retreat, and wandered in the wood; and now, no longer restrained by the fear of discovery, I gave vent to my anguish in fearful howlings. I was like a wild beast that had broken the toils; destroying the objects that obstructed me, and ranging through the wood with a stag-like swiftness. O! what a miserable night I passed! the cold stars shone in mockery, and the bare trees waved their branches above me: now and then the sweet voice of a bird burst forth amidst the universal stillness. All, save I, were at rest or in enjoyment: I, like the archfiend, bore a hell within me; and, finding myself unsympathised with, wished to tear up the trees, spread havoc and destruction around me, and then to have sat down and enjoyed the ruin.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Chapter XVI”?

   A. Endings and futures

   B. Visit to Hunsford

   C. Rejection and the turn to revenge

   D. A persuasive tale

SAT key: 1. A (Small trees and bushes that grow among large trees); 2. C (Rejection and the turn to revenge)

Lesson 23: Chapter XVII

Focus: the demand for a companion

Teacher only · spoilers

The creature demands a female companion as wretched as himself, promising to withdraw to South America. Moved and afraid, Victor agrees.

Background: Debates on whether humans have natural rights to companionship and happiness echo Enlightenment philosophy.

Significance: This bargain is the hinge of the plot; Victor's later choice will decide everyone's fate.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Settle in and write for five minutes: Is the creature's request fair? What risks does Victor consider? No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
Today's words are insurmountable, concede, trifled, protectors, sickened. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check Webster's. Here is the first: “But that cannot be; the human senses are insurmountable barriers to our union.” Webster's says: Incapable of being passed over, surmounted, or overcome. Now the word history: “insurmountable”: in- (Latin in-, "not" or "in") + -able (Latin -abilis, "able to be"). Root not in our table: have students find it. “concede”: con- (Latin com-, "with, together") + ced (Latin cedere, "to go, yield"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary. “trifle”: no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin. Add each root to your etymology log.

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Present the historical and literary background.
Here is what the first readers of Frankenstein would have known. Debates on whether humans have natural rights to companionship and happiness echo Enlightenment philosophy. Why does this chapter matter? This bargain is the hinge of the plot; Victor's later choice will decide everyone's fate. Write down one question you want answered.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for theme.
Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. I read a sentence, stop, and ask what the author is doing. When I see theme, I underline it and write in the margin what effect it has. Here I notice the diction and the sentence rhythm, and I connect them to the demand for a companion.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for Theme, Characterization, Conflict.
Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of theme. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.

> *"You must create a female for me, with whom I can live in the interchange of those sympathies necessary for my being. This you alone can do; and I demand it of you as a right which you must not refuse to concede."*

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their rigor.
Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Theme, Characterization, Conflict: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; your level is already set. Middle-school version: In "Chapter XVII," how does Shelley show the demand for a companion? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the chapter, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the theme you noticed as one piece of evidence. I will circulate and conference.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion (think-pair-share or a short Socratic circle).
Let's talk. Our question: How does this chapter connect to the costs of unchecked ambition? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
Take the chapter quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this chapter suggests about the demand for a companion, backed by one short quotation.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how theme shapes the demand for a companion. Tonight, read the next chapter and add two words to your etymology log.

Total: 90 minutes.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (Webster's 1913)	In context	Etymology note
insurmountable	Incapable of being passed over, surmounted, or overcome	*But that cannot be; the human senses are insurmountable barriers to our union.*	"insurmountable": in- (Latin in-, "not" or "in") + -able (Latin -abilis, "able to be"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
concede	To yield or suffer	*This you alone can do; and I demand it of you as a right which you must not refuse to concede."*	"concede": con- (Latin com-, "with, together") + ced (Latin cedere, "to go, yield"). Teacher

			note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary.
trifled	A thing of very little value or importance	*I must not be trifled with: and I demand an answer.*	“trifle”: no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin.
protectors	One who, or that which, defends or shields from injury, evil, oppression, etc.; a defender	*I thought of the promise of virtues which he had displayed on the opening of his existence, and the subsequent blight of all kindly feeling by the loathing and scorn which his protectors had manifested towards him.*	“protector”: pro- (Latin pro, "forward, for") + -or (Latin -or, "one who"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
sickened	To make sick	*I compassionated him, and sometimes felt a wish to console him; but when I looked upon him, when I saw the filthy mass that moved and talked, my heart sickened, and my feelings were altered to those of horror and hatred.*	“sicken”: no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin.
interchange	To put each in the place of the other	*“You must create a female for me, with whom I can live in the interchange of those sympathies necessary for my being.*	“interchange”: inter- (Latin inter, "between"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
precipices	A sudden or headlong fall	*His power and threats were not omitted in my calculations: a creature who could exist in the ice-caves of the glaciers, and hide himself from pursuit among the ridges of inaccessible precipices, was a being possessing faculties it would be vain to cope with.*	“precipice”: pre- (Latin prae, "before"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
narrated	To tell, rehearse, or recite, as a story	*The latter part of his tale had kindled anew in me the anger that had died away while he narrated his peaceful life among the cottagers, and, as he said this, I could no longer suppress the rage that burned within me.*	“narrate”: -ate (Latin -atus, "to make, having"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
barriers	(Fort.) A carpentry obstruction, stockade, or other obstacle made in a passage in order to stop an enemy	*But that cannot be; the human senses are insurmountable barriers to our union.*	“barrier”: -er (Old English -ere, "one who"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
persevere			“persevere”: per- (Latin per, "through, thoroughly"). Root

	To persist in any business or enterprise undertaken	*How can you, who long for the love and sympathy of man, persevere in this exile?*	not in our table: have students find it.

Discussion questions

1. Is the creature's request fair? What risks does Victor consider?
2. Where does theme appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with isolation and the need for companionship?

Annotation focus

- **Theme:** look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas
- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- **Conflict:** look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other

Chapter quiz

1. What does the creature demand?
   A. A female companion
   B. To live in Geneva
   C. Money
   D. Victor's death
2. Where does he promise to go?
   A. The wilds of South America
   B. Italy
   C. The North Pole
   D. London
3. Why does Victor agree?
   A. He is bribed
   B. He is curious
   C. He feels compassion and fear
   D. Elizabeth asks him
4. What theme does the request highlight?
   A. Love of fame
   B. The need for companionship
   C. Wealth
   D. Religion
5. What kind of moment is this in the plot?
   A. A turning point bargain
   B. A flashback only
   C. An ending

D. A comic interlude

6. In the line “But that cannot be; the human senses are insurmountable barriers to our union.”, what does “insurmountable” most nearly mean?

   A. To yield or suffer

   B. A thing of very little value or importance

   C. Incapable of being passed over, surmounted, or overcome

   D. One who, or that which, defends or shields from injury, evil, oppression, etc.; a defender

7. In the line “This you alone can do; and I demand it of you as a right which you must not refuse to concede.””, what does “concede” most nearly mean?

   A. A thing of very little value or importance

   B. Incapable of being passed over, surmounted, or overcome

   C. One who, or that which, defends or shields from injury, evil, oppression, etc.; a defender

   D. To yield or suffer

Answer key: 1. A (A female companion); 2. A (The wilds of South America); 3. C (He feels compassion and fear); 4. B (The need for companionship); 5. A (A turning point bargain); 6. C (Incapable of being passed over, surmounted, or overcome); 7. D (To yield or suffer)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; RL.7.2, W.7.1): In “Chapter XVII,” how does Shelley show the demand for a companion? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the chapter, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the theme you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; RL.9-10.2, W.9-10.1): In Chapter XVII, how does Shelley develop the idea of the demand for a companion? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the theme in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; RL.9-10.2, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Chapter XVII develops the idea of the demand for a companion. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of theme and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; RL.11-12.2, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Chapter XVII (where it begins, turns and ends) and its theme shape the reader's understanding of the demand for a companion. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; RL.11-12.2, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Chapter XVII suggests about the demand for a companion. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's theme and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; AP.RL.2, AP.W.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses theme in Chapter XVII to complicate the reader's understanding of the demand for a companion. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; CF.RL.2, CF.W.1): Situate Chapter XVII within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of the demand for a companion responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; C2.RL.2, C2.W.1): Read Chapter XVII alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of the demand for a companion follows or bends those conventions, using the theme as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; C3.RL.2, C3.W.1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter XVII and its treatment of the demand for a companion. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's theme and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; C4.RL.2, C4.W.1): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter XVII as evidence for a larger claim about the demand for a companion in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; GR.RL.2, GR.W.1): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter XVII as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of the demand for a companion. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *I must not be trifled with: and I demand an answer.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “trifled” most nearly mean?

   A. A thing of very little value or importance

   B. (Fort.) A carpentry obstruction, stockade, or other obstacle made in a passage in order to stop an enemy

   C. To tell, rehearse, or recite, as a story

   D. To persist in any business or enterprise undertaken

2. *“You must create a female for me, with whom I can live in the interchange of those sympathies necessary for my being. This you alone can do; and I demand it of you as a right which you must not refuse to concede.”*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Chapter XVII”?

   A. Leaving Kent

   B. The demand for a companion

   C. Detachment among the childlike people

   D. Confiding and consent

SAT key: 1. A (A thing of very little value or importance); 2. B (The demand for a companion)

Lesson 24: Chapter XVIII

Focus: delay and dread

Teacher only · spoilers

Back in Geneva, Victor delays. His father asks whether he loves another; Victor agrees to marry Elizabeth after a trip to England, where he will secretly do his work. He travels with Clerval through Germany and down the Rhine.

Background: The Rhine was celebrated for picturesque castles and vineyards in Romantic travel writing.

Significance: Clerval's joy in nature contrasts with Victor's dread, heightening tension.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Settle in and write for five minutes: How does Clerval's attitude toward nature differ from Victor's at this point? No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
Today's words are eradicating, enfranchised, sedulous, meandering, dilatory. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check Webster's. Here is the first: “My father saw this change with pleasure, and he turned his thoughts towards the best method of eradicating the remains of my melancholy, which every now and then would return by fits, and with a devouring blackness overcast the approaching sunshine.” Webster's says: To pluck up by the roots. Now the word history: “eradicate”: -ate (Latin -atus, "to make, having"). Root not in our table: have students find it. “enfranchise”: en- (French en-/Latin in-, "into"). Root not in our table: have students find it. “sedulous”: se- (Latin se-, "apart") + -ous (Latin -osus, "full of"). Root not in our table: have students find it. Add each root to your etymology log.

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Present the historical and literary background.
Here is what the first readers of Frankenstein would have known. The Rhine was celebrated for picturesque castles and vineyards in Romantic travel writing. Why does this chapter matter? Clerval's joy in nature contrasts with Victor's dread, heightening tension. Write down one question you want answered.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for foreshadowing.
Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. I read a sentence, stop, and ask what the author is doing. When I see foreshadowing, I underline it and write in the margin what effect it has. Here I notice the diction and the sentence rhythm, and I connect them to delay and dread.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for Foreshadowing, Setting, Characterization.
Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of foreshadowing. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.

> *To England, therefore, I was bound, and it was understood that my union with Elizabeth should take place immediately on my return. My father's age rendered him extremely averse to delay. For myself, there was one reward I promised myself from my detested toils—one consolation for my unparalleled sufferings; it was the prospect of that day when, enfranchised from my miserable slavery, I might claim Elizabeth, and forget the past in my union with her.*

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their rigor.
Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Foreshadowing, Setting, Characterization: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; your level is already set. Middle-school version: In "Chapter XVIII," how does Shelley show delay and dread? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the chapter, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the foreshadowing you noticed as one piece of evidence. I will circulate and conference.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion (think-pair-share or a short Socratic circle).
Let's talk. Our question: How does this chapter connect to the costs of unchecked ambition? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
Take the chapter quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this chapter suggests about delay and dread, backed by one short quotation.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how foreshadowing shapes delay and dread. Tonight, read the next chapter and add two words to your etymology log.

Total: 90 minutes.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (Webster's 1913)	In context	Etymology note
eradicating	To pluck up by the roots	*My father saw this change with pleasure, and he turned his thoughts towards the best method of eradicating the remains of my melancholy, which every now and then would*	"eradicate": -ate (Latin -atus, "to make, having"). Root not in our table: have students find it.

		return by fits, and with a devouring blackness overcast the approaching sunshine.	
enfranchised	To set free	*For myself, there was one reward I promised myself from my detested toils—one consolation for my unparalleled sufferings; it was the prospect of that day when, enfranchised from my miserable slavery, I might claim Elizabeth, and forget the past in my union with her.*	"enfranchise": en- (French en-/Latin in-, "into"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
sedulous	Diligent in application or pursuit	*It had been her care which provided me a companion in Clerval—and yet a man is blind to a thousand minute circumstances, which call forth a woman's sedulous attention.*	"sedulous": se- (Latin se-, "apart") + -ous (Latin -osus, "full of"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
meandering	A winding, crooked, or involved course	*In one spot you view rugged hills, ruined castles overlooking tremendous precipices, with the dark Rhine rushing beneath; and, on the sudden turn of a promontory, flourishing vineyards, with green sloping banks, and a meandering river, and populous towns occupy the scene.*	"meander": -er (Old English -ere, "one who"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
dilatory	Inclined to defer or put off what ought to be done at once	*The latter method of obtaining the desired intelligence was dilatory and unsatisfactory: besides, I had an insurmountable aversion to the idea of engaging myself in my loathsome task in my father's house, while in habits of familiar intercourse with those I loved.*	"dilatory": -ory (Latin -orius, "relating to"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
inhabits	To live or dwell in	*Oh, surely, the spirit that inhabits and guards this place has a soul more in harmony with man, than those who pile the glacier, or retire to the inaccessible peaks of the mountains of our own country."*	"inhabit": in- (Latin in-, "not" or "in"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
inroads	The entrance of an enemy into a country with purposes of hostility	*My journey had been my own suggestion, and Elizabeth, therefore, acquiesced: but she was filled with disquiet at the idea of my suffering, away from her, the inroads of misery and grief.*	"inroad": in- (Latin in-, "not" or "in"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
harrowing	An implement of agriculture, usually formed of pieces of timber or metal crossing each other, and set with iron or…	*I was aware also that I should often lose all self-command, all capacity of hiding the harrowing sensations that would possess me during the progress of my unearthly occupation.*	"harrow": no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin.
unexampled		*Pardon this gush of sorrow; these ineffectual words are but a slight tribute to the*	"unexampled": un- (Old English un-, "not") + -ed

	Having no example or similar case	*unexampled worth of Henry, but they soothe my heart, overflowing with the anguish which his remembrance creates.*	(Old English -ed, past or "having"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
variegated	Having marks or patches of different colors	*This part of the Rhine, indeed, presents a singularly variegated landscape.*	“variegated”: -ed (Old English -ed, past or "having"). Root not in our table: have students find it.

Discussion questions

1. How does Clerval's attitude toward nature differ from Victor's at this point?
2. Where does foreshadowing appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with nature versus nurture?

Annotation focus

- **Foreshadowing:** look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events
- **Setting:** look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling
- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them

Chapter quiz

1. Why does Victor travel to England?
   A. To study law
   B. To meet Walton
   C. To create the female in secret
   D. To visit his mother
2. Who travels with him?
   A. Justine
   B. Elizabeth
   C. Ernest
   D. Clerval
3. What river do they travel along?
   A. The Danube
   B. The Thames
   C. The Rhine
   D. The Seine
4. What does Victor's father want to know?
   A. If he needs money
   B. Whether Victor loves someone else
   C. Where the creature is
   D. Whether he is ill

5. How is Clerval described in this chapter?
   A. Angry
   B. Joyful and alive to nature
   C. Ill
   D. Gloomy
6. In the line “My father saw this change with pleasure, and he turned his thoughts towards the best method of eradicating the remains of my melancholy, which every now and then would return by fits, and with a devouring blackness overcast the approaching sunshine.”, what does “eradicating” most nearly mean?
   A. To set free
   B. Diligent in application or pursuit
   C. To pluck up by the roots
   D. A winding, crooked, or involved course
7. In the line “For myself, there was one reward I promised myself from my detested toils—one consolation for my unparalleled sufferings; it was the prospect of that day when, enfranchised from my miserable slavery, I might claim Elizabeth, and forget the past in my union with her.”, what does “enfranchised” most nearly mean?
   A. To pluck up by the roots
   B. A winding, crooked, or involved course
   C. Diligent in application or pursuit
   D. To set free

Answer key: 1. C (To create the female in secret); 2. D (Clerval); 3. C (The Rhine); 4. B (Whether Victor loves someone else); 5. B (Joyful and alive to nature); 6. C (To pluck up by the roots); 7. D (To set free)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; RL.7.5, W.7.1): In “Chapter XVIII,” how does Shelley show delay and dread? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the chapter, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the foreshadowing you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1): In Chapter XVIII, how does Shelley develop the idea of delay and dread? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the foreshadowing in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Chapter XVIII develops the idea of delay and dread. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of foreshadowing and setting shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Chapter XVIII (where it begins, turns and ends) and its foreshadowing shape the reader's understanding of delay and dread. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Chapter XVIII suggests about delay and dread. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's foreshadowing and setting), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; AP.RL.3, AP.W.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses foreshadowing in Chapter XVIII to complicate the reader's understanding of delay and dread. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; CF.RL.3, CF.W.1): Situate Chapter XVIII within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of delay and dread responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; C2.RL.3, C2.W.1): Read Chapter XVIII alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of delay and dread follows or bends those conventions, using the foreshadowing as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; C3.RL.3, C3.W.1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter XVIII and its treatment of delay and dread. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's foreshadowing and setting, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; C4.RL.3, C4.W.1): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter XVIII as evidence for a larger claim about delay and dread in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; GR.RL.3, GR.W.1): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter XVIII as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of delay and dread. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *It had been her care which provided me a companion in Clerval—and yet a man is blind to a thousand minute circumstances, which call forth a woman's sedulous attention.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "sedulous" most nearly mean?

   A. Having no example or similar case

   B. Diligent in application or pursuit

   C. An implement of agriculture, usually formed of pieces of timber or metal crossing each other, and set with iron or…

   D. Having marks or patches of different colors

2. *To England, therefore, I was bound, and it was understood that my union with Elizabeth should take place immediately on my return. My father's age rendered him extremely averse to delay. For myself, there was one reward I promised myself from my detested toils—one consolation for my unparalleled sufferings; it was the prospect of that day when, enfranchised from my miserable slavery, I might claim Elizabeth, and forget the past in my union with her.*

Which choice best states a central concern of "Chapter XVIII"?

A. Delay and dread

B. An imperious hostess

C. Departure and relief

D. Disappointment and philosophy

SAT key: 1. B (Diligent in application or pursuit); 2. A (Delay and dread)

Lesson 25: Chapter XIX

Focus: isolation in the north

Teacher only · spoilers

In London, Oxford and later Scotland, Victor gathers knowledge, then leaves Clerval and goes alone to a remote Orkney island to build the female creature, working in misery.

Background: Oxford's association with the English Civil War and the poet-patriot John Hampden is mentioned.

Significance: The bleak island mirrors Victor's isolation and moral desolation.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Settle in and write for five minutes: Why does Victor choose such a desolate place? No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
Today's words are remembrancers, expedite, roarings, debasing, oatmeal. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check Webster's. Here is the first: "For a moment my soul was elevated from its debasing and miserable fears, to contemplate the divine ideas of liberty and self-sacrifice, of which these sights were the monuments and the remembrancers." Webster's says: One who, or that which, serves to bring to, or keep in, mind. Now the word history: "remembrancer": re- (Latin re-, "back, again") + mem (Latin memor, "mindful") + -er (Old English -ere, "one who"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary. "expedite": ex- (Latin ex, "out of") + ped (Latin pes/pedis, "foot"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary. "roaring": -ing (Old English -ing, action). Root not in our table: have students find it. Add each root to your etymology log.

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Present the historical and literary background.
Here is what the first readers of Frankenstein would have known. Oxford's association with the English Civil War and the poet-patriot John Hampden is mentioned. Why does this chapter matter? The bleak island mirrors Victor's isolation and moral desolation. Write down one question you want answered.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for setting.
Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. I read a sentence, stop, and ask what the author is doing. When I see setting, I underline it and write in the margin what effect it has. Here I notice the diction and the sentence rhythm, and I connect them to isolation in the north.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for Setting, Tone / mood, Foreshadowing.
Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of setting. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.

> *We had arrived in England at the beginning of October, and it was now February. We accordingly determined to commence our journey towards the north at the expiration of another month. In this expedition we did not intend to follow the great road to Edinburgh, but to visit Windsor, Oxford, Matlock, and the Cumberland lakes, resolving to arrive at the completion of this tour about the end of July. I packed up my chemical instruments, and the materials I had collected, resolving to finish my labours in some obscure nook in the northern highlands of Scotland.*

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their rigor.
Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Setting, Tone / mood, Foreshadowing: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; your level is already set. Middle-school version: In "Chapter XIX," how does Shelley show isolation in the north? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the chapter, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the setting you noticed as one piece of evidence. I will circulate and conference.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion (think-pair-share or a short Socratic circle).
Let's talk. Our question: How does this chapter connect to the costs of unchecked ambition? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
Take the chapter quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this chapter suggests about isolation in the north, backed by one short quotation.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how setting shapes isolation in the north. Tonight, read the next chapter and add two words to your etymology log.

Total: 90 minutes.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (Webster's 1913)	In context	Etymology note
remembrancers	One who, or that which, serves to bring to, or keep in, mind	*For a moment my soul was elevated from its debasing and miserable fears, to contemplate the divine ideas of liberty and self-sacrifice, of which*	"remembrancer": re- (Latin re-, "back, again") + mem (Latin memor, "mindful") + -er (Old English -ere, "one who").

		these sights were the monuments and the remembrancers.	Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary.
expedite	Free of impediment	*Sometimes I thought that the fiend followed me, and might expedite my remissness by murdering my companion.*	“expedite”: ex- (Latin ex, "out of") + ped (Latin pes/pedis, "foot"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary.
roarings	A loud, deep, prolonged sound, as of a large beast, or of a person in distress, anger, mirth, etc., or of a noisy…	*Its fair lakes reflect a blue and gentle sky; and, when troubled by the winds, their tumult is but as the play of a lively infant, when compared to the roarings of the giant ocean.*	“roaring”: -ing (Old English -ing, action). Root not in our table: have students find it.
debasing	To reduce from a higher to a lower state or grade of worth, dignity, purity, station, etc.; to degrade	*For a moment my soul was elevated from its debasing and miserable fears, to contemplate the divine ideas of liberty and self-sacrifice, of which these sights were the monuments and the remembrancers.*	“debase”: de- (Latin de, "down from, away"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
oatmeal	Meal made of oats	*The soil was barren, scarcely affording pasture for a few miserable cows, and oatmeal for its inhabitants, which consisted of five persons, whose gaunt and scraggy limbs gave tokens of their miserable fare.*	“oatmeal”: -al (Latin -alis, "relating to"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
scraggy	Rough with irregular points	*The soil was barren, scarcely affording pasture for a few miserable cows, and oatmeal for its inhabitants, which consisted of five persons, whose gaunt and scraggy limbs gave tokens of their miserable fare.*	“scraggy”: no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin.
engages	To put under pledge	*His feelings are forever on the stretch; and when he begins to sink into repose, he finds himself obliged to quit that on which he rests in pleasure for something new, which again engages his attention, and which also he forsakes for other novelties.*	“engage”: en- (French en-/Latin in-, "into"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
intermixed	To mix together	*I looked towards its completion with a tremulous and eager hope, which I dared not trust myself to question, but which was intermixed with obscure*	“intermix”: in- (Latin in-, "not" or "in"). Root not in our table: have students find it.

		forebodings of evil, that made my heart sicken in my bosom.	
highlands	Elevated or mountainous land	*I packed up my chemical instruments, and the materials I had collected, resolving to finish my labours in some obscure nook in the northern highlands of Scotland.*	"highland": no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin.
forsakes	To quit or leave entirely	*His feelings are forever on the stretch; and when he begins to sink into repose, he finds himself obliged to quit that on which he rests in pleasure for something new, which again engages his attention, and which also he forsakes for other novelties.*	"forsake": no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin.

Discussion questions

1. Why does Victor choose such a desolate place?
2. Where does setting appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with the sublime power of nature?

Annotation focus

- **Setting:** look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling
- **Tone / mood:** look for word choices that reveal the narrator's attitude or the scene's feeling
- **Foreshadowing:** look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events

Chapter quiz

1. Where does Victor work on the second creature?
   A. Oxford
   B. London
   C. Edinburgh University
   D. A remote island in the Orkneys
2. Who does he leave behind?
   A. Elizabeth
   B. Clerval
   C. Walton
   D. His father
3. What is Victor's mood while working?
   A. Excited
   B. Miserable and filled with dread
   C. Hopeful
   D. Peaceful

4. Which English city prompts thoughts of history?
   A. Oxford
   B. Bath
   C. Bristol
   D. Manchester
5. What does the desolate setting mirror?
   A. The creature's joy
   B. Clerval's happiness
   C. Victor's inner isolation
   D. Elizabeth's beauty
6. In the line “For a moment my soul was elevated from its debasing and miserable fears, to contemplate the divine ideas of liberty and self-sacrifice, of which these sights were the monuments and the remembrancers.”, what does “remembrancers” most nearly mean?
   A. To reduce from a higher to a lower state or grade of worth, dignity, purity, station, etc.; to degrade
   B. One who, or that which, serves to bring to, or keep in, mind
   C. A loud, deep, prolonged sound, as of a large beast, or of a person in distress, anger, mirth, etc., or of a noisy…
   D. Free of impediment
7. In the line “Sometimes I thought that the fiend followed me, and might expedite my remissness by murdering my companion.”, what does “expedite” most nearly mean?
   A. One who, or that which, serves to bring to, or keep in, mind
   B. To reduce from a higher to a lower state or grade of worth, dignity, purity, station, etc.; to degrade
   C. Free of impediment
   D. A loud, deep, prolonged sound, as of a large beast, or of a person in distress, anger, mirth, etc., or of a noisy…

Answer key: 1. D (A remote island in the Orkneys); 2. B (Clerval); 3. B (Miserable and filled with dread); 4. A (Oxford); 5. C (Victor's inner isolation); 6. B (One who, or that which, serves to bring to, or keep in, mind); 7. C (Free of impediment)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; RL.7.3, W.7.1): In “Chapter XIX,” how does Shelley show isolation in the north? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the chapter, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the setting you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In Chapter XIX, how does Shelley develop the idea of isolation in the north? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the setting in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Chapter XIX develops the idea of isolation in the north. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and tone / mood shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Chapter XIX (where it begins, turns and ends) and its setting shape the reader's understanding of isolation in the north. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Chapter XIX suggests about isolation in the north. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's setting and tone / mood), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; AP.RL.3, AP.W.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses setting in Chapter XIX to complicate the reader's understanding of isolation in the north. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; CF.RL.3, CF.W.1): Situate Chapter XIX within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of isolation in the north responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; C2.RL.3, C2.W.1): Read Chapter XIX alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of isolation in the north follows or bends those conventions, using the setting as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; C3.RL.3, C3.W.1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter XIX and its treatment of isolation in the north. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's setting and tone / mood, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; C4.RL.3, C4.W.1): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter XIX as evidence for a larger claim about isolation in the north in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; GR.RL.3, GR.W.1): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter XIX as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of isolation in the north. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *Its fair lakes reflect a blue and gentle sky; and, when troubled by the winds, their tumult is but as the play of a lively infant, when compared to the roarings of the giant ocean.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “roarings” most nearly mean?

   A. Elevated or mountainous land

   B. To quit or leave entirely

   C. To mix together

D. A loud, deep, prolonged sound, as of a large beast, or of a person in distress, anger, mirth, etc., or of a noisy…

2. *We had arrived in England at the beginning of October, and it was now February. We accordingly determined to commence our journey towards the north at the expiration of another month. In this expedition we did not intend to follow the great road to Edinburgh, but to visit Windsor, Oxford, Matlock, and the Cumberland lakes, resolving to arrive at the completion of this tour about the end of July. I packed up my chemical instruments, and the materials I had collected, resolving to finish my labours in some obscure nook in the northern highlands of Scotland.*

Which choice best states a central concern of "Chapter XIX"?

A. Isolation in the north

B. A practical marriage

C. Confiding and consent

D. The first death and growing guilt

SAT key: 1. D (A loud, deep, prolonged sound, as of a large beast, or of a person in distress, anger, mirth, etc., or of a noisy…); 2. A (Isolation in the north)

Lesson 26: Chapter XX

Focus: destroying the companion

Teacher only · spoilers

Fearing a 'race of devils,' Victor tears apart the half-finished female while the creature watches. The creature vows: 'I shall be with you on your wedding-night.' Victor rows out to sea to dump the remains, drifts, and lands in Ireland, where he is arrested for a murder.

Background: Fears of uncontrolled reproduction reflect debates sparked by Malthus on population.

Significance: Victor's choice can be read as moral courage or as a second abandonment—a rich debate topic.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Settle in and write for five minutes: Was destroying the female the right choice? Argue both sides. No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
Today's words are specked, wiliness, slenderly, debility, buffeted. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check Webster's. Here is the first: “A few fishing vessels alone specked the water, and now and then the gentle breeze wafted the sound of voices, as the fishermen called to one another.” Webster's says: The blubber of whales or other marine mammals. Now the word history: “speck”: no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin. “wiliness”: -ness (Old English -ness, "state of"). Root not in our table: have students find it. “slender”: -er (Old English -ere, "one who"). Root not in our table: have students find it. Add each root to your etymology log.

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Present the historical and literary background.
Here is what the first readers of Frankenstein would have known. Fears of uncontrolled reproduction reflect debates sparked by Malthus on population. Why does this chapter matter? Victor's choice can be read as moral courage or as a second abandonment—a rich debate topic. Write down one question you want answered.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for conflict.
Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. I read a sentence, stop, and ask what the author is doing. When I see conflict, I underline it and write in the margin what effect it has. Here I notice the diction and the sentence rhythm, and I connect them to destroying the companion.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for Conflict, Foreshadowing, Characterization.
Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of conflict. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.

> *I trembled, and my heart failed within me; when, on looking up, I saw, by the light of the moon, the daemon at the casement. A ghastly grin wrinkled his lips as he gazed on me, where I sat fulfilling the task which he had allotted to me. Yes, he had followed me in my travels; he had loitered in forests, hid himself in caves, or taken refuge in wide and desert heaths; and he now came to mark my progress, and claim the fulfilment of my promise.*

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their rigor.
Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Conflict, Foreshadowing, Characterization: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; your level is already set. Middle-school version: In "Chapter XX," how does Shelley show destroying the companion? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the chapter, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the conflict you noticed as one piece of evidence. I will circulate and conference.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion (think-pair-share or a short Socratic circle).
Let's talk. Our question: How does this chapter connect to the costs of unchecked ambition? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
Take the chapter quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this chapter suggests about destroying the companion, backed by one short quotation.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how conflict shapes destroying the companion. Tonight, read the next chapter and add two words to your etymology log.

Total: 90 minutes.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (Webster's 1913)	In context	Etymology note
specked	The blubber of whales or other marine mammals	*A few fishing vessels alone specked the water, and now and then the gentle breeze wafted the sound of voices, as the fishermen called to one another.*	"speck": no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin.

wiliness	The quality or state of being wily	*I will watch with the wiliness of a snake, that I may sting with its venom.*	“wiliness”: -ness (Old English -ness, "state of"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
slenderly	Small or narrow in proportion to the length or the height	*I had no compass with me, and was so slenderly acquainted with the geography of this part of the world, that the sun was of little benefit to me.*	“slender”: -er (Old English -ere, "one who"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
debility	The state of being weak	*As I was in a state of extreme debility, I resolved to sail directly towards the town, as a place where I could most easily procure nourishment.*	“debility”: de- (Latin de, "down from, away") + -ity (Latin -itas, "quality of"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
buffeted	A cupboard or set of shelves, either movable or fixed at one side of a room, for the display of plate, china, etc.,…	*I might be driven into the wide Atlantic, and feel all the tortures of starvation, or be swallowed up in the immeasurable waters that roared and buffeted around me.*	“buffet”: no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin.
paddling	To use the hands or fingers in toying	*I felt the silence, although I was hardly conscious of its extreme profundity, until my ear was suddenly arrested by the paddling of oars near the shore, and a person landed close to my house.*	“paddle”: no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin.
irresolution	Want of resolution	*“The hour of my irresolution is past, and the period of your power is arrived.*	“irresolution”: ir- (Latin in-, "not") + solu (Latin solvere, "to loosen") + -tion (Latin -tio, "the act of"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary.
construed	To apply the rules of syntax to (a sentence or clause) so as to exhibit the structure, arrangement, or connection…	*I was ready to sink from fatigue and hunger; but, being surrounded by a crowd, I thought it politic to rouse all my strength, that no physical debility might be construed into apprehension or conscious guilt.*	“construe”: con- (Latin com-, "with, together"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
mutable	Capable of alteration	*How mutable are our feelings, and how strange is that clinging love we have of life even in the excess of misery!*	“mutable”: -able (Latin -abilis, "able to be"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
loitered	To be slow in moving	*Yes, he had followed me in my travels; he had loitered in forests, hid himself in caves, or taken refuge in wide and desert heaths; and he now came to*	“loiter”: -er (Old English -ere, "one who"). Root not in our table: have students find it.

		mark my progress, and claim the fulfilment of my promise.	

Discussion questions

1. Was destroying the female the right choice? Argue both sides.
2. Where does conflict appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with the costs of unchecked ambition?

Annotation focus

- **Conflict:** look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other
- **Foreshadowing:** look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events
- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them

Chapter quiz

1. Why does Victor destroy the female?
   A. She is finished and dangerous
   B. He fears a race of devils
   C. The creature asks him
   D. He runs out of materials
2. What does the creature threaten?
   A. To kill Walton
   B. To be with Victor on his wedding night
   C. To burn Geneva
   D. To leave forever
3. Where does Victor land after drifting at sea?
   A. Iceland
   B. Ireland
   C. Norway
   D. France
4. What happens when he lands?
   A. He meets Walton
   B. He marries
   C. He is arrested for murder
   D. He is welcomed
5. How might readers view his decision?
   A. As accidental
   B. As purely comic
   C. As courage or as another abandonment
   D. As unimportant

6. In the line “A few fishing vessels alone specked the water, and now and then the gentle breeze wafted the sound of voices, as the fishermen called to one another.”, what does “specked” most nearly mean?
   A. Small or narrow in proportion to the length or the height
   B. The quality or state of being wily
   C. The blubber of whales or other marine mammals
   D. The state of being weak
7. In the line “I will watch with the wiliness of a snake, that I may sting with its venom.”, what does “wiliness” most nearly mean?
   A. The state of being weak
   B. The quality or state of being wily
   C. Small or narrow in proportion to the length or the height
   D. The blubber of whales or other marine mammals

Answer key: 1. B (He fears a race of devils); 2. B (To be with Victor on his wedding night); 3. B (Ireland); 4. C (He is arrested for murder); 5. C (As courage or as another abandonment); 6. C (The blubber of whales or other marine mammals); 7. B (The quality or state of being wily)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; RL.7.3, W.7.1): In “Chapter XX,” how does Shelley show destroying the companion? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the chapter, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the conflict you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In Chapter XX, how does Shelley develop the idea of destroying the companion? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the conflict in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Chapter XX develops the idea of destroying the companion. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of conflict and foreshadowing shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Chapter XX (where it begins, turns and ends) and its conflict shape the reader's understanding of destroying the companion. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Chapter XX suggests about destroying the companion. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's conflict and foreshadowing), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; AP.RL.2, AP.W.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses conflict in Chapter XX to complicate the reader's understanding of destroying the companion. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; CF.RL.2, CF.W.1): Situate Chapter XX within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of destroying the companion responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; C2.RL.2, C2.W.1): Read Chapter XX alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of destroying the companion follows or bends those conventions, using the conflict as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; C3.RL.2, C3.W.1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter XX and its treatment of destroying the companion. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's conflict and foreshadowing, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; C4.RL.2, C4.W.1): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter XX as evidence for a larger claim about destroying the companion in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; GR.RL.2, GR.W.1): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter XX as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of destroying the companion. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *I had no compass with me, and was so slenderly acquainted with the geography of this part of the world, that the sun was of little benefit to me.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “slenderly” most nearly mean?

   A. To be slow in moving

   B. Small or narrow in proportion to the length or the height

   C. Capable of alteration

   D. To apply the rules of syntax to (a sentence or clause) so as to exhibit the structure, arrangement, or connection…

2. *I trembled, and my heart failed within me; when, on looking up, I saw, by the light of the moon, the daemon at the casement. A ghastly grin wrinkled his lips as he gazed on me, where I sat fulfilling the task which he had allotted to me. Yes, he had followed me in my travels; he had loitered in forests, hid himself in caves, or taken refuge in wide and desert heaths; and he now came to mark my progress, and claim the fulfilment of my promise.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Chapter XX”?

   A. An imperious hostess

   B. Visit to Hunsford

C. The second proposal

D. Destroying the companion

SAT key: 1. B (Small or narrow in proportion to the length or the height); 2. D (Destroying the companion)

Lesson 27: Chapter XXI

Focus: grief, prison and return

Teacher only · spoilers

Victor discovers the murdered man is Clerval. He falls into fever in prison for two months. Mr. Kirwin, the magistrate, is kind; his father arrives; Victor is acquitted and they return home.

Background: Grand juries and assizes were standard in British and Irish courts.

Significance: Clerval's death destroys the last emblem of Victor's healthy past.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Settle in and write for five minutes: How does Clerval's death affect Victor differently from William's? No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
Today's words are turnkeys, gaolers, repassed, assizes, vexations. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check Webster's. Here is the first: "But I was doomed to live; and, in two months, found myself as awaking from a dream, in a prison, stretched on a wretched bed, surrounded by gaolers, turnkeys, bolts, and all the miserable apparatus of a dungeon." Webster's says: A person who has charge of the keys of a prison, for opening and fastening the doors. Now the word history: "turnkey": no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin. "gaoler": -er (Old English -ere, "one who"). Root not in our table: have students find it. "repass": re- (Latin re-, "back, again") + pass (Latin passus, "step"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary. Add each root to your etymology log.

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Present the historical and literary background.
Here is what the first readers of Frankenstein would have known. Grand juries and assizes were standard in British and Irish courts. Why does this chapter matter? Clerval's death destroys the last emblem of Victor's healthy past. Write down one question you want answered.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for irony.
Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. I read a sentence, stop, and ask what the author is doing. When I see irony, I underline it and write in the margin what effect it has. Here I notice the diction and the sentence rhythm, and I connect them to grief, prison and return.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for Irony, Plot, Tone / mood.
Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of irony. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.

> *But I was doomed to live; and, in two months, found myself as awaking from a dream, in a prison, stretched on a wretched bed, surrounded by gaolers, turnkeys, bolts, and all the miserable apparatus of a dungeon. It was morning, I remember, when I thus awoke to understanding: I had forgotten the particulars of what had happened, and only felt as if some great misfortune had suddenly overwhelmed me; but when I looked around, and saw the barred windows, and the squalidness of the room in which I was, all flashed across my memory, and I groaned bitterly.*

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their rigor.
Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Irony, Plot, Tone / mood: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; your level is already set. Middle-school version: In "Chapter XXI," how does Shelley show grief, prison and return? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the chapter, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the irony you noticed as one piece of evidence. I will circulate and conference.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion (think-pair-share or a short Socratic circle).
Let's talk. Our question: How does this chapter connect to the costs of unchecked ambition? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
Take the chapter quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this chapter suggests about grief, prison and return, backed by one short quotation.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how irony shapes grief, prison and return. Tonight, read the next chapter and add two words to your etymology log.

Total: 90 minutes.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (Webster's 1913)	In context	Etymology note
turnkeys	A person who has charge of the keys of a prison, for opening and fastening the doors	*But I was doomed to live; and, in two months, found myself as awaking from a dream, in a prison, stretched on a wretched bed, surrounded by gaolers, turnkeys, bolts,*	"turnkey": no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED)

		and all the miserable apparatus of a dungeon.	and record the language of origin.
gaolers	The keeper of a jail	*But I was doomed to live; and, in two months, found myself as awaking from a dream, in a prison, stretched on a wretched bed, surrounded by gaolers, turnkeys, bolts, and all the miserable apparatus of a dungeon.*	“gaoler”: -er (Old English -ere, "one who"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
repassed	To pass again	*I repassed, in my memory, my whole life; my quiet happiness while residing with my family in Geneva, the death of my mother, and my departure for Ingolstadt.*	“repass”: re- (Latin re-, "back, again") + pass (Latin passus, "step"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary.
assizes	An assembly of knights and other substantial men, with a bailiff or justice, in a certain place and at a certain…	*The season of the assizes approached.*	“assize”: as- (Latin ad, "to"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
vexations	The act of vexing, or the state of being vexed	*My father was enraptured on finding me freed from the vexations of a criminal charge, that I was again allowed to breathe the fresh atmosphere, and permitted to return to my native country.*	“vexation”: -ation (Latin -atio, "the act or result of"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
retrospect	To look backward	*Kirwin said this, notwithstanding the agitation I endured on this retrospect of my sufferings, I also felt considerable surprise at the knowledge he seemed to possess concerning me.*	“retrospect”: re- (Latin re-, "back, again") + spect (Latin specere, "to look"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary.
hangman	One who hangs another	*Who could be interested in the fate of a murderer, but the hangman who would gain his fee?*	“hangman”: man (Latin manus, "hand"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary.
liberated	To release from restraint or bondage	*The grand jury rejected the bill, on its being proved that I was on the Orkney Islands at the hour the body of my friend was found; and a fortnight after my removal I was liberated from prison.*	“liberate”: lib (Latin liber, "free" / "book") + -ate (Latin -atus, "to make, having"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary.
residing	To dwell permanently or for a considerable time	*I repassed, in my memory, my whole life; my quiet happiness while residing with my family in Geneva, the death of my mother, and my departure for Ingolstadt.*	“reside”: re- (Latin re-, "back, again"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
laudanum			

	Tincture of opium, used for various medical purposes	*Ever since my recovery from the fever, I had been in the custom of taking every night a small quantity of laudanum; for it was by means of this drug only that I was enabled to gain the rest necessary for the preservation of life.*	"laudanum": no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin.

Discussion questions

1. How does Clerval's death affect Victor differently from William's?
2. Where does irony appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with creation and responsibility?

Annotation focus

- **Irony:** look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true
- **Plot:** look for key events and the causes linking them
- **Tone / mood:** look for word choices that reveal the narrator's attitude or the scene's feeling

Chapter quiz

1. Who is the murdered man?
   A. Henry Clerval
   B. William
   C. Felix
   D. Mr. Kirwin
2. How long does Victor lie ill in prison?
   A. Five years
   B. One week
   C. One day
   D. About two months
3. Who is kind to Victor in Ireland?
   A. Safie
   B. Felix
   C. Krempe
   D. Mr. Kirwin
4. Who comes to bring Victor home?
   A. Elizabeth
   B. Walton
   C. His father
   D. Ernest
5. What is ironic about Victor being accused?
   A. He likes jail

B. He is guilty in a sense, though innocent of the act

C. He was in Geneva

D. He confesses

6. In the line "But I was doomed to live; and, in two months, found myself as awaking from a dream, in a prison, stretched on a wretched bed, surrounded by gaolers, turnkeys, bolts, and all the miserable apparatus of a dungeon.", what does "turnkeys" most nearly mean?

   A. A person who has charge of the keys of a prison, for opening and fastening the doors

   B. To pass again

   C. An assembly of knights and other substantial men, with a bailiff or justice, in a certain place and at a certain…

   D. The keeper of a jail

7. In the line "But I was doomed to live; and, in two months, found myself as awaking from a dream, in a prison, stretched on a wretched bed, surrounded by gaolers, turnkeys, bolts, and all the miserable apparatus of a dungeon.", what does "gaolers" most nearly mean?

   A. To pass again

   B. A person who has charge of the keys of a prison, for opening and fastening the doors

   C. The keeper of a jail

   D. An assembly of knights and other substantial men, with a bailiff or justice, in a certain place and at a certain…

Answer key: 1. A (Henry Clerval); 2. D (About two months); 3. D (Mr. Kirwin); 4. C (His father); 5. B (He is guilty in a sense, though innocent of the act); 6. A (A person who has charge of the keys of a prison, for opening and fastening the doors); 7. C (The keeper of a jail)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; RL.7.6, W.7.1): In "Chapter XXI," how does Shelley show grief, prison and return? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the chapter, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the irony you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): In Chapter XXI, how does Shelley develop the idea of grief, prison and return? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the irony in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Chapter XXI develops the idea of grief, prison and return. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and plot shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Chapter XXI (where it begins, turns and ends) and its irony shape the reader's understanding of grief, prison and return. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Chapter XXI suggests about grief, prison and return. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's irony and plot), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; AP.RL.1, AP.W.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses irony in Chapter XXI to complicate the reader's understanding of grief, prison and return. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; CF.RL.1, CF.W.1): Situate Chapter XXI within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of grief, prison and return responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; C2.RL.1, C2.W.1): Read Chapter XXI alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of grief, prison and return follows or bends those conventions, using the irony as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; C3.RL.1, C3.W.1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter XXI and its treatment of grief, prison and return. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's irony and plot, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; C4.RL.1, C4.W.1): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter XXI as evidence for a larger claim about grief, prison and return in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; GR.RL.1, GR.W.1): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter XXI as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of grief, prison and return. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *I repassed, in my memory, my whole life; my quiet happiness while residing with my family in Geneva, the death of my mother, and my departure for Ingolstadt.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “repassed” most nearly mean?

   A. To dwell permanently or for a considerable time

   B. To pass again

   C. Tincture of opium, used for various medical purposes

   D. To release from restraint or bondage

2. *But I was doomed to live; and, in two months, found myself as awaking from a dream, in a prison, stretched on a wretched bed, surrounded by gaolers, turnkeys, bolts, and all the miserable apparatus of a dungeon. It was morning, I remember, when I thus awoke to understanding: I had forgotten the particulars of what had*

happened, and only felt as if some great misfortune had suddenly overwhelmed me; but when I looked around, and saw the barred windows, and the squalidness of the room in which I was, all flashed across my memory, and I groaned bitterly.

Which choice best states a central concern of "Chapter XXI"?

A. A ridiculous proposal

B. Grief, prison and return

C. Restlessness despite privilege

D. The great confrontation

SAT key: 1. B (To pass again); 2. B (Grief, prison and return)

Lesson 28: Chapter XXII

Focus: the wedding night and its catastrophe

Teacher only · spoilers

Victor and Elizabeth marry and travel to Evian. Armed and expecting to be attacked himself, Victor leaves Elizabeth alone, and the creature murders her. Victor's father dies of grief, and a Genevan magistrate doubts Victor's story.

Background: Weddings in this social class involved property arrangements; the Frankensteins regain some of Elizabeth's inheritance.

Significance: Dramatic irony: readers suspect the danger is to Elizabeth while Victor thinks only of himself.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Settle in and write for five minutes: Why does Victor misread the threat? No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
Today's words are overtaxed, unchained, obliterate, remonstrate, amphitheatre. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check Webster's. Here is the first: “I soon found that I had overtaxed my strength, and that I must repose before I could continue my journey.” Webster's says: To tax or to task too heavily. Now the word history: “overtax”: vert (Latin vertere, "to turn"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary. “unchain”: un- (Old English un-, "not"). Root not in our table: have students find it. “obliterate”: ob- (Latin ob, "against, toward") + liter (Latin littera, "letter") + -ate (Latin -atus, "to make, having"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary. Add each root to your etymology log.

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Present the historical and literary background.
Here is what the first readers of Frankenstein would have known. Weddings in this social class involved property arrangements; the Frankensteins regain some of Elizabeth's inheritance. Why does this chapter matter? Dramatic irony: readers suspect the danger is to Elizabeth while Victor thinks only of himself. Write down one question you want answered.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for foreshadowing.
Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. I read a sentence, stop, and ask what the author is doing. When I see foreshadowing, I underline it and write in the margin what effect it has. Here I notice the diction and the sentence rhythm, and I connect them to the wedding night and its catastrophe.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for Foreshadowing, Irony, Characterization.
Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of foreshadowing. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.

> *My father yielded at length to my desire to avoid society, and strove by various arguments to banish my despair. Sometimes he thought that I felt deeply the degradation of being obliged to answer a charge of murder, and he endeavoured to prove to me the futility of pride.*

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their rigor.
Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Foreshadowing, Irony, Characterization: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; your level is already set. Middle-school version: In "Chapter XXII," how does Shelley show the wedding night and its catastrophe? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the chapter, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the foreshadowing you noticed as one piece of evidence. I will circulate and conference.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion (think-pair-share or a short Socratic circle).
Let's talk. Our question: How does this chapter connect to the costs of unchecked ambition? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
Take the chapter quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this chapter suggests about the wedding night and its catastrophe, backed by one short quotation.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how foreshadowing shapes the wedding night and its catastrophe. Tonight, read the next chapter and add two words to your etymology log.

Total: 90 minutes.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (Webster's 1913)	In context	Etymology note
overtaxed	To tax or to task too heavily	*I soon found that I had overtaxed my strength, and that I must repose before I could continue my journey.*	"overtax": vert (Latin vertere, "to turn"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary.
unchained			

	To free from chains or slavery	*I had unchained an enemy among them, whose joy it was to shed their blood, and to revel in their groans.*	“unchain”: un- (Old English un-, "not"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
obliterate	To erase or blot out	*He wished as much as possible to obliterate the memory of the scenes that had taken place in Ireland, and never alluded to them, or suffered me to speak of my misfortunes.*	“obliterate”: ob- (Latin ob, "against, toward") + liter (Latin littera, "letter") + -ate (Latin -atus, "to make, having"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary.
remonstrate	To point out	*When reason returned, she would remonstrate, and endeavour to inspire me with resignation.*	“remonstrate”: re- (Latin re-, "back, again") + -ate (Latin -atus, "to make, having"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
amphitheatre	An oval or circular building with rising tiers of seats about an open space called the arena	*The Alps here come closer to the lake, and we approached the amphitheatre of mountains which forms its eastern boundary.*	“amphitheatre”: the (Greek theos, "god"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary.
playmate	A companion in diversions	*Victor, be assured that your cousin and playmate has too sincere a love for you not to be made miserable by this supposition.*	“playmate”: -ate (Latin -atus, "to make, having"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
centred	To be placed in a center	*I said, “little happiness remains for us on earth; yet all that I may one day enjoy is centred in you.*	“centre”: no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin.
futility	The quality of being talkative	*Sometimes he thought that I felt deeply the degradation of being obliged to answer a charge of murder, and he endeavoured to prove to me the futility of pride.*	“futility”: -ity (Latin -itas, "quality of"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
penniless	Destitute of money	*Alas! what freedom? such as the peasant enjoys when his family have been massacred before his eyes, his cottage burnt, his lands laid waste, and he is turned adrift, homeless, penniless, and alone, but free.*	“penniless”: -less (Old English -leas, "without"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
conduce	To lead or tend, esp	*I resolved, therefore, that if my immediate union with my cousin would conduce either to hers or my father’s happiness, my adversary’s designs against my life should not retard it a single hour.*	“conduce”: con- (Latin com-, "with, together") + duc (Latin ducere, "to lead"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary.

Discussion questions

1. Why does Victor misread the threat?
2. Where does foreshadowing appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with isolation and the need for companionship?

Annotation focus

- **Foreshadowing:** look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events
- **Irony:** look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true
- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them

Chapter quiz

1. Where do the newlyweds spend their wedding night?
   A. Rome
   B. Paris
   C. Evian
   D. London
2. Who is killed on the wedding night?
   A. Alphonse
   B. Elizabeth
   C. Victor
   D. Ernest
3. Who did Victor expect the creature to attack?
   A. Elizabeth
   B. Himself
   C. Ernest
   D. His father
4. How does Victor's father die?
   A. At sea
   B. Of grief
   C. Murdered by the creature
   D. In a duel
5. How does the magistrate respond to Victor's story?
   A. With full belief and action
   B. With doubt
   C. By arresting Victor
   D. With laughter

6. In the line “I soon found that I had overtaxed my strength, and that I must repose before I could continue my journey.”, what does “overtaxed” most nearly mean?
   A. To erase or blot out
   B. To tax or to task too heavily
   C. To free from chains or slavery
   D. To point out
7. In the line “I had unchained an enemy among them, whose joy it was to shed their blood, and to revel in their groans.”, what does “unchained” most nearly mean?
   A. To point out
   B. To tax or to task too heavily
   C. To free from chains or slavery
   D. To erase or blot out

Answer key: 1. C (Evian); 2. B (Elizabeth); 3. B (Himself); 4. B (Of grief); 5. B (With doubt); 6. B (To tax or to task too heavily); 7. C (To free from chains or slavery)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; RL.7.5, W.7.1): In “Chapter XXII,” how does Shelley show the wedding night and its catastrophe? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the chapter, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the foreshadowing you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1): In Chapter XXII, how does Shelley develop the idea of the wedding night and its catastrophe? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the foreshadowing in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Chapter XXII develops the idea of the wedding night and its catastrophe. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of foreshadowing and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Chapter XXII (where it begins, turns and ends) and its foreshadowing shape the reader's understanding of the wedding night and its catastrophe. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Chapter XXII suggests about the wedding night and its catastrophe. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's foreshadowing and irony), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; AP.RL.3, AP.W.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses foreshadowing in Chapter XXII to complicate the reader's understanding of the wedding night and its catastrophe. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; CF.RL.3, CF.W.1): Situate Chapter XXII within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of the wedding night and its catastrophe responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; C2.RL.3, C2.W.1): Read Chapter XXII alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of the wedding night and its catastrophe follows or bends those conventions, using the foreshadowing as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; C3.RL.3, C3.W.1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter XXII and its treatment of the wedding night and its catastrophe. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's foreshadowing and irony, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; C4.RL.3, C4.W.1): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter XXII as evidence for a larger claim about the wedding night and its catastrophe in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; GR.RL.3, GR.W.1): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter XXII as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of the wedding night and its catastrophe. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *He wished as much as possible to obliterate the memory of the scenes that had taken place in Ireland, and never alluded to them, or suffered me to speak of my misfortunes.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “obliterate” most nearly mean?

   A. Destitute of money

   B. To erase or blot out

   C. To lead or tend, esp

   D. The quality of being talkative

2. *My father yielded at length to my desire to avoid society, and strove by various arguments to banish my despair. Sometimes he thought that I felt deeply the degradation of being obliged to answer a charge of murder, and he endeavoured to prove to me the futility of pride.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Chapter XXII”?

   A. The wedding night and its catastrophe

   B. Confrontation between creator and creation

   C. A ridiculous proposal

   D. Disappointment and philosophy

SAT key: 1. B (To erase or blot out); 2. A (The wedding night and its catastrophe)

Lesson 29: Chapter XXIII

Focus: loss and vengeance

Teacher only · spoilers

Victor pursues the creature across Europe to the Arctic, following taunting messages. His tale ended, Walton resumes writing: the ice traps the ship, the crew demands to turn south, and Walton yields. Victor dies. The creature appears over his body, mourns, condemns himself, and vows to die on a funeral pyre before vanishing into darkness.

Background: The pursuit into the frozen north returns us to the frame setting.

Significance: Creator and creation become mirror images, each driven solely by revenge.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Settle in and write for five minutes: How have Victor and the creature come to resemble each other? No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
Today's words are deviating, inspecting, intimidated, seizure, maddening. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check Webster's. Here is the first: "I now related my history, briefly, but with firmness and precision, marking the dates with accuracy, and never deviating into invective or exclamation." Webster's says: To go out of the way. Now the word history: "deviate": de- (Latin de, "down from, away"). Root not in our table: have students find it. "inspect": in- (Latin in-, "not" or "in") + spect (Latin specere, "to look"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary. "intimidate": in- (Latin in-, "not" or "in") + -ate (Latin -atus, "to make, having"). Root not in our table: have students find it. Add each root to your etymology log.

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Present the historical and literary background.
Here is what the first readers of Frankenstein would have known. The pursuit into the frozen north returns us to the frame setting. Why does this chapter matter? Creator and creation become mirror images, each driven solely by revenge. Write down one question you want answered.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for plot.
Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. I read a sentence, stop, and ask what the author is doing. When I see plot, I underline it and write in the margin what effect it has. Here I notice the diction and the sentence rhythm, and I connect them to loss and vengeance.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for Plot, Tone / mood, Characterization.
Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of plot. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.

> *She left me, and I continued some time walking up and down the passages of the house, and inspecting every corner that might afford a retreat to my adversary. But I discovered no trace of him, and was beginning to conjecture that some fortunate chance had intervened to prevent the execution of his menaces; when suddenly I heard a shrill and dreadful scream. It came from the room into which Elizabeth had retired. As I heard it, the whole truth rushed into my mind, my arms dropped, the motion of every muscle and fibre was suspended; I could feel the blood trickling in my veins, and tingling in the extremities of my limbs. This state lasted but for an instant; the scream was repeated, and I rushed into the room.*

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their rigor.
Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Plot, Tone / mood, Characterization: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; your level is already set. Middle-school version: In "Chapter XXIII," how does Shelley show loss and vengeance? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the chapter, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the plot you noticed as one piece of evidence. I will circulate and conference.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion (think-pair-share or a short Socratic circle).
Let's talk. Our question: How does this chapter connect to the costs of unchecked ambition? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
Take the chapter quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this chapter suggests about loss and vengeance, backed by one short quotation.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how plot shapes loss and vengeance. Tonight, read the next chapter and add two words to your etymology log.

Total: 90 minutes.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (Webster's 1913)	In context	Etymology note
deviating	To go out of the way	*I now related my history, briefly, but with firmness and precision, marking the dates with*	"deviate": de- (Latin de, "down from, away"). Root not in our table: have students find it.

		accuracy, and never deviating into invective or exclamation.	
inspecting	To look upon	*She left me, and I continued some time walking up and down the passages of the house, and inspecting every corner that might afford a retreat to my adversary.*	“inspect”: in- (Latin in-, "not" or "in") + spect (Latin specere, "to look"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary.
intimidated	To make timid or fearful	*As I spoke, rage sparkled in my eyes; the magistrate was intimidated:—“You are mistaken,” said he, “I will exert myself; and if it is in my power to seize the monster, be assured that he shall suffer punishment proportionate to his crimes.*	“intimidate”: in- (Latin in-, "not" or "in") + -ate (Latin -atus, "to make, having"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
seizure	The act of seizing, or the state of being seized	*When I had concluded my narration, I said, “This is the being whom I accuse, and for whose seizure and punishment I call upon you to exert your whole power.*	“seizure”: se- (Latin se-, "apart"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
maddening	To make mad	*I was possessed by a maddening rage when I thought of him, and desired and ardently prayed that I might have him within my grasp to wreak a great and signal revenge on his cursed head.*	“madden”: no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin.
auditor	A hearer or listener	*This address caused a considerable change in the physiognomy of my own auditor.*	“auditor”: -or (Latin -or, "one who"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
menaces	The show of an intention to inflict evil	*But I discovered no trace of him, and was beginning to conjecture that some fortunate chance had intervened to prevent the execution of his menaces; when suddenly I heard a shrill and dreadful scream.*	“menace”: no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin.
tingling	To feel a kind of thrilling sensation, as in hearing a shrill sound	*As I heard it, the whole truth rushed into my mind, my arms dropped, the motion of every muscle and fibre was suspended; I could feel the blood trickling in my veins, and tingling in the extremities of my limbs.*	“tingle”: no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin.
intervened	To come between, or to be between, persons or things	*But I discovered no trace of him, and was beginning to conjecture that some fortunate chance had intervened to prevent the execution of his menaces; when suddenly I heard a shrill and dreadful scream.*	“intervene”: inter- (Latin inter, "between") + ven (Latin venire, "to come"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary.
torrents	A violent stream, as of water, lava, or the like	*There were no horses to be procured, and I must return by the lake; but the wind was unfavourable, and the rain fell in torrents.*	“torrent”: -ent (Latin -ens, "one who, doing"). Root not in our table: have students find it.

Discussion questions

1. How have Victor and the creature come to resemble each other?
2. Where does plot appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with nature versus nurture?

Annotation focus

- **Plot:** look for key events and the causes linking them
- **Tone / mood:** look for word choices that reveal the narrator's attitude or the scene's feeling
- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them

Chapter quiz

1. What does the creature leave for Victor during the pursuit?
   A. Taunting messages and food
   B. A boat
   C. Letters from Elizabeth
   D. Money
2. How does Victor's father die?
   A. At sea
   B. In a duel
   C. Murdered by the creature
   D. Of grief
3. How does the magistrate respond to Victor's story?
   A. By arresting Victor
   B. With doubt
   C. With laughter
   D. With full belief and action
4. Where does the pursuit lead?
   A. The Arctic
   B. South America
   C. India
   D. Africa
5. What does the creature leave for Victor?
   A. Letters to Elizabeth
   B. A boat
   C. Taunting messages and food
   D. Money
6. In the line “I now related my history, briefly, but with firmness and precision, marking the dates with accuracy, and never deviating into invective or exclamation.”, what does “deviating” most nearly mean?
   A. To look upon

B. To go out of the way

C. The act of seizing, or the state of being seized

D. To make timid or fearful

7. In the line “She left me, and I continued some time walking up and down the passages of the house, and inspecting every corner that might afford a retreat to my adversary.”, what does “inspecting” most nearly mean?

A. To look upon

B. To make timid or fearful

C. To go out of the way

D. The act of seizing, or the state of being seized

Answer key: 1. A (Taunting messages and food); 2. D (Of grief); 3. B (With doubt); 4. A (The Arctic); 5. C (Taunting messages and food); 6. B (To go out of the way); 7. A (To look upon)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; RL.7.3, W.7.1): In “Chapter XXIII,” how does Shelley show loss and vengeance? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the chapter, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the plot you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In Chapter XXIII, how does Shelley develop the idea of loss and vengeance? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the plot in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Chapter XXIII develops the idea of loss and vengeance. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of plot and tone / mood shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Chapter XXIII (where it begins, turns and ends) and its plot shape the reader's understanding of loss and vengeance. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Chapter XXIII suggests about loss and vengeance. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's plot and tone / mood), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; AP.RL.2, AP.W.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses plot in Chapter XXIII to complicate the reader's understanding of loss and vengeance. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; CF.RL.2, CF.W.1): Situate Chapter XXIII within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of loss and vengeance responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; C2.RL.2, C2.W.1): Read Chapter XXIII alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of loss and vengeance follows or bends those conventions, using the plot as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; C3.RL.2, C3.W.1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter XXIII and its treatment of loss and vengeance. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's plot and tone / mood, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; C4.RL.2, C4.W.1): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter XXIII as evidence for a larger claim about loss and vengeance in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; GR.RL.2, GR.W.1): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter XXIII as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of loss and vengeance. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *As I spoke, rage sparkled in my eyes; the magistrate was intimidated:—"You are mistaken," said he, "I will exert myself; and if it is in my power to seize the monster, be assured that he shall suffer punishment proportionate to his crimes.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "intimidated" most nearly mean?

   A. To make timid or fearful

   B. To come between, or to be between, persons or things

   C. A violent stream, as of water, lava, or the like

   D. To feel a kind of thrilling sensation, as in hearing a shrill sound

2. *She left me, and I continued some time walking up and down the passages of the house, and inspecting every corner that might afford a retreat to my adversary. But I discovered no trace of him, and was beginning to conjecture that some fortunate chance had intervened to prevent the execution of his menaces; when suddenly I heard a shrill and dreadful scream. It came from the room into which Elizabeth had retired. As I heard it, the whole truth rushed into my mind, my arms dropped, the motion of every muscle and fibre was suspended; I could feel the blood trickling in my veins, and tingling in the extremities of my limbs. This state lasted but for an instant; the scream was repeated, and I rushed into the room.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Chapter XXIII"?

   A. The first death and growing guilt

   B. Confidence before danger

   C. Loss and vengeance

   D. The hidden benefactor

SAT key: 1. A (To make timid or fearful); 2. C (Loss and vengeance)

Lesson 30: Chapter XXIV

Focus: the final reckoning

Teacher only · spoilers

Walton resumes writing. The ice traps the ship; the crew demands to turn south, and Walton yields. Victor dies. The creature appears over his body, mourns, condemns himself, and vows to destroy himself on a funeral pyre before vanishing into darkness.

Background: Walton's choice to return is a moral decision, contrasting with Victor's refusal to stop.

Significance: The ending lets Walton learn the lesson, while the creature's final speech gives him the last eloquent word.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Settle in and write for five minutes: Does Walton learn from Victor? What evidence shows it? No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
Today's words are curdles, disencumbered, execrate, abortion, congeal. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check Webster's. Here is the first: “You have read this strange and terrific story, Margaret; and do you not feel your blood congeal with horror, like that which even now curdles mine?” Webster's says: To change into curd. Now the word history: “curdle”: cur (Latin cura, "care"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary. “disencumber”: dis- (Latin dis-, "apart, not") + -er (Old English -ere, "one who"). Root not in our table: have students find it. “execrate”: ex- (Latin ex, "out of") + -ate (Latin -atus, "to make, having"). Root not in our table: have students find it. Add each root to your etymology log.

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Present the historical and literary background.
Here is what the first readers of Frankenstein would have known. Walton's choice to return is a moral decision, contrasting with Victor's refusal to stop. Why does this chapter matter? The ending lets Walton learn the lesson, while the creature's final speech gives him the last eloquent word. Write down one question you want answered.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for point of view.
Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. I read a sentence, stop, and ask what the author is doing. When I see point of view, I underline it and write in the margin what effect it has. Here I notice the diction and the sentence rhythm, and I connect them to the final reckoning.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for Point of view, Theme, Irony.
Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of point of view. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.

> *What his feelings were whom I pursued I cannot know. Sometimes, indeed, he left marks in writing on the barks of the trees, or cut in stone, that guided me, and instigated my fury. "My reign is not yet over," (these words were legible in one of these inscriptions;) "you live, and my power is complete. Follow me; I seek the everlasting ices of the north, where you will feel the misery of cold and frost, to which I am impassive. You will find near this place, if you follow not too tardily, a dead hare; eat, and be refreshed. Come on, my enemy; we have yet to wrestle for our lives; but many hard and miserable hours must you endure until that period shall arrive."*

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their rigor.
Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Point of view, Theme, Irony: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; your level is already set. Middle-school version: In "Chapter XXIV," how does Shelley show the final reckoning? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the chapter, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the point of view you noticed as one piece of evidence. I will circulate and conference.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion (think-pair-share or a short Socratic circle).
Let's talk. Our question: How does this chapter connect to the costs of unchecked ambition? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
Take the chapter quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this chapter suggests about the final reckoning, backed by one short quotation.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how point of view shapes the final reckoning. Tonight, read the next chapter and add two words to your etymology log.

Total: 90 minutes.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (Webster's 1913)	In context	Etymology note
curdles	To change into curd	*You have read this strange and terrific story, Margaret; and do you not feel*	"curdle": cur (Latin cura, "care"). Teacher note from a

		your blood congeal with horror, like that which even now curdles mine?	root table; verify in an etymological dictionary.
disencumbered	To free from encumbrance, or from anything which clogs, impedes, or obstructs	*But this was not the time for delay: I disencumbered the dogs of their dead companion, gave them a plentiful portion of food; and, after an hour's rest, which was absolutely necessary, and yet which was bitterly irksome to me, I continued my route.*	"disencumber": dis- (Latin dis-, "apart, not") + -er (Old English -ere, "one who"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
execrate	To denounce evil against, or to imprecate evil upon	*Why do you not execrate the rustic who sought to destroy the saviour of his child?*	"execrate": ex- (Latin ex, "out of") + -ate (Latin -atus, "to make, having"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
abortion	The act of giving premature birth	*I, the miserable and the abandoned, am an abortion, to be spurned at, and kicked, and trampled on.*	"abortion": ab- (Latin ab, "away from"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
congeal	To change from a fluid to a solid state by cold	*You have read this strange and terrific story, Margaret; and do you not feel your blood congeal with horror, like that which even now curdles mine?*	"congeal": con- (Latin com-, "with, together"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
glimmers	To give feeble or scattered rays of light	*Frankenstein has daily declined in health: a feverish fire still glimmers in his eyes; but he is exhausted, and, when suddenly roused to any exertion, he speedily sinks again into apparent lifelessness.*	"glimmer": -er (Old English -ere, "one who"). Root not in our table: have students find it.
scaring	A mark in the skin or flesh of an animal, made by a wound or ulcer, and remaining after the wound or ulcer is healed	*I approached this tremendous being; I dared not again raise my eyes to his face, there was something so scaring and unearthly in his ugliness.*	"scar": no root in our classroom table; have students look it up (Etymonline, OED) and record the language of origin.
tardily	In a tardy manner	*You will find near this place, if you follow not too tardily, a dead hare; eat, and be refreshed.*	"tardily": ard (Latin ardere, "to burn") + -ly (Old English -lice, "in the manner of"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary.
composes	To form by putting together two or more things or parts	*Oh, no! the only joy that he can now know will be when he composes his shattered spirit to peace and death.*	"compose": com- (Latin com-, "with, together") + pos (Latin ponere, "to place"). Teacher note from a root table; verify in an etymological dictionary.

modulated	To form, as sound, to a certain key, or to a certain portion	*He spoke this with a voice so modulated to the different feelings expressed in his speech, with an eye so full of lofty design and heroism, that can you wonder that these men were moved?*	“modulate”: -ate (Latin -atus, "to make, having"). Root not in our table: have students find it.

Discussion questions

1. Does Walton learn from Victor? What evidence shows it?
2. Where does point of view appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with the sublime power of nature?

Annotation focus

- **Point of view:** look for who is telling the story and what that narrator can and cannot know
- **Theme:** look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas
- **Irony:** look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true

Chapter quiz

1. What do Walton's crew demand?
   A. To find the creature
   B. To turn back south
   C. More pay
   D. To land in Russia
2. How does Walton respond?
   A. He punishes them
   B. He refuses
   C. He leaves the ship
   D. He agrees to return
3. What happens to Victor?
   A. He returns to Geneva
   B. He kills the creature
   C. He dies on the ship
   D. He marries again
4. What does the creature plan to do?
   A. Create a mate
   B. Go to London
   C. Destroy himself on a funeral pyre
   D. Rule the Arctic
5. Whose voice ends the story?
   A. Elizabeth's
   B. Clerval's

C. Victor's

D. Walton's, recording the creature's departure

6. In the line “You have read this strange and terrific story, Margaret; and do you not feel your blood congeal with horror, like that which even now curdles mine?”, what does “curdles” most nearly mean?

A. To change into curd

B. To free from encumbrance, or from anything which clogs, impedes, or obstructs

C. The act of giving premature birth

D. To denounce evil against, or to imprecate evil upon

7. In the line “But this was not the time for delay: I disencumbered the dogs of their dead companion, gave them a plentiful portion of food; and, after an hour's rest, which was absolutely necessary, and yet which was bitterly irksome to me, I continued my route.”, what does “disencumbered” most nearly mean?

A. To change into curd

B. To denounce evil against, or to imprecate evil upon

C. The act of giving premature birth

D. To free from encumbrance, or from anything which clogs, impedes, or obstructs

Answer key: 1. B (To turn back south); 2. D (He agrees to return); 3. C (He dies on the ship); 4. C (Destroy himself on a funeral pyre); 5. D (Walton's, recording the creature's departure); 6. A (To change into curd); 7. D (To free from encumbrance, or from anything which clogs, impedes, or obstructs)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; RL.7.6, W.7.1): In “Chapter XXIV,” how does Shelley show the final reckoning? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the chapter, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the point of view you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): In Chapter XXIV, how does Shelley develop the idea of the final reckoning? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the point of view in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Chapter XXIV develops the idea of the final reckoning. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of point of view and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Chapter XXIV (where it begins, turns and ends) and its point of view shape the reader's understanding of the final reckoning. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Chapter XXIV suggests about the final reckoning. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's point of view and theme), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; AP.RL.3, AP.W.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses point of view in Chapter XXIV to complicate the reader's understanding of the final reckoning. Develop a

defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; CF.RL.3, CF.W.1): Situate Chapter XXIV within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of the final reckoning responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; C2.RL.3, C2.W.1): Read Chapter XXIV alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of the final reckoning follows or bends those conventions, using the point of view as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; C3.RL.3, C3.W.1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter XXIV and its treatment of the final reckoning. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's point of view and theme, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; C4.RL.3, C4.W.1): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter XXIV as evidence for a larger claim about the final reckoning in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; GR.RL.3, GR.W.1): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter XXIV as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of the final reckoning. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *Why do you not execrate the rustic who sought to destroy the saviour of his child?*

   As used in the text, what does the word “execrate” most nearly mean?

   A. To form, as sound, to a certain key, or to a certain portion

   B. To denounce evil against, or to imprecate evil upon

   C. In a tardy manner

   D. To form by putting together two or more things or parts

2. *What his feelings were whom I pursued I cannot know. Sometimes, indeed, he left marks in writing on the barks of the trees, or cut in stone, that guided me, and instigated my fury. “My reign is not yet over,” (these words were legible in one of these inscriptions;) “you live, and my power is complete. Follow me; I seek the everlasting ices of the north, where you will feel the misery of cold and frost, to which I am impassive. You will find near this place, if you follow not too tardily, a dead hare; eat, and be refreshed. Come on, my enemy; we have yet to wrestle for our lives; but many hard and miserable hours must you endure until that period shall arrive.”*

Which choice best states a central concern of "Chapter XXIV"?

A. Wisdom cannot be taught

B. The final reckoning

C. A charming stranger

D. Confidence before danger

SAT key: 1. B (To denounce evil against, or to imprecate evil upon); 2. B (The final reckoning)

Whole-book test

Frankenstein: whole-book test · 90 minutes

Part I: Multiple choice

1. Where was Shelley staying when the ghost-story contest began?
   A. In London
   B. In Venice
   C. On a ship to the Arctic
   D. Near Geneva, Switzerland
2. Which scientist does the Preface mention as having supposed the event possible?
   A. Isaac Newton
   B. Galileo
   C. Humphry Davy
   D. Dr. Darwin
3. To whom is Walton writing?
   A. His sister, Margaret Saville
   B. Victor Frankenstein
   C. A ship's captain
   D. His father
4. What does Walton say he lacks most?
   A. A friend who shares his feelings
   B. A ship
   C. Money for the voyage
   D. Maps of the Arctic
5. How does Walton feel in Letter III?
   A. Ill and weak
   B. Confident and determined
   C. Ready to turn back
   D. Terrified
6. What does the crew first see on the ice?
   A. A polar bear
   B. A lost ship
   C. A gigantic figure on a dog sled
   D. A fire
7. Where is Victor's family from?
   A. Paris

B. Naples

C. London

D. Geneva

8. Which author first fascinates Victor?

A. Cornelius Agrippa

B. Homer

C. Isaac Newton

D. Shakespeare

9. How does Victor's mother die?

A. A carriage accident

B. Drowning

C. Scarlet fever caught nursing Elizabeth

D. Old age

10. What does Victor discover?

A. A route to the pole

B. A cure for fever

C. A new planet

D. The cause of generation and life

11. What month does the creature come to life?

A. December

B. June

C. March

D. November

12. Who writes to Victor during his recovery?

A. Walton

B. His mother

C. Krempe

D. Elizabeth

13. Who has been murdered?

A. Alphonse

B. Elizabeth

C. Clerval

D. William, Victor's youngest brother

14. What happens at Justine's trial?

A. She is freed

B. She escapes

C. She is convicted and condemned

D. The trial is cancelled

15. What does Victor consider in his despair?
    A. Suicide
    B. Becoming a monk
    C. Marrying at once
    D. Moving to England
16. Where does Victor meet the creature?
    A. In Geneva
    B. In a church
    C. On the glacier at Montanvert
    D. On Walton's ship
17. Who narrates this chapter?
    A. Elizabeth
    B. Walton
    C. The creature
    D. Victor
18. Whom does the creature observe?
    A. Villagers in Geneva
    B. The Frankensteins
    C. The De Lacey family
    D. Walton's crew
19. Who arrives at the cottage?
    A. Safie
    B. Elizabeth
    C. Clerval
    D. Justine
20. Why were the De Laceys exiled?
    A. Felix helped a Turkish merchant escape
    B. They were scientists
    C. They stole money
    D. They insulted the king
21. Which book is NOT among those he finds?
    A. The Sorrows of Young Werther
    B. Plutarch's Lives
    C. Robinson Crusoe
    D. Paradise Lost
22. Where does the creature travel after the De Laceys leave?
    A. To Ingolstadt
    B. To London
    C. To the North Pole

D. Toward Geneva

23. What does the creature demand?
    A. A female companion
    B. To live in Geneva
    C. Money
    D. Victor's death
24. Why does Victor travel to England?
    A. To study law
    B. To meet Walton
    C. To create the female in secret
    D. To visit his mother
25. Where does Victor work on the second creature?
    A. Oxford
    B. London
    C. Edinburgh University
    D. A remote island in the Orkneys
26. Why does Victor destroy the female?
    A. She is finished and dangerous
    B. He fears a race of devils
    C. The creature asks him
    D. He runs out of materials
27. Who is the murdered man?
    A. Henry Clerval
    B. William
    C. Felix
    D. Mr. Kirwin
28. Where do the newlyweds spend their wedding night?
    A. Rome
    B. Paris
    C. Evian
    D. London
29. What does the creature leave for Victor during the pursuit?
    A. Taunting messages and food
    B. A boat
    C. Letters from Elizabeth
    D. Money
30. What do Walton's crew demand?
    A. To find the creature
    B. To turn back south

C. More pay

D. To land in Russia

Part II: Short answer

1. Explain how the costs of unchecked ambition develops from the beginning of the novel to the end. Use two chapters.
2. Explain how creation and responsibility develops from the beginning of the novel to the end. Use two chapters.
3. Explain how isolation and the need for companionship develops from the beginning of the novel to the end. Use two chapters.

Part III: Essay

Choose one of the novel's central concerns (the costs of unchecked ambition, creation and responsibility, isolation and the need for companionship, nature versus nurture, the sublime power of nature) and argue how the ending reframes it.

Answer key

Answer key: 1. D (Near Geneva, Switzerland); 2. D (Dr. Darwin); 3. A (His sister, Margaret Saville); 4. A (A friend who shares his feelings); 5. B (Confident and determined); 6. C (A gigantic figure on a dog sled); 7. D (Geneva); 8. A (Cornelius Agrippa); 9. C (Scarlet fever caught nursing Elizabeth); 10. D (The cause of generation and life); 11. D (November); 12. D (Elizabeth); 13. D (William, Victor's youngest brother); 14. C (She is convicted and condemned); 15. A (Suicide); 16. C (On the glacier at Montanvert); 17. C (The creature); 18. C (The De Lacey family); 19. A (Safie); 20. A (Felix helped a Turkish merchant escape); 21. C (Robinson Crusoe); 22. D (Toward Geneva); 23. A (A female companion); 24. C (To create the female in secret); 25. D (A remote island in the Orkneys); 26. B (He fears a race of devils); 27. A (Henry Clerval); 28. C (Evian); 29. A (Taunting messages and food); 30. B (To turn back south)

Essay assignments

Essay: The costs of unchecked ambition

Middle School (600 words; W.7.1, RL.7.2): Write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Frankenstein teaches about the costs of unchecked ambition. Use at least three quotations from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Mary Shelley develops the costs of unchecked ambition in Frankenstein. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Mary Shelley develops the costs of unchecked ambition across Frankenstein. Trace the idea through at least three chapters and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Frankenstein (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of the costs of unchecked ambition. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of the costs of unchecked ambition in Frankenstein. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (900 words; AP.W.1, AP.RL.2): In a well-organized essay, analyze how Mary Shelley uses a recurring literary element to shape the meaning of the costs of unchecked ambition in Frankenstein. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; CF.W.1, CF.RL.2): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places Frankenstein's treatment of the costs of unchecked ambition in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; C2.W.1, C2.RL.2): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on the costs of unchecked ambition in Frankenstein that reads the novel against its genre and period and engages two published critics.

College Junior (2800 words; C3.W.1, C3.RL.2): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on the costs of unchecked ambition in Frankenstein. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits.

College Senior (4000 words; C4.W.1, C4.RL.2): Write a capstone research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about the costs of unchecked ambition in Frankenstein, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; GR.W.1, GR.RL.2): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on the costs of unchecked ambition in Frankenstein, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Creation and responsibility

Middle School (600 words; W.7.1, RL.7.2): Write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Frankenstein teaches about creation and responsibility. Use at least three quotations from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Mary Shelley develops creation and responsibility in Frankenstein. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Mary Shelley develops creation and responsibility across Frankenstein. Trace the idea through at least three chapters and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Frankenstein (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of creation and responsibility. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of creation and responsibility in Frankenstein. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (900 words; AP.W.1, AP.RL.2): In a well-organized essay, analyze how Mary Shelley uses a recurring literary element to shape the meaning of creation and responsibility in Frankenstein. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; CF.W.1, CF.RL.2): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places Frankenstein's treatment of creation and responsibility in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; C2.W.1, C2.RL.2): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on creation and responsibility in Frankenstein that reads the novel against its genre and period and engages two published critics.

College Junior (2800 words; C3.W.1, C3.RL.2): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on creation and responsibility in Frankenstein. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits.

College Senior (4000 words; C4.W.1, C4.RL.2): Write a capstone research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about creation and responsibility in Frankenstein, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; GR.W.1, GR.RL.2): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on creation and responsibility in Frankenstein, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Isolation and the need for companionship

Middle School (600 words; W.7.1, RL.7.2): Write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Frankenstein teaches about isolation and the need for companionship. Use at least three quotations from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Mary Shelley develops isolation and the need for companionship in Frankenstein. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Mary Shelley develops isolation and the need for companionship across Frankenstein. Trace the idea through at least three chapters and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Frankenstein (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of isolation and the need for companionship. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of isolation and the need for companionship in Frankenstein. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (900 words; AP.W.1, AP.RL.2): In a well-organized essay, analyze how Mary Shelley uses a recurring literary element to shape the meaning of isolation and the need for companionship in Frankenstein. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; CF.W.1, CF.RL.2): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places Frankenstein's treatment of isolation and the need for companionship in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; C2.W.1, C2.RL.2): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on isolation and the need for companionship in Frankenstein that reads the novel against its genre and period and engages two published critics.

College Junior (2800 words; C3.W.1, C3.RL.2): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on isolation and the need for companionship in Frankenstein. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits.

College Senior (4000 words; C4.W.1, C4.RL.2): Write a capstone research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about isolation and the need for companionship in Frankenstein, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; GR.W.1, GR.RL.2): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on isolation and the need for companionship in Frankenstein, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Nature versus nurture

Middle School (600 words; W.7.1, RL.7.2): Write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Frankenstein teaches about nature versus nurture. Use at least three quotations from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Mary Shelley develops nature versus nurture in Frankenstein. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Mary Shelley develops nature versus nurture across Frankenstein. Trace the idea through at least three chapters and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Frankenstein (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of nature versus nurture. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of nature versus nurture in Frankenstein. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (900 words; AP.W.1, AP.RL.2): In a well-organized essay, analyze how Mary Shelley uses a recurring literary element to shape the meaning of nature versus nurture in Frankenstein. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; CF.W.1, CF.RL.2): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places Frankenstein's treatment of nature versus nurture in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; C2.W.1, C2.RL.2): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on nature versus nurture in Frankenstein that reads the novel against its genre and period and engages two published critics.

College Junior (2800 words; C3.W.1, C3.RL.2): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on nature versus nurture in Frankenstein. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits.

College Senior (4000 words; C4.W.1, C4.RL.2): Write a capstone research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about nature versus nurture in Frankenstein, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; GR.W.1, GR.RL.2): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on nature versus nurture in Frankenstein, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: The sublime power of nature

Middle School (600 words; W.7.1, RL.7.2): Write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Frankenstein teaches about the sublime power of nature. Use at least three quotations from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Mary Shelley develops the sublime power of nature in Frankenstein. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Mary Shelley develops the sublime power of nature across Frankenstein. Trace the idea through at least three chapters and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Frankenstein (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of the sublime power of nature. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of the sublime power of nature in Frankenstein. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (900 words; AP.W.1, AP.RL.2): In a well-organized essay, analyze how Mary Shelley uses a recurring literary element to shape the meaning of the sublime power of nature in Frankenstein. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; CF.W.1, CF.RL.2): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places Frankenstein's treatment of the sublime power of nature in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; C2.W.1, C2.RL.2): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on the sublime power of nature in Frankenstein that reads the novel against its genre and period and engages two published critics.

College Junior (2800 words; C3.W.1, C3.RL.2): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on the sublime power of nature in Frankenstein. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits.

College Senior (4000 words; C4.W.1, C4.RL.2): Write a capstone research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about the sublime power of nature in Frankenstein, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; GR.W.1, GR.RL.2): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on the sublime power of nature in Frankenstein, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

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